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CITY: PG 3
Women's quota defeat: Delhi House passes censure motion against Oppn

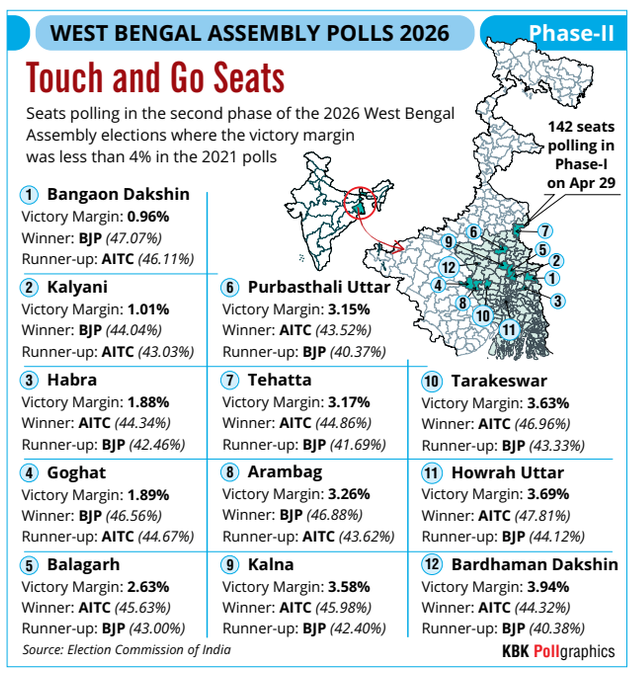
NATION: PG 5
PM says dynastic parties stalling women's quota

FILM: PG 14
'I never want to be next someone else'

BENGAL POLLS: 2,343 COMPANIES OF CENTRAL FORCES DEPLOYED

Over 3 cr voters to decide fate of 1448 candidates amid heavy CAPF cover

Women officials depart for polling stations on the eve of voting PTI



SOUMITRA NANDI

KOLKATA: The stage is set for the second and final phase of elections on Wednesday, with 3.21 crore electors set to decide the fate of 1,448 candidates — 1,228 men and 220 women — across 142 Assembly constituencies.

The electorate comprises 1.64 crore men, 1.57 crore women and 792 transgender voters.

TAKEAWAYS

- The electorate comprises 1.64 crore men, 1.57 crore women and 792 transgender voters
- The constituencies are spread across eight districts of south Bengal
- Polling will be held in 41,001 stations, including 39,301 main and 1,700 auxiliary booths

The constituencies are spread across eight districts — Kolkata North (7 seats), Kolkata South (4), North 24 Parganas (33), South 24 Parganas (31), Howrah (16), Nadia (17), Hooghly (18) and East Burdwan (16). The presence of international and riverine borders in three districts poses both political and security challenges. Polling will be held in 41,001 stations, including 39,301 main and 1,700 auxiliary booths. Bhangar in South 24-Parganas has the highest Continued on P4

NO CLARIFICATION ON NUMBER OF CASE DISPOSED OF BY TRIBUNALS

EC adds 1468 names to voter roll, Trinamool says 'low' deletion rate shows 'genuine voters targeted'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: The Election Commission of India (ECI) late on Monday night published a fresh supplementary list, a day ahead of the second phase of polls, allowing the inclusion of 1,468 names in the electoral roll while excluding six, as directed by tribunals. However, the Commission did not clarify how many cases were disposed of by the tribunals before this phase.

The ruling All India Trinamool Congress (TMC) said that the deletion of only six out of 1,474 electors vindicated party chief Mamata Banerjee's repeated claims that genuine voters were targeted during the special intensive revision (SIR). The party argued that, at this rate, only about 1,000 names would have been deleted out of the 27 lakh cases still pending before tribunals, had they been disposed of ahead of the second and final phase.

TMC state vice-president Joy Prakash Majumdar alleged: "The ECI has destroyed democracy. The poll body has been acting like 'Tughlaq'. The Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar will be seen as a 'khal nayak' in history." Continued on P4

KEY POINTS

- TMC said that the deletion of only six out of 1,474 electors vindicated party chief Mamata Banerjee's repeated claims that genuine voters were targeted
- The party said that only about 1,000 names would have been deleted out of the 27 lakh cases still pending before tribunals, had they been disposed of ahead of the second and final phase
- The Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar will be seen as a 'khal nayak' in history, says TMC leader Joy Prakash Majumdar

India to get 4th unit of S-400 missile systems early next month

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India is set to receive the fourth unit of the S-400 Triumf surface-to-air missile system from Russia early next month, a move expected to strengthen the country's air defence network, according to security sources on Tuesday.

Last month, New Delhi approved procurement of five additional S-400 units, doubling the planned fleet to 10

The delivery is part of a $5 billion agreement signed in October 2018 for five S-400 units, of which three have already been inducted. Officials said the fourth system has already been shipped and is likely to arrive within days. The fifth and final unit under the original contract is scheduled for delivery by November, following a revised timeline.

The S-400 systems were deployed by the Indian Air Force during the May 7 to 10 conflict with Pakistan and were also instrumental Continued on P4

IRAN SAYS IT IS STILL IN A 'WAR SITUATION'

US unmoved by Iran offer to end war sans nuclear deal

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: The Trump administration seemed unlikely on Tuesday to accept Iran's offer to end the war and reopen the Strait of Hormuz if the US lifts its blockade on the country.

The proposal would postpone discussions on the Islamic Republic's nuclear programme, something that US Secretary of State Marco Rubio appeared to rule out in a Fox News interview Monday.

"We have to ensure that any deal that is made, any agreement that is made, is one that definitively prevents them from sprinting towards a nuclear weapon at any point," he said of the proposal, which was delivered to the US by Pakistan.

The White House said US President Donald Trump's national security team discussed the offer and Trump would address it later.

The offer emerged Monday as Iran Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi visited Russia, which has long been a key backer of Tehran. It was unclear what, if any, assistance Moscow might offer now.

An Iranian army spokesperson said Iran is still in a "war situation" as the Strait of Hormuz remains a major sticking point in negotiations.

As Gulf leaders meet in Saudi Arabia, Qatar says the critical waterway should not be used as a pressure card and warns against the possibility of a "frozen conflict", according to Al Jazeera news network.

President Trump's national security team is reviewing the plan by Iran to halt the war and open the Strait of Hormuz, while postponing talks on its nuclear programme.

Israel and Hezbollah continue to trade fire as the death toll from Israeli attacks on Lebanon since an April 17 "ceasefire" rose to at least 40 people. Continued on P4

At UNSC, India calls for safe passage through Hormuz, flags risks to global trade

UNITED NATIONS: India has called for the immediate restoration of safe and uninterrupted maritime passage through the Strait of Hormuz, warning that any disruption to critical waterways carries far-reaching consequences for global trade and energy flows.

Speaking at a United Nations Security Council open debate on maritime security, India's Chargé d'affaires to the UN, Yojna Patel, said recent developments in West Asia have raised serious concerns about the safety of commercial shipping and civilian crew members. The debate, held under Bahrain's Council presidency, focused on the protection of Continued on P4

UAE says it will leave OPEC on May 1 in blow to oil cartel

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: The United Arab Emirates said Tuesday it will leave OPEC effective May 1, stripping the oil cartel of one of its largest producers and further weakening its leverage over global oil supplies and prices.

The UAE's decision had been rumoured as a possibility for some time, as it pushed back in recent years against OPEC production quotas it felt had been too low — meaning it wasn't able to sell as much oil to the world as it had wanted.

"Having invested heavily in expanding energy production capacity in recent years, the bigger picture is that the UAE has been itching to pump more oil," Capital Economics wrote in an analysis. "The ties binding OPEC members together have loosened," it said, particularly after Qatar withdrew from the cartel in 2019.

Regional politics are also likely at play. The UAE has had increasingly frosty relations with Saudi Arabia, OPEC's largest producer, over political and economic matters in the Mideast, even after both came under attack by fellow OPEC member Iran during the war.

The UAE's withdrawal from OPEC won't necessarily have any immediate effects in markets. That's because world oil supplies are sharply constrained by the war in Iran, which has closed off the Strait of Hormuz, a waterway through which one-fifth of global Continued on P4

After Kejriwal, Sisodia refuses to pursue excise case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: AAP leader Manish Sisodia on Tuesday said he will not participate in further proceedings before the Delhi High Court bench of Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma in connection with the excise policy case, aligning his stance with that of party chief Arvind Kejriwal.

Sisodia's decision comes a day after Kejriwal chose not to appear in person or be represented by legal counsel in the same court. In a letter addressed to Justice Sharma, Sisodia stated that no lawyer would represent him either. "No lawyer will appear on my behalf either. Your children's future is in the hands of Tushar Mehta," he wrote, adding, "I do not expect justice, there is no path left except Satyagraha." Continued on P4

WhatsApp banned 9,400 accounts involved in digital arrest scams since January 2026: Centre to SC

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A coordinated crackdown involving multiple government agencies, financial regulators, telecom operators and technology platforms is underway to address the surge in so-called "digital arrest" scams, the Centre has informed the Supreme Court. As part of the action, messaging platform WhatsApp has blocked 9,400 accounts linked to such frauds over the past three months.

Details of the enforcement measures were submitted in a status report by the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre, operating under the Ministry of Home Affairs, in compliance with court directions issued on February 9. The bench, led by Chief Justice Surya Kant, had taken suo motu cognisance of rising cyber fraud cases and directed Continued on P4

CLOSER LOOK

- **NEW SAFEGUARDS:** Fake logo detection, alerts for new accounts, hiding suspicious caller photos, SIM-binding (4–6 months)
- DoT and telcos to block fraudulent SIMs in 2–3 hours; Biometric Identity Verification System rollout by Dec 2026

SAY AIRLINE INDUSTRY ON VERGE OF 'STOPPING OPERATIONS'

AI, IndiGo, SpiceJet seek ATF price relief

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: India's airline industry has warned of a deepening financial strain as surging aviation turbine fuel costs, driven by global crude oil volatility, threaten the viability of both domestic and international operations. In a letter dated April 26 to the civil aviation ministry, the Federation of Indian Airlines, representing Air India, IndiGo and SpiceJet, said the sector is under "extreme stress" and could face a scenario where carriers are forced to halt operations if immediate relief is not provided.

At the centre of the crisis is a sharp rise in jet fuel prices, which have crossed Rs 2 lakh per kilolitre in recent revisions

At the centre of the crisis is a sharp rise in jet fuel prices, which have crossed Rs 2 lakh per kilolitre in recent revisions. Aviation turbine fuel, which typically makes up 30 to 40 per cent of an airline's operating costs, has now surged to as much as 55 to 60 per cent, sharply eroding margins. The increase is linked to escalating global crude oil prices amid tensions in West Asia, along with supply concerns around key routes such as the Strait of Hormuz.

Airlines said the impact has been compounded by currency depreciation and a widening gap between crude oil and ATF prices, known as the crack spread. "Any ad hoc pricing and irrational increase in ATF Continued on P4

Centre fixes OCI card application fee at $275, scraps six-month stay rule

NEW DELHI: The Centre has set a uniform fee of $275 for new Overseas Citizen of India cards, with payments to be made in Indian rupees for applications filed within the country and in local currency when submitted through Indian missions abroad, officials said on Tuesday. The revised structure replaces the earlier charge of Rs 15,000 for applicants in India.

According to the Bureau of Immigration, a fee of $25 will apply to requests for reissuance of OCI cards involving changes in personal details, issuance upon the holder attaining 20 years of age, or for renunciation. A higher fee of $100 will be charged in cases where the card has been lost. Continued on P4

'Roads cannot be blocked in name of religious activities, govt can interfere'

SC says each religious institution needs to have norms, there can't be anarchy

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday said that while religious denominations enjoy autonomy in matters of worship, such freedoms cannot extend to disrupting public order or secular activities, including blocking roads during religious events.

The observation came from a nine-judge Constitution bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh, Ahsanuddin Amanullah, Aravind Kumar, Augustine George Masih, Prasanna B Varale, R Mahadevan and Joymalya Bagchi. The bench is hearing a batch of petitions concerning women's entry and alleged discrimination at religious places, including the Sabarimala temple, and examining the scope of religious freedom across faiths.

On the ninth day of hearings, the court clarified that it cannot adjudicate on how a denomination chooses to worship. However, it drew a distinction when such practices spill into the public sphere. Continued on P4

People are seen waiting to offer prayers at the temple

TAKEAWAYS

- The bench clarified that constitutional protection covers rituals and observances, but is not absolute when they impact civic life
- The court stressed that managing religious institutions requires structure and norms
- The bench noted that regulation must remain within constitutional limits and avoid discrimination

India brings int'l drug trafficker Salim Dola from Türkiye

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: In a significant development in India's campaign against international narcotics networks, the Narcotics Control Bureau on Tuesday secured the return of fugitive trafficker Mohammad Salim Dola from Türkiye, marking the culmination of a long-running global manhunt under "Operation Global-Hunt." The 59-year-old, described by officials as a key figure in transnational drug operations and a close associate of Dawood Ibrahim, was taken into custody upon arrival at Indira Gandhi International Airport early Tuesday, shortly after being deported following his arrest abroad.

According to the Ministry of Home Affairs, Dola had been hiding in Türkiye for nearly two years after evading Indian law enforcement agencies in multiple narcotics cases. His arrest was facilitated through an Interpol Red Notice issued at India's request in March 2024, which Continued on P4

International drug trafficker Mohammed Salim Dola in NCB custody after he was brought back to India from Turkiye PTI

PARLIAMENT STREET

2 dead after bike collides with goods carrier: Cops

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two persons including a teenager were killed after a motorcycle collided with a goods carrier near Mahadev Road T-point on Ashoka Road in New Delhi's Parliament Street area, police said on Tuesday.

A PCR call regarding the accident was received during the night, following which a police team rushed to the spot opposite the PNB Complex. Upon arrival, officers found two persons lying unconscious on the road.

They were immediately shifted to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared them brought dead, police said.

The bodies have been preserved at the RML Hospital

The deceased were later identified as Yagya Bhatia (20), a BSc student, and Abhav Bhatia (14), a school student. Both are residents of Ashok Nagar.

Police said the accident involved a motorcycle and a goods carrier. The exact sequence of events leading to the collision is yet to be ascertained.

The district crime team was called to the scene, and a forensic examination of the spot was carried out to collect evidence.

The bodies have been preserved at the Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital mortuary for a postmortem examination, officials said.

A case has been registered under relevant sections of law based on the statement of an eyewitness. The offending vehicle has been identified, and efforts are underway to apprehend its driver, who is currently absconding. Further investigation in the matter is in progress, police added.

Jamia protest against RSS-linked 'Yuva Kumbh' turns tense, SFI alleges injuries

Student groups claim over 50 injured; varsity rejects claims

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A protest against an RSS-linked event in the Jamia Millia Islamia turned violent on Tuesday, as a scuffle broke out between the SFI-affiliated students and the varsity's security guards.

Students belonging to the Students' Federation of India (SFI) unit of Jamia alleged that they were injured in the clash, a claim denied by the administration.

The students were protesting against the university for hosting the 'Yuva Kumbh' programme to mark 100 years of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS). Personnel from the Delhi Police and Rapid

Action Force were deployed around the campus ahead of the protest. "Over 50 students were injured in the crackdown, with several beaten by guards... Several others were attacked and forcibly dragged by university guards," a statement by the SFI said.

However, a university official denied all the allegations.

"No such injuries were caused in the scuffle. Moreover, students have expressed objection to an event that was organised through proper channels," the official said. "Every student, irrespective of their affiliations to any organisation, has the right to approach us regarding any event. Moreover, the discussions in the Yuva Kumbh event on Tuesday were around topics like the future of the youth and the Indian knowledge system," the official added.

Other student groups face curbs, but RSS held a programme in an air-conditioned hall: AISA

The event had drawn objections a day earlier from the SFI's Jamia unit, which termed it a "direct provocation".

AISA Delhi president and Jamia student Saiyed alleged differential treatment by the university administration. "This is the same Jamia where other student groups are not even allowed to hold discussions without security intervention, but the RSS has been permitted to organise a full programme in an air-conditioned hall," he said.

He added that students would continue to resist similar events in the future to "defend our democratic rights".

Woman found dead at home in New Ashok Nagar: Police

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 21-year-old woman was found dead in suspected suicide circumstances at her residence in New Ashok Nagar, east Delhi, police said. A PCR call was received around 12.50 pm reporting the incident in a locked room in C-Block.

Police, along with fire officials, forced open the door and found her hanging from a ceiling fan. No suicide note was recovered.

The body was shifted to Lal Bahadur Shastri Hospital for post-mortem. Police said no foul play is suspected so far and inquest proceedings have been initiated. Investigations are underway to ascertain the circumstances.

On the 5th day of the week-long "Nasha – Not Cool" campaign, Delhi Police engaged chemists and pharmacists across markets and hospitals. Staff wore anti-drug armbands and displayed banners, while officers interacted with customers MPOST

Man arrested for killing co-worker

NEW DELHI: A 25-year-old man has been arrested for allegedly killing his co-worker following a quarrel in south Delhi's Malviya Nagar area, police said on Tuesday.

The incident took place on the intervening night of April 27 and 28 at a jhuggi. Police said a PCR call was received reporting a murder, following which a team reached the spot.

The complainant, Ranjit Yadav, told officers that a dispute had broken out earlier between the accused, Rakesh Kumar alias Kaily, and the victim, Shatrughan, but was later pacified.

However, around 1 am, Ranjit heard a noise and found that Rakesh had allegedly attacked Shatrughan on the neck with a wooden stick while he was asleep.

Victim was taken to AIIMS but declared dead. Police said the accused, allegedly drunk and enraged over phone use, was arrested and remanded to judicial custody. Investigation is underway to establish full sequence of events. MPOST

19-yr-old stabbed to death in Narela

Police scan CCTV, form teams

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 19-year-old man was found stabbed to death in Delhi's Narela Industrial Area on Sunday, police said.

The victim, identified as Mayank (19), son of Satish and a resident of Chauhan Wali Gali in Bhorgarh village, was discovered with multiple stab injuries near F-Block, Bhorgarh Phase-II Industrial Area, close to Kali Mata Mandir.

Police said they received a PCR call on April 27 reporting a man lying injured in the area. A team, accompanied by senior officers, rushed to the spot and found Mayank unconscious on the ground with several severe stab wounds, indicating a violent attack. He was immediately taken for medical examination but was declared brought dead by doctors. The body has been shifted to SRHC Hospital for post-mortem and further legal formalities.

A case has been registered under Section 103(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), pertaining to murder, and an investigation is underway.

Officials said all possible

A team rushed to the spot, found Mayank unconscious on the ground with several severe stab wounds

angles, including personal enmity and local disputes, are being explored to ascertain the motive. Multiple teams have been formed to identify and apprehend those responsible.

Police are scanning CCTV footage from nearby areas and questioning local residents to piece together the sequence of events. Forensic teams have also examined the crime scene and collected evidence.

The incident has caused concern among residents, with police assuring that those involved will be brought to justice.

Noida Airport gets BCAS nod

NOIDA: Noida International Airport has secured approval for its Aerodrome Security Program (ASP) from the Bureau of Civil Aviation Security (BCAS). The clearance confirms that the airport's security framework and procedures meet regulatory standards, paving the way for the next phase of preparations before commercial operations begin.

A official for the airport said the focus will now shift to coordinating with airlines and key stakeholders to finalise a mutually convenient date for launch. Officials said systems and staff are being readied for a seamless launch. Nitu Samra has been named interim CEO after BCAS declined approval for Christoph Schnellmann, who moves to vice chairman, as the delayed project nears operations. MPOST

Man, 60, dies in Paharganj house blaze; three rescued

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 60-year-old man died after sustaining severe burn injuries in a fire at a residential building in Paharganj, central Delhi, on Monday afternoon, police said.

A PCR call was received at around 2.45 pm on April 27, reporting a blaze at a third-floor house in the Chuna Mandi area. Police teams rushed to the spot and found three persons inside the premises, who were safely rescued.

During a subsequent

search, another occupant, identified as Ramesh (60), son of Prabhu Dayal, was found trapped in a room locked from within. He had suffered extensive burn injuries.

Fire brigade teams reached the site and brought the blaze under control after firefighting operations. Ramesh was immediately taken to Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, where doctors declared him brought dead.

Officials said the exact cause of the fire is yet to be ascertained. A crime team has inspected the site and collected evidence, while statements of those rescued and other witnesses are being recorded. Preliminary findings suggest the fire originated within the residential premises, though all possibilities remain under examination.

PROJ TO ENHANCE OVERALL ROAD SAFETY

Noida Authority clears ₹43.13 cr road safety plan for expressway

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: The Noida Authority has approved a major road safety initiative aimed at reducing accidents along the Noida–Greater Noida Expressway. Under the plan, W-Beam crash barriers will be installed along nearly 20 km of service roads to prevent vehicles from veering off into hazardous zones.

The project has been sanctioned with a budget of Rs 43.13 crore, and tenders are expected to be floated soon following final approval from the Chief Executive Officer.

Officials said the move is to address rising traffic concerns, especially in view of the upcoming Noida International

Tenders expected to be floated soon after final approval from the Chief Executive Officer

Airport, which is expected to significantly increase vehicular movement on the corridor. Authorities noted that several stretches between the main carriageway and service roads have deep drains, posing serious risks to commuters. The installation of crash barriers is expected to reduce such dangers and minimise loss of life and property.

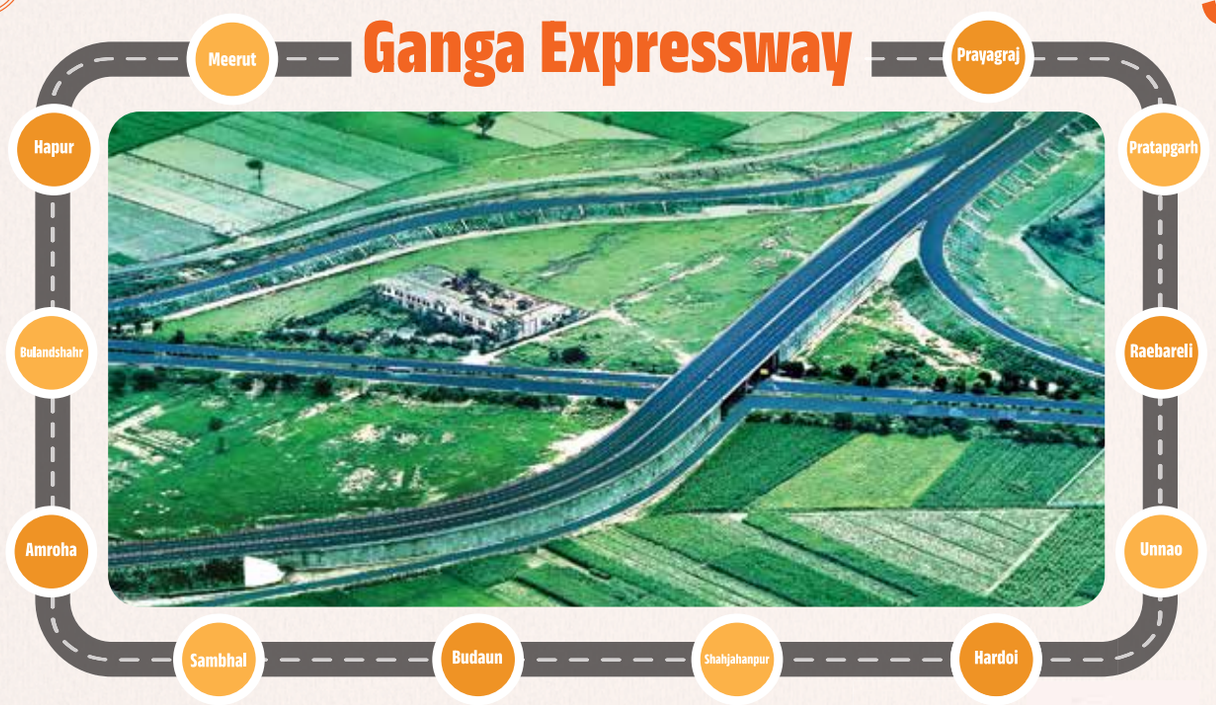
W-Beam crash barriers are semi-rigid metal safety structures commonly used on highways and bridges. Made of corrugated, W-shaped galvanized steel about 3 mm thick, they are designed to absorb impact energy and redirect errant vehicles back onto the road. This reduces the severity of collisions and prevents vehicles from plunging into ditches or hitting roadside obstacles.

The Noida Authority stated that the project will enhance overall road safety and contribute to developing the expressway into a more secure and modern transit corridor. Similar safety measures may be introduced in the future to ensure safer and smoother traffic movement across the city.

Guided by Maa Ganga, Driven by Progress

Navnirman Ke 9 Varsh

Ganga Expressway



Inauguration of Uttar Pradesh's grand 594-km long Ganga Expressway (Meerut-Prayagraj) built at a cost of ₹36,230 Crore

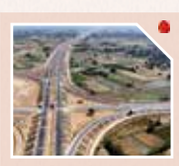
by

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

Progress in Full Speed : 6 lane (expandable to 8 lane) Ganga Expressway connects 12 districts • Designed for speed 120 km/hr; Meerut to Prayagraj distance to be covered in 6-8 hours • Long bridges spanning 960 m over the Ganga river at Hapur and 720 m over the Ramganga river at Budaun • 21 ramp interchanges including 2 main entry-exit gates at Meerut and Prayagraj • Fully access-controlled Greenfield Ganga Expressway is equipped with Advanced Traffic Management System (ATMS) • 3.50 km long airstrip near Shahjahanpur for emergency landing and take-off of fighter aircrafts • 3.75 m wide staggered service lanes on both sides of the expressway

Development and Welfare : 9 large Public Facility Centres with fuel and e-charging facilities • Industrial corridor development underway across 12 districts of Ganga Expressway • Rapid connectivity to Delhi for industrial units and agricultural production zones • Increased revenue in agricultural, commercial, tourism and industrial sectors • New centres for storage and processing of milk, fruits and vegetables • Expansion of trade and employment opportunities; boost to tourism • Immense potential for new Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs), higher education and medical institutions

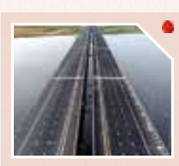
In the august presence of



Anandiben Patel
Governor, Uttar Pradesh

Yogi Adityanath
Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh

Pankaj Chaudhary, Minister of State, Finance, Government of India
Jitin Prasada, Minister of State, Commerce and Industry, Electronics and Information Technology, Government of India
Keshav Prasad Maurya, Deputy Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh
Brajesh Pathak, Deputy Chief Minister, Uttar Pradesh



Suresh Kumar Khanna, Minister, Finance and Parliamentary Affairs, Uttar Pradesh
Nand Gopal Gupta 'Nandi', Minister, Industrial Development, Export Promotion, NRI and Investment Promotion, Uttar Pradesh
Nitin Agrawal, Minister of State (Independent Charge), Excise and Prohibition, Uttar Pradesh
Asim Arun, Minister of State (Independent Charge), Social Welfare, Scheduled Caste and Tribal Welfare, Uttar Pradesh
Jayendra Pratap Singh Rathore, Minister of State (Independent Charge), Cooperative, Uttar Pradesh
Narendra Kumar Kashyap, Minister of State (Independent Charge), Backward Class Welfare, Divyangjan Empowerment, Uttar Pradesh
Jaswant Singh Saini, Minister of State, Parliamentary Affairs, Industrial Development, Uttar Pradesh
Rajni Tiwari, Minister of State, Higher Education, Uttar Pradesh
Jai Prakash, Member of Parliament, Hardoi
Ashok Kumar Rawat, Member of Parliament, Misrikh
Arun Kumar Sagar, Member of Parliament, Shahjahanpur
Dr. Swami Sachidanand Hari Sakshi Maharaj, Member of Parliament, Unnao
Mithilesh Kumar, Member, Rajya Sabha
Shakun Singh, Chairman, District Panchayat, Unnao
Mamta Yadav, Chairman, District Panchayat, Shahjahanpur
Priya Shakya, Chairman, District Panchayat, Kannauj
Premavati P.K. Verma, Chairman, District Panchayat, Hardoi
Archana Verma, Mayor, Shahjahanpur
Madhavendra Pratap Singh, MLA, Sawaijpur
Shyam Prakash, MLA, Gopamau
Prabhash Kumar, MLA, Sandi
Ashish Kumar Singh 'Ashu', MLA, Bilgram-Mallawan
Rampal Verma, MLA, Balamau
Alka Singh 'Arkvanshi', MLA, Sandila
Hari Prakash Verma, MLA, Jalalabad
Archana Pandey, MLA, Chhibramau
Pankaj Gupta, MLA, Unnao
Kailash Rajput, MLA, Tirwa
Ashutosh Shukla, MLA, Bhagwantnagar
Arvind Kumar Singh, MLA, Dadraul
Shrikant Katiyar, MLA, Bangermau
Salona Kushwaha, MLA, Tihar
Anil Kumar Singh, MLA, Purwa
Chetram, MLA, Powayan
Bamba Lal, MLA, Safipur
Dr. Veer Vikram Singh 'Prince', MLA, Katra
Brajesh Kumar, MLA, Mohan
Arun Pathak, MLC
Dr. Manvendra Pratap Singh, MLC
Er. Awanish Kumar Singh, MLC
Dr. Sudhir Gupta, MLC
Ashok Agarwal, MLC
Umesh Dwivedi, MLC
Ram Chandra Pradhan, MLC
Pranshu Dutt Dwivedi, MLC
Dr. Akash Agarwal, MLC

and other dignitaries

Date: 29th April, 2026 | Time: 10:00 AM | Venue: Mallawan cut, near chainage 351 km Ganga Expressway, Tehsil-Bilgram, District-Hardoi, U.P.

Superfast State - Uttar Pradesh : 8 expressways operational, 14 in various development stages • 55% of the country's total expressways in Uttar Pradesh • Industrial Corridors at 27 locations of 26 districts along the expressways • Implementation of Atal Industrial Infrastructure Mission for industrial development • Uttar Pradesh is a leading state in implementing PM Gati Shakti • Work underway for establishing Integrated Manufacturing Clusters at Prayagraj and Agra under the Amritsar–Kolkata Industrial Corridor • Junction of the Eastern and Western Dedicated Freight Corridors located at Dadri, Uttar Pradesh • Largest rail network in the country in Uttar Pradesh (16,000 km) • 17 airports operational (5 international airports), 7 in various development stages • Work in progress for extending National Waterway-1 (Varanasi-Haldia) up to Ayodhya

Vikas ki Gati Apaar-Double Engine Sarkar

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STORMY SESSION SEES SHARP POLITICAL CLASH

Women's quota defeat: Delhi House passes censure motion against Oppn

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: A stormy special session of the Delhi Assembly on Tuesday witnessed sharp political confrontation as the House passed a censure motion against the Opposition over the recent defeat of the Women's Reservation Bill in Parliament, with Chief Minister Rekha Gupta calling the episode "a black chapter of Indian democracy".

Moving the motion, Gupta accused Opposition parties of indulging in "narrow political gains" and "conspiring" to block a historic opportunity for women's representation. "Women across the country were watching Parliament with hope that their 78-year-long wait would end. What happened instead was deeply disappointing," she said, adding, "It was a sad day and a black chapter of our democracy."

The Chief Minister asserted that the Centre, under Prime Minister Narendra Modi, had taken a decisive step through the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam to ensure 33 percent reservation for women in legislatures. However, she alleged that the Opposition stalled its implementation on "technical grounds" to delay women's empowerment. "This is not just about a Bill, but about the dignity and rights of half the population," she said.

Gupta also launched a sharp attack on Opposition leaders, stating that "those who speak of women's empowerment step back when it is time to act." Targeting Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi, she remarked, "Priyanka Gandhi gave the 'Ladki Hun Lad Sakti Hun' slogan, and herself ran away when women were fighting for their rights."

The session saw high drama as AAP members walked out, alleging they were not allowed to speak freely. Speaker Vijender Gupta rejected the charge, saying every member was given time and that the Opposition "created drama" to avoid listening to ruling party members. In a symbolic gesture, BJP MLA Shikha Roy was invited by Speaker Vijender Gupta to conduct proceedings for a brief period.

Earlier, BJP MLAs, along with ministers, staged a protest inside the Assembly wearing black armbands. Health Minister Dr Pankaj Kumar Singh said, "If there was genuine intent, the Opposition would have supported the Bill instead of creating excuses to derail it." He added, "This is not just about a Bill; it is about the dignity and rightful representation of crores of women."

Cabinet Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa termed the Opposition's stand a historic mistake, saying, "History will not forgive those who played politics with women's rights." He added that the Bill would have ensured representation for "our sisters and daughters" in key legislative bodies. Opposition members, however, hit back, questioning the BJP's record on women's leadership and alleging that the Bill was being used for electoral gains. They also raised concerns over issues such as delimitation and seat expansion.

Despite the heated exchanges, the ruling BJP pushed through the censure motion by voice vote, framing the debate as a larger battle over women's rights and political intent. The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill failed to pass in the Lok Sabha after being voted down by opposition parties. The proposed legislation aimed to raise the total number of Lok Sabha seats from the existing 543 to as many as 816, in order to facilitate the implementation of women's reservation ahead of the 2029 general elections. This expansion was to be carried out through a delimitation exercise based on the 2011 Census.

> **"Women across the country were watching Parliament with hope that their 78-year-long wait would end. What happened instead was deeply disappointing... It was a sad day and a black chapter of our democracy**
>
> **— CM Rekha**

CM Rekha Gupta leads torch march in Delhi over Women's Reservation Bill

NEW DELHI: A large group of women, led by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Delhi BJP president Virendra Sachdeva, took out a torch march in Connaught Place on Tuesday, protesting against opposition parties over the Women's Reservation Bill and holding a public awareness campaign on the issue. Women from diverse backgrounds, including doctors, teachers, advocates and homemakers, participated in the "Mashal Jaloos", which was organised to express support for the Nari Shakti Vandan Act introduced by the Centre and to criticise opposition parties for allegedly attempting to stall it.

Addressing the gathering, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched a sharp attack on opposition leaders, saying, "The opposition cannot see beyond the women of their own families, due to which an ordinary woman can neither contest elections nor reach the Lok Sabha." She added, "The way the opposition has, on one pretext or another, violated women's rights, the anger in the hearts of women across the country has now come out from homes onto the streets."

Gupta also said that the Women's Reservation Bill had been introduced multiple times in Parliament over the years but was repeatedly blocked. MPOST

Relief: DJB plans 250 school water ATMs

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Jal Board is planning to install 250 water ATMs in schools as a measure to tackle heatwave and adverse weather conditions in the national capital, officials said on Tuesday.

Under the Delhi government's action plan, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has announced several measures that were being implemented in the city to tackle the heatwave. One of which is installing more water ATMs in schools, bus queue shelters, and other public spaces, they said.

"The aim is to provide regular, safe, and clean drinking water to children studying in government, government-aided, and local body schools, as well as to residents and passersby, thereby reducing dependence on tanker water," the officials said.

As per the plan, the machines will be equipped with a GPS for showing real-time location and the facility of remote monitoring, auto-flushing, and self-regulation of key processes, ensuring minimal human intervention. "Each machine will have four to six taps, and the water will go through four levels of filtration before being supplied in schools," an official added. The work has to be completed in three months. The schools in Delhi have also been directed to ring a bell every 45-60 minutes to remind students to drink water and pair them up in a "buddy system" to monitor each other's health. These were part of fresh precautionary measures issued by the Directorate of Education (DoE) last week for Delhi government schools, aided schools, and private unaided recognised schools. This comes as the India Meteorological Department (IMD) warned of a likely heatwave and adverse weather conditions in the national capital in the coming days. During a recent review meeting with all the departments, Gupta also directed the DoE to make arrangements for the ORS solution across schools in Delhi.

Zoo turns to cool tricks for animals

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Watermelons and succulent fruits become staple feed, citrus ice cubes cool down parched primate palates and elephants line up for three showers daily — summer at the National Zoological Park here brings with it a full-scale cooling plan as heatwave conditions grip the capital. With temperatures rising, the Delhi zoo has made special arrangements to protect animals from stress, dehydration and heat stroke during peak summer months.

An official said animals are provided a seasonal diet to help maintain hydration and body temperature, with fruits such as watermelon, muskmelon, sweet lime ('mosambi') and apples included in their daily meals. Primates are also being provided fruit ice cubes as a cooling supplement.

For carnivores, the diet has been adjusted — reducing heavy feed intake and increasing water consumption. Regular showers are also being provided to help them endure the extreme heat, he said.

The official said coolers have been installed and are being operated in retiring cells and animal shelters, to keep them comfortable.

Elephants are being bathed three times a day to prevent overheating, and proper hydration is being ensured, he added.

For herbivores, sprinklers have been installed inside enclosures to maintain soil moisture, reduce the impact of dry heat, and keep the surroundings cooler, he said, adding that the zoo's veterinary team is adding glucose and electrolyte powder to drinking water whenever required to prevent dehydration and weakness among animals.

Duty refusal lands 142 teachers in TROUBLE

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: The district magistrate of Old Delhi has asked the director of education to terminate the services of 142 guest teachers for allegedly refusing to perform their statutory duty as census enumerators, terming the act "gross negligence and indiscipline".

In a letter to the director of education dated April 24, the magistrate said, "The teachers declined to carry out assigned census work despite an earlier communication issued on April 16 highlighting the difficulties caused by their unwillingness to participate in the exercise."

Commenting on the issue, Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood said that census is a matter of national importance which everyone should support.

"We will look into the matter and consider the special cases sympathetically," Sood said.

The magistrate said the refusal amounted to gross negligence, dereliction of duty and was detrimental to public interest.

"It is being informed that 142 guest teachers have refused to perform the above-mentioned duty. The list is attached for reference," the letter said.

The magistrate requested that their services be discontinued or terminated with immediate effect, saying that tolerating such acts of indiscipline could affect other staff members currently engaged in census duty.

He also said that allowing such non-compliance could disrupt the census process and weaken discipline among the employees performing the same statutory responsibility.

However, the teachers claimed that they have not received any termination letter yet.

Meanwhile, the Government Teachers Association (GTA) of Delhi has requested Sood to withdraw the proposed termination of the guest teachers.

GTA general secretary Ajay Veer wrote to Sood that all the concerned guest teachers are working on annual contracts, which are scheduled to expire on May 8.

Veer claimed the refusal to join census duty was not an act of deliberate disobedience but a result of practical difficulties, lack of adequate resources and extremely low remuneration.

He said there had been no increase in the daily remuneration of guest teachers for nearly eight years, and the existing amount was insufficient even to meet basic expenses such as commuting.

"The remuneration is not even adequate to meet basic expenses, making the discharge of such duties practically unviable," he said.

Veer urged the authorities to withdraw the proposed termination and ensure that the annual contracts of the guest teachers are not discontinued during the summer vacation.

He also demanded that guest teachers continue to receive regular remuneration without any interruption and be given additional honorarium for census duty, similar to the extra payment provided to regular teachers over and above their salaries for the exercise.

L-G reviews NDMC heatwave plan

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Tuesday visited the Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC) at Palika Kendra to review the Summer Action Plan and ongoing heatwave mitigation measures.

The L-G's official X handle posted that the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) command centre serves as the digital nerve center of the capital, using Internet of Things (IoT)-based systems to integrate services — from water management to environmental monitoring.

"This technology-enabled model of governance has potential for replication in urban local bodies across the country to improve civic delivery," the L-G said in a post.

As India moves toward a "Viksit Bharat", the L-G said Delhi's role remains central, with New Delhi symbolising that vision. "While the technological capabilities are commendable, the real priority shall be strong on-ground execution to protect vulnerable communities and frontline workers," the L-G's post read.

He said the administration is committed to supporting and strengthening resilient and citizen-centric urban governance.

According to officials, the NDMC has already issued a special circular directing departments such as horticulture, civil engineering, sanitation, and health to ensure availability of ORS packets, safe drinking water, protective gear, and revised working hours for field staff so as to minimise exposure during peak heat hours.

Public awareness campaigns through information, education, and communication activities and social media are also being conducted extensively, officials said.

NDMC chairperson Keshav Chandra said the ICCC was inaugurated in September 2020 under the Smart City Mission and has since emerged as a key governance platform.

"It integrates more than 49 civic services, including solid waste management, street lighting, parking systems, sewage treatment plants, sanitation operations, and emergency response mechanisms," Chandra said.

NDMC Vice-chairman Kuljeet Singh Chahal said with advanced technologies such as GIS mapping, supervisory control and data acquisition integration, and GPS-enabled waste management systems, NDMC has elevated urban governance to new benchmarks of precision and efficiency.

Ahead of Mayoral polls, BJP sets 15-mth target to clear landfill

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi BJP president Virendra Sachdeva on Tuesday urged party councillors, in a meeting ahead of the April 29 mayoral polls, to ensure cleanliness across every street and road in the city.

Sachdeva said councillors, along with their MLAs, should commit to maintaining cleanliness while the MCD works to clear all three landfill sites in the next 15 months.

According to the statement, the meeting held at the party's state headquarters is to ensure a unified front as the electoral college prepares to elect the next mayor, deputy mayor and three vacant seats in the standing committee for Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) elections.

Newly inducted into the BJP, Rajya Sabha MP Swati Maliwal attended the meeting for the first time.

The electoral college for this year's mayoral election comprises 273 votes, including 249 councillors, 14 MLAs nominated by the Delhi Assembly, seven Lok Sabha MPs, and three Rajya Sabha members from Delhi who will decide the mayor. A candidate requires 137 votes to win the election.

The BJP has already fielded Pravesh Wahi, a seasoned three-term councillor from Rohini-East, as its mayoral candidate.

With AAP opting out of the contest and the Congress nominating Haji Zarif, it is likely that the BJP candidate is going to sail through, as the incumbents hold the majority.

With the recent induction of AAP's seven Rajya Sabha members into the party's fold, the BJP's sole focus is on capitalising on its strengthened numbers in the 273-member electoral college.

Going by current numbers, the BJP holds an edge with 143 votes, including 123 councillors, seven Lok Sabha and two Rajya Sabha MPs and 11 MLAs. The AAP has 105 votes, comprising 100 councillors, three MLAs, and two Rajya Sabha members, with Swati Maliwal recently quitting the party and joining the BJP.

Within the saffron camp, senior leaders emphasised that the new Mayor would prioritise resolving the administrative deadlock and fast-tracking civic projects across the city. Meanwhile, the Indraprastha Vikas Party, which splintered from AAP, has 15 councillors; the Congress has nine; two are independents; and one seat is vacant.

On Monday, Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta nominated 14 legislators to the MCD mayoral poll electoral college, with 11 MLAs from the BJP and three from AAP.

Further, the next full general election for all 250 wards of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) is likely to be held in 2027, as the current term of the House is five years from its first meeting in late 2022. The mayor's term, as per the Delhi Municipal Corporation (DMC) Act, is only one year.

The MPs, who hold vital voting rights in the MCD alongside the newly nominated 14 MLAs, reviewed the strategy to ensure a seamless victory for their candidate, Pravesh Wahi, party officials said.

The meeting was addressed by Sachdeva and Union Minister of State Harsh Malhotra and attended by MPs Manoj Tiwari, Yogender Chandolia and Kamaljeet Sehrawat, among others.

Current Mayor Raja Iqbal Singh, mayoral candidate Pravesh Wahi, deputy mayoral candidate Monika Pant, and Standing Committee candidates Jaibhagwan Yadav and Manish Chadha were also present. Singh thanked councillors for their support during his tenure as Mayor and earlier as Leader of the Opposition.

Student body alleges textbook delay in government schools

Minister says distribution by April 30

NEW DELHI: Students in Classes 1 to 8 at several Delhi government schools are still waiting for textbooks, nearly a month after the new academic session began, a student body said on Tuesday.

However, Delhi Education Minister Ashish Sood said the process of textbook distribution is underway, and all books for students will be distributed by April 30. The Democratic Youth Federation of India (DYFI) said in a statement that the delay is affecting students' studies and holiday homework ahead of summer vacations.

DYFI Delhi state secretary Aman Saini said many children from poor and middle-class families studying in government schools could not afford to buy books from the open market and depended on timely distribution by schools. The student body said its members visited schools in Yamuna Vihar and other districts and found that students of Classes 6, 7 and 8 have not received textbooks.

The DYFI claimed that senior advocate Ashok Agarwal has also approached the High Court on the issue.

The organisation urged the government to ensure immediate textbook distribution so that students do not face further academic disruption. PTI

AS VIRENDRA SACHDEVA'S TERM ENDS

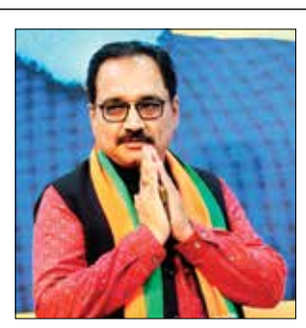
Race for Delhi BJP chief's post heats up

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: With the West Bengal elections nearing a close, the race for the Delhi BJP president's post has picked up pace with some party insiders citing the names of NDMC vice-chairman Kuljeet Chahal and Union minister Harsh Malhotra as among the top contenders.

However, one section of leaders said that incumbent Delhi BJP chief Virendra Sachdeva is expected to get a second term in view of the party's historic victory in the Delhi polls held last February.

Sachdeva completed three years in office in March.



According to the BJP's constitution, the state president's term is three years, with a maximum of two consecutive terms.

Under Sachdeva's leadership, the BJP won 48 out of 70 seats in the Assembly polls to form the government in Delhi after 27 years.

Earlier, the party maintained its track record of winning all seven Lok Sabha seats in Delhi in 2024 under Sachdeva's presidentship.

Sources in the party said the national leadership is likely to take a call on the top post in the Delhi BJP after the Assembly elections are complete in West Bengal. The second and final phase of Bengal polls will be held on Wednesday, and the results will be declared on May 4. Sachdeva was nominated as the working president of Delhi BJP in December 2022. He became a full-time chief in March 2023.

"The national leadership will decide the leader from which community becomes the Delhi BJP chief," a senior BJP functionary said.

Chahal, the vice-chairman of the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC), is a Jat, while Sachdeva, Malhotra and Babbar are Punjabis.

Names of other leaders, such as Jai Prakash, are also doing the rounds as the next president of the Delhi BJP. Jai Prakash belongs to the Gujjar community.

Chahal, who is also the national convener of the NaMo app, is considered close to the national leadership, while Union minister Harsh Malhotra is learnt to be close to the RSS, party leaders said.

Govt plans to start FNB prog at GTB Hospital

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has decided to start a Fellowship of National Board (FNB) programme in paediatric emergency medicine at Guru Tegh Bahadur Hospital, with an intake of two seats per year, officials said on Wednesday. The move is aimed at strengthening specialised care for children in critical condition and enhancing super-specialty training capacity in the national capital, an official statement said.

The hospital caters to around 30,000-35,000 paediatric emergency patients annually and has been witnessing a growing need for structured training in paediatric emergency medicine. The introduction of the programme is expected to improve the quality of care and help reduce under-five mortality, it added. The FNB course, conducted under the National Board of Examinations, is a two-year post-MD super-specialty programme equivalent to senior residency. Trainees will be accommodated against existing vacant senior resident posts, ensuring no additional financial burden on the exchequer. "Strengthening paediatric emergency care is a priority for the Delhi government. This step will enhance specialist training capacity and ensure better, timely treatment for children...," Delhi Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said.

From Page 1

CAPF cover

number of candidates (19), while Goghat in Hooghly has the lowest (5).

In terms of electorate size, Bhatpara in North 24-Parganas has the smallest voter base at 1.17 lakh, while Chinsurah in Hooghly has the highest at over 2.75 lakh.

Arrangements include 8,845 all-women-managed booths, 13 PwD-managed stations and 258 model polling stations. A total of 55,331 ballot units, 55,162 control units and 59,463 VVPAT machines will be deployed.

In the 2021 Assembly elections, the Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress won 123 of these 142 seats. While the BJP secured 77 seats statewide, it won only 18 in this region.

The Election Commission is deploying 2,343 companies of Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF), averaging about three personnel per booth — among the highest such deployments in recent elections.

North 24-Parganas has been allotted the highest share at 517 companies, followed by South 24-Parganas (413). Kolkata, with 5,172 booths and 274 companies, will see an average of 3.8 CAPF personnel per booth, supplemented by mobile patrols and reserve forces.

Howrah will have 258 companies, Nadia 287, Hooghly 323 and East Burdwan 276.

Chief Electoral Officer Manoj Agarwal announced a control room number (18003450008) for complaints related to intimidation or obstruction of voting. "We will immediately alert the concerned police authorities for intervention," he said, adding that 3,000 arrests had been made till Tuesday evening. Nearly 30% of booths — around 12,000 — have been identified as sensitive.

Twenty-six senior officers deployed during the first phase will continue in the second phase to boost voter confidence.

Strict enforcement of Section 163 of the BNSS (earlier Section 144) will be in place within a 100-metre radius of polling stations. Booth premises will be demarcated to prevent unauthorised entry and impersonation. The Commission has warned of strict action against officials found guilty of bias or negligence.

All polling stations will have 100 per cent webcasting, with two cameras per booth — one inside to monitor polling activity and one outside to track queue management and potential disturbances. Sensitive booths will have additional internal surveillance. Monitoring systems will also be set up at district control rooms and Returning Officer offices.

Voters will undergo two levels of verification: identity checks by central forces at the entrance, followed by confirmation at Voter Assistance Booths by Booth Level Officers before entering the voting compartment.

Among high-profile contests, Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee faces Leader of the Opposition Suvendu Adhikari in Bhowanipore.

Other prominent candidates include Firhad Hakim (Kolkata Port), Chandrima Bhattacharya (Dum Dum Uttar), Shashi Panja (Shyampukur), Aroop Biswas (Tollygunge), Bratya Basu (Dum Dum) and Sujit Basu (Bidhannagar).

EC adds 1468

He added that even if all pending cases were disposed of, deletions would have been minimal.

With the addition of 1,468 names, the total electorate for the second phase stands at 3.21 crore. Polling will be held across 142 Assembly constituencies on Wednesday.

The TMC said that removing six names out of 1,474 reflects a deletion rate of 0.4 per cent. It argued that such findings undermine the rationale behind the SIR exercise, reiterating that those flagged were "genuine electors" whose voting rights were being curtailed. The party also claimed that many of these voters, despite being cleared, would still be unable to vote on April 29 as their names would not appear on the rolls.

The additions have been made following directions of the Supreme Court of India, after applicants were cleared by appellate tribunals. According to the supplementary list, 677 names have been added in Kolkata South and 596 in Kolkata North. Other additions include 77 in Howrah, 39 in Nadia, 34 in North 24-Parganas, 30 in South 24-Parganas, eight in East Burdwan and seven in Hooghly. All these voters will be eligible to cast their ballots in this phase.

However, the Commission has not specified how many cases were disposed of by tribunals before the second phase. Ahead of the first phase, 657 cases were disposed of, with 139 voters added to the rolls and eight names deleted, while the rest were rejected due to procedural errors.

The apex court had directed that individuals whose cases were decided up to two days before polling, and who were subsequently found eligible, must be allowed to vote. ECI officials said the supplementary roll was prepared based on tribunal decisions up to Monday.

Following the SIR of West Bengal's electoral rolls, over 60 lakh voters were placed under adjudication. Of these, around 33 lakh names were cleared while 27 lakh were deleted. The court had allowed aggrieved voters to appeal before tribunals headed by retired judges.

Polling in this phase will cover constituencies across Kolkata (North and South), South 24-Parganas, North 24-Parganas, Howrah, Hooghly, Nadia and East Burdwan.

UAE says it

oil supplies — including much of the UAE's — is transported.

On Tuesday, Brent crude, the international benchmark, traded above $111 a barrel, or more than 50% above its pre-war price.

OPEC's market power had already been waning in recent years as the United States ramped up its production of crude oil. Saudi Arabia had been pumping over 10 million barrels of oil a day before the war. The US pumps more than 13 million barrels a day.

US President Donald Trump has been a steady critic of the cartel during his two terms in the White House.

The UAE, which joined OPEC through its emirate of Abu Dhabi in 1967, had been producing around 3.4 million barrels of crude a day just before the US-Israeli war with Iran began on Feb 28. Analysts say it has capacity to produce roughly 5 million barrels a day.

In its announcement on Tuesday, made via its state-run WAM news agency, the UAE said it also would leave the wider OPEC+ group, which Russia had led to try to stabilise oil prices.

"This decision reflects the UAE's long-term strategic and economic vision and evolving energy profile, including accelerated investment in domestic energy production," the UAE said, adding that it would bring "additional production to market in a gradual and measured manner, aligned with demand and market conditions."

The UAE's withdrawal removes one of OPEC's few members with the ability to quickly increase production, said Jorge Leon, head of geopolitical analysis at Rystad Energy.

"A structurally weaker OPEC, with less spare capacity concentrated within the group, will find it increasingly difficult to calibrate supply and stabilise prices," he said.

Saudi Arabia and the UAE increasingly have competed over economic issues and regional politics, particularly in the Red Sea area.

The two countries had jointly fought against Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi rebels in 2015. However, that coalition broke down into recriminations in late December, when Saudi Arabia bombed what it described as a weapons shipment bound for Yemeni separatists backed by the UAE.

As tensions rose in recent months, Saudi broadcasters long based in Dubai, the economic hub of the UAE, have pulled back to the kingdom.

"This exit of OPEC fits into the UAE need for flexibility with key energy consumers as well -- including a future relationship with China and a more competitive relationship with Saudi Arabia," said Karen Young, a senior research scholar at Columbia University's Center on Global Energy Policy.

The UAE hosted the United Nations COP28 climate talks in 2023, a conference that ended for the first time with a pledge by nearly 200 countries to move away from planet-warming fossil fuels. But the UAE still plans to increase its production capacity in the coming years, even as it pursues more clean energy at home, a move decried by climate activists.

"The demand for power is going to go up and up and up," US Interior Secretary Doug Burgum told an Abu Dhabi oil conference in November. "Today's the day to announce that there is no energy transition. There is only energy addition."

He drew widespread applause from his Emirati hosts.

US unmoved by Iran offer

Since the war began, at least 3,375 people have been killed in Iran and at least 2,521 people in Lebanon, where fighting between Israel and the Iran-backed Hezbollah militant group resumed two days after the Iran war started.

Another 23 people have been killed in Israel and more than a dozen in Gulf Arab states. Sixteen Israeli soldiers in Lebanon, 13 U.S. service members in the region and six U.N. peacekeepers in southern Lebanon have been killed.

United Nations General Assembly President Annalena Baerbock said urgent efforts to secure a ceasefire in the Iran war are critical.

During a visit on Tuesday to India, Baerbock warned the conflict is disrupting global supplies and deepening regional crises, with attacks and blockades in the Strait of Hormuz increasing oil and fertilizer prices worldwide.

"Every effort to come to a ceasefire is highly needed," Baerbock said, adding that the escalation is diverting attention from humanitarian crises in Gaza. "It overshadows the devastating situation for the people in Gaza. The humanitarian situation in Gaza is still heartbreaking."

President Trump on Tuesday claimed that Iran "has just" informed the US that it is in a "state of collapse".

"They want us to "Open the Hormuz Strait," as soon as possible, as they try to figure out their leadership situation," Trump posted on social media.

He added that he believes they will be able to sort out reported divisions within the Islamic Republic government about negotiations with the US.

India to get

in Operation Sindoor, underscoring their operational significance.

Last month, New Delhi approved procurement of five additional S-400 units, doubling the planned fleet to 10. Sources indicated that concerns over potential US sanctions under the Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act are unlikely to affect the new order, describing it as a follow-on to the existing deal.

Russian teams have already trained Indian personnel to operate the system, regarded as one of the most advanced long-range air defence platforms globally.

At UNSC, India calls

waterways in the maritime domain.

"As a major trading nation, India strongly deplores the recent targeting of commercial shipping through the Strait of Hormuz and the endangerment of innocent civilian crew members," Patel said, noting that such incidents have led to the loss of Indian lives.

India is among the world's top three suppliers of seafarers, accounting for around 13 per cent of the global workforce in the sector. Highlighting the human cost of disruptions, Patel said New Delhi remains deeply concerned about the safety and welfare of its nationals working at sea.

The government has reiterated that freedom of navigation must be upheld in line with international law, including principles under the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea. It stressed that any "purported closure" or obstruction of vital maritime routes affects not only trade but also energy and humanitarian supply chains.

Data shared by the Ministry of External Affairs last month indicated that eight Indian nationals have died and one remains missing in separate incidents linked to the ongoing regional tensions.

India outlined several priority areas requiring urgent attention, including ensuring navigational safety, maintaining supply chains with a focus on humanitarian needs, improving maritime situational awareness and strengthening communication systems for seafarers.

Patel also pointed to measures already undertaken by India, including a 24-hour helpline operated by the Directorate General of Shipping. The service has received nearly 7,500 calls and over 15,000 emails from seafarers of various nationalities seeking assistance.

Reaffirming its position, India said it remains committed to promoting a free, open and rules-based maritime order, while working towards secure waterways that support global stability and economic continuity. AGENCIES

Centre to SC

agencies including the Reserve Bank of India and the Department of Telecommunications to jointly develop a framework for victim compensation.

The report, filed through Attorney General R Venkataramani, outlines actions taken since January 2026. It notes that WhatsApp launched a targeted, multi-week investigation into digital arrest scams affecting Indian users. The company adopted a structured approach involving detection of initial signals, mapping of networks, enforcement across linked accounts and deployment of automated safeguards at scale.

Among new measures, WhatsApp has introduced systems to identify and remove accounts displaying official-looking police or government insignia. It is also considering features to alert users when they receive calls from newly created or unverified accounts, which are often associated with scams. Another planned safeguard would automatically hide profile photos of suspicious unknown callers to prevent misuse of visual cues that suggest authority.

On the telecom front, the Department of Telecommunications and service providers have agreed to stricter timelines for disabling fraudulent SIM cards. A proposed mechanism aims to block suspicious SIMs within two to three hours of detection, significantly reducing the window for fraudulent activity.

The report further states that the Central Bureau of Investigation has set a threshold of Rs 10 crore in losses for taking over digital arrest cases. The agency has already re-registered three major cases, including two in Gujarat involving large-scale financial fraud and one in Delhi where a victim was allegedly defrauded of Rs 22.92 crore.

A high-level inter-departmental committee held its third meeting on March 12, bringing together stakeholders from telecom, banking and technology sectors. One of its key proposals is the introduction of a Biometric Identity Verification System to enable real-time monitoring of SIM card issuance across networks. The Department of Telecommunications has been tasked with implementing this system by December 2026.

In parallel, WhatsApp has committed to additional safeguards, including a SIM-binding mechanism expected to be rolled out within four to six months. This feature would require an active, KYC-verified SIM to remain inserted in a device for the app to function, thereby limiting misuse through SIM swapping.

The Reserve Bank of India has also finalised a standard operating procedure directing banks to place temporary holds on suspicious transactions to curb the use of mule accounts.

Seeking further directions, the Ministry of Home Affairs has urged the court to ensure timely implementation of these measures, including stricter SIM verification rules and faster blocking of fraudulent numbers. It has also called for compliance from technology platforms to roll out promised safeguards without delay.

AI, IndiGo

prices will result in unsurmountable losses for airlines and will lead to grounding of aircraft," the federation said, warning of possible flight cancellations if conditions persist.

The industry body pointed to recent pricing disparities as a major concern. While the government capped the increase in ATF prices for domestic operations at Rs 15 per litre last month, rates for international operations rose by Rs 73 per litre. Airlines said this imbalance has made international routes particularly difficult to sustain, even as domestic networks face mounting pressure.

To ease the burden, the federation has sought immediate financial support and policy intervention. Among its key demands is a temporary suspension of the 11 per cent excise duty on ATF, arguing that the tax amplifies cost pressures in an already volatile environment. It has also urged the government to work with states to reduce value-added tax on jet fuel, which varies widely across the country. VAT stands at 25 per cent in Delhi and as high as 29 per cent in Tamil Nadu, while other major aviation hubs such as Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad and Kolkata impose rates between 16 and 20 per cent. These six cities together account for more than half of India's airline operations.

The federation has also called for the reintroduction of a transparent pricing framework under the previously used crack band mechanism of USD 12 to 22 per barrel, arguing it would ensure more predictable fuel costs and reasonable margins for oil marketing companies.

Airlines said sustained high fuel costs are already straining cash flows and limiting their ability to plan routes and pricing. "In order to survive, sustain and continue operation, we request your urgent intervention," the letter stated.

Industry executives indicated that if prices remain elevated, carriers may be forced to cut capacity, rationalise routes and consider fare increases. For passengers, this could translate into higher ticket prices and reduced flight options, particularly on routes that become financially unviable.

Centre fixes OCI card

The Union Home Ministry has also introduced changes to the application process. Officials said the earlier requirement mandating applicants above 12 years to have stayed continuously in India for six months has been removed. "The six-month stay is no longer required for the submission of the OCI application," an official said.

Applicants must now present a passport valid for at least six months at the time of submission, along with a visa valid for a minimum of three months. Those applying on the basis of marriage to an Indian citizen or an existing OCI cardholder must ensure that the marriage has been registered and has continued for at least two years before applying.

Authorities clarified that individuals holding tourist, missionary, mountaineering or e-visas are not eligible to seek OCI registration while in India. Existing OCI cardholders are required to update their details within three months of obtaining a new foreign passport, failing which a $25 penalty will be imposed.

The government has also withdrawn the Person of Indian Origin card scheme from December 31, 2025, with all PIO cardholders now deemed OCI cardholders. The OCI framework, introduced through an amendment to the Citizenship Act, 1955 in 2005, allows eligible persons of Indian origin to register, subject to specified conditions, while excluding those with links to Pakistan or Bangladesh. MPOST

'Roads cannot be blocked

Justice Nagarathna illustrated this by referring to temple festivals, stating that while rituals can continue, they cannot justify blocking public roads. "You do your religious activity, but not by blocking the roads. The State can always step in to regulate," she said.

The bench reiterated that the Constitution grants autonomy in religious affairs, but that autonomy is not absolute. "Court cannot sit in judgment" over the manner of worship, Justice Nagarathna noted, adding that the State is empowered to intervene where secular activities are affected.

Advocate Akshay Nagarajan, appearing for the Hindu Dharma Acharya Sabha, argued that the State cannot use Article 25(2)(a) to interfere with denominational rights. The provision allows regulation of secular aspects associated with religion, including economic and political activities. Nagarajan submitted that protections under Article 25 extend beyond belief to include rituals, observances and ceremonies tied to worship.

He further argued that matters involving secular aspects of religious institutions can be addressed under Article 26(d), which grants denominations the right to manage their properties in accordance with the law.

The proceedings also saw broader arguments on religious identity and historical context. Advocate Ashwini Upadhyay referred to historical divisions of the Indian subcontinent, claiming that denominational conflicts had led to multiple partitions over centuries. He also made submissions on linguistic limitations in English compared to Sanskrit.

Justice Mahadevan, however, cautioned against straying from the core legal issues. "You are going beyond the subject being discussed," he said, urging counsel to remain focused on the matter at hand.

Earlier in the day, the bench stressed that the right to manage religious institutions cannot translate into a lack of structure. Justice Amanullah observed that every institution must have a system governing its functioning. "There cannot be anarchy," he said, adding that regulation is essential to ensure order while remaining within constitutional limits.

Advocate Nizam Pasha, representing Peerzada Syed Altamash Nizami of the Chishti Nizami lineage linked to the dargah of Hazrat Khwaja Nizamuddin Aulia, told the court that a dargah holds deep spiritual significance in the Sufi tradition. He outlined the structure of Sufi orders in India, including the Chishtiya, Qadriya, Naqshbandiya and Suhrawardiya, and argued that these constitute distinct religious denominations.

Pasha maintained that managing entry into a religious institution forms part of its administrative rights. In response, Justice Amanullah said that while management rights exist, they must be exercised within a defined framework. "It cannot be that everyone says I will do whatever I want," he remarked, noting that institutions require clear norms and oversight.

The court also underlined that any regulatory framework must adhere to constitutional guarantees, including non-discrimination.

The hearing is scheduled to continue on Wednesday.

Salim Dola from Türkiye

enabled global tracking and provisional detention pending extradition or deportation. Officials said the operation reflected coordinated efforts between Indian agencies, Turkish authorities and international policing channels.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah said the development demonstrated the government's determination to dismantle drug syndicates operating across borders. In a statement posted online, he said India's anti-narcotics agencies had expanded their reach globally and warned that "no place is safe for drug kingpins," adding that the crackdown would continue irrespective of where offenders attempt to hide.

Officials familiar with the case said Dola will be produced before a Delhi court to seek transit remand, after which he is expected to be taken to Mumbai for further legal proceedings. Niraj Kumar Gupta, Deputy Director General of the NCB, confirmed that Dola faces charges under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act and is wanted by multiple agencies, including the Maharashtra Police, Gujarat Anti-Terrorism Squad and the Directorate of Revenue Intelligence.

Investigators say Dola's alleged criminal network spans more than two decades, with operations stretching across the Middle East, Africa and Europe before feeding into distribution channels in India. His name has been linked to several high-value seizures involving heroin, charas, mephedrone, mandrax and methamphetamine, particularly in Maharashtra and Gujarat. Authorities described him as a bulk supplier who played a central role in sustaining downstream drug networks.

The Ministry of Home Affairs noted that his return represents a broader strategy focused on dismantling organised criminal structures rather than isolated arrests. Officials pointed to growing international cooperation as a critical factor, with intelligence sharing and coordinated enforcement enabling agencies to track suspects across jurisdictions that were once difficult to access.

Dola's case also connects to earlier enforcement actions targeting his associates. In 2025, his son Tahil Salim Dola and several others were arrested by Mumbai Police following their deportation from the United Arab Emirates, in a move that investigators said helped tighten the net around the larger network. Authorities said the success of Operation Global-Hunt illustrates a shift toward sustained, cross-border enforcement, where investigations extend beyond domestic boundaries and rely on long-term intelligence gathering. The approach, officials added, focuses on disrupting supply chains and limiting safe havens for traffickers rather than only responding to individual incidents. The case remains under active investigation as agencies pursue further leads linked to the syndicate. Officials indicated that the effort forms part of a continuing campaign aimed at identifying and bringing back fugitives involved in organised narcotics trafficking, reinforcing what they described as a policy of zero tolerance backed by coordinated global action.

After Kejriwal, Sisodia

Referring to Kejriwal's earlier communication, Sisodia said the concerns raised were "troubling" and that he agreed with the position taken, which he described as rooted in Mahatma Gandhi's teachings on Satyagraha. Kejriwal had written to the judge after his request for recusal was rejected on April 20.

Sisodia said he would not reiterate all the points already made but noted that the issues flagged by Kejriwal also weighed on his mind. Among them, he cited Justice Sharma's "repeated public attendance" at events linked to the Akhil Bharatiya Adhivakta Parishad, which he described as being associated with the RSS.

He also raised concerns about the professional roles of the judge's children on various Union government panels, suggesting this created an "appearance of closeness" with law officers appearing in the case. Sisodia questioned whether there was a duty to disclose such circumstances at the outset.

Stating that his position was not driven by hostility towards the court, Sisodia said he faced a moral dilemma about continuing in proceedings while holding doubts about impartiality. "After much reflection, my answer is similar to Kejriwal's. I cannot," he said, confirming he would neither appear personally nor through counsel.

'THESE PARTIES WERE AFRAID OF WOMEN'S EMPOWERMENT'

At Varanasi rally, PM says dynastic parties stalling women's quota

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

VARANASI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday accused opposition parties of blocking women's political representation for decades and said "dynastic and appeasement-driven" politics had denied daughters of the country their rightful place in Parliament and state assemblies.

Addressing a Nari Vandan rally in Varanasi, the Prime Minister said parties such as the Samajwadi Party, Congress, Trinamool Congress and DMK had "betrayed women" and kept the Women's Reservation Bill pending for nearly 40 years. He said these parties were afraid of women's empowerment and did not want them to enter legislative bodies.

Modi said his government passed the Nari Shakti Vandan Act in 2023 to ensure reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and state assemblies and asserted that he would leave no stone unturned to implement it. He said the idea behind building the new Parliament was also to increase women's participation in governance.

The Prime Minister said India's journey towards becoming a developed nation was progressing continuously and women were the strongest pillar of this transformation. He said he had come to seek blessings for a "mahayagya" aimed at implementing women's reservation and added that as the Prime Minister and the MP from Varanasi, he needed public support to achieve this goal.

He said recent efforts to push the legislation could not succeed due to opposition from parties such as the Samajwadi Party and Congress, but assured that he would make every effort to ensure its implementation. Modi said when a woman becomes empowered, the entire family gains strength and this in turn strengthens the nation.

Referring to social challenges faced by women, Modi said women in Varanasi and across the country had long been subjected to discouraging attitudes. He said they were often told not to study or work and were made to believe certain tasks were beyond their capability. "In many cases, they were not even asked, but simply told what they could or could not do," he said, adding that such experiences were common across the country and had been normalised.

The Prime Minister said that during his tenure as Gujarat chief minister about 25 years ago, he had initiated efforts to change this mindset by promoting girls' education and providing financial assistance for schooling. He said women's welfare had remained a top priority in government policies, citing the construction of around 12 crore toilets as a key intervention.

The Prime Minister said new opportunities had been opened for women in the armed forces and across sectors.

PM Narendra Modi greets people during the Mahila Sammelan, in Varanasi, on Tuesday PTI

Highlights

- The Prime Minister said parties such as the Samajwadi Party, Congress, Trinamool Congress and DMK had "betrayed women" and kept the Women's Reservation Bill pending for nearly 40 years
- Modi said his government passed the Nari Shakti Vandan Act in 2023 to ensure reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and state assemblies and asserted that he would leave no stone unturned to implement it

Massive BJP sweep in Gujarat civic polls, conquers 15 MCs

Bond between Guj & BJP even stronger, says PM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

AHMEDABAD: The BJP on Tuesday swept the local body elections in Gujarat by winning all 15 municipal corporations that went to the polls and 33 out of 34 district panchayats in the state.

Though final results of 250 taluka panchayats and 84 municipalities were awaited, data from the State Election Commission (SEC) showed that the ruling party has won most of these local bodies while some were bagged by the Congress, AAP and independents.

Polling was held on Sunday for 15 municipal corporations, 84 municipalities, 34 district panchayats and 260 taluka panchayats. More than 4.18 crore voters were eligible to cast their ballots.

The BJP emerged as clear winner in the municipal corporations of Ahmedabad, Vadodara, Surat, Bhavnagar, Jamnagar and Rajkot besides the newly created municipal corporations of Navsari, Gandhidham, Morbi, Vapi, Anand, Nadiad, Mehsana, Porbandar and Surendranagar.

Elections were not held for Gandhinagar and Junagadh corporations as they have a different election cycle.

Barring Narmada district, the BJP also captured 33 district panchayats.

The ruling party lost the Narmada district panchayat to AAP, which won 15 out of 22 seats while the saffron party managed to win only seven seats.

AAP claimed in a statement that it has also won 12 taluka panchayats, including four in Narmada district.

The local bodies won by the Congress included the taluka panchayats of Vyara, Ankalav, Hadad, Palanpur, Sidhpur and Patan, besides Sikka and Jam Raval municipalities.

Overall, the BJP has won 7,491 out of 9,986 seats across local bodies, as per the latest SEC data.

Congress has won 1,740 seats, AAP 489 seats while Independents and other parties including AIMIM have bagged 266 seats.

The BJP has won 3,674 seats in taluka panchayats, 892 in district panchayats, 1,988 in municipalities and 937 in municipal corporations.

Counting began at 9 am under heavy security.

The voter turnout on December 26 was 55.1 per cent for municipal corporations, 65.53 per cent for municipalities, 66.64 per cent for district panchayats and 67.26 per cent for taluka panchayats.

Gujarat CM Bhupendra Patel, centre, Deputy CM Harsh Sanghavi, left, and state BJP chief Jagdish Panchal celebrate PTI

PM flags off Amrit Bharat trains linking Kashi, Ayodhya to Mumbai & Pune

NARESH BISWANI

VARANASI/AYODHYA: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday flagged off two new Amrit Bharat Express trains, enhancing connectivity between key religious and economic centres.

One service runs from Varanasi to Pune, while the other connects Ayodhya to Mumbai, aiming to improve interregional travel across northern and western India. The new routes are designed to meet rising passenger demand while offering affordable and efficient transport options.

The Ayodhya–Mumbai line is expected to significantly improve access for pilgrims visiting the Shri Ram Mandir, while the Varanasi–Pune route strengthens links to the Kashi Vishwanath Temple and major urban hubs. Alongside the train launches, Modi inaugurated and laid the foundation for multiple development projects in Varanasi worth around Rs 6,350 crore. The initiatives span transport upgrades, urban infrastructure, and regional development works.

New routes are designed to meet rising passenger demand

Speaking on the occasion, the Prime Minister also reiterated his government's focus on expanding women's representation in legislative bodies, linking broader inclusion goals with ongoing development efforts.

Officials said the new rail services are part of a wider push to strengthen regional connectivity and support both pilgrimage and economic activity across states. The developments are expected to further boost tourism, ease long-distance travel, and strengthen economic linkages between major cities, while reinforcing Varanasi and Ayodhya's role as key spiritual and cultural hubs.

'WILL CONTINUE TO FIGHT FOR PEOPLE'

Detained J&K AAP MLA freed after 8 months

JAMMU: After spending eight months in prison, AAP MLA Mehraj Malik was released from Kathua jail on Tuesday following the quashing of his detention under the Public Safety Act (PSA) by the Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh High Court.

Malik arrived at his residence in Jammu to a rousing reception with a floral welcome and beats of dholaks and bursting of crackers. Scores of party workers distributed sweets amid sloganeering in favour of Malik, as he vowed to continue to fight for the people.

Setting aside the detention order issued by the Doda district magistrate, Justice Mohd Yousuf Wani on Monday directed authorities to release Malik and held that the order was legally unsustainable and based on "non-application of mind."

Mehraj Malik being welcomed after his release from Kathua jail PTI

Malik was detained last September under the PSA for allegedly disturbing public order and was subsequently lodged in Kathua jail.

On September 24, 2025, he filed a habeas corpus petition in the high court, challenging his detention and seeking Rs 5 crore as compensation.

On February 23, the high court had reserved its order in the case, and then on Monday, it quashed the detention issued under the PSA. "Malik was released by jail authorities this morning after completion of all formalities," his lawyer and AAP spokesperson Appu Singh Slathia told reporters here.

As the gates of Kathua jail opened this morning to release the AAP leader, numerous people garlanded him with flowers and rallied behind him.

"Our struggle will continue. It will not change. It is not a struggle based on politics but on the thoughts and drive of people's welfare. I urge youth to join politics," Malik told reporters in Kathua.

When Mehraj arrived at his residence in Jammu to a rousing reception, he was received by his mother and father, who hugged him amid a tearful welcome. "It is the victory of people," Malik, who is the AAP's Jammu and Kashmir unit president, told party workers at his residence.

Akhilesh visits BJP MLA hurt in effigy protest

LUCKNOW: Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav on Tuesday visited a private hospital in Lucknow to meet BJP MLA Anupama Jaiswal, who sustained burn injuries while burning an effigy of Yadav during a protest over the stalling of the Women's Reservation Bill.

Yadav reached Medanta Hospital and enquired about the condition of the legislator. He greeted her with folded hands and also spoke to the doctors overseeing her treatment. MPOST

Congress slams PM over women's quota issue

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Tuesday reiterated its demand for an all-party meeting to discuss implementation of the women's reservation law within the existing strength of the Lok Sabha from 2029 onwards. It said it is now time for Prime Minister Narendra Modi to make amends for his "sins of using women" to advance his political agenda.

Congress leader Jairam Ramesh alleged that the government's agenda was "only delimitation for the PM's political preservation," adding that women's reservation was being misused. He said the PM must "make amends". AGENCIES

Ghazipur killing sparks political, caste row

LUCKNOW: The death of a teenage girl in Ghazipur has turned into a major political flashpoint, with parties trading allegations and the case quickly acquiring caste undertones ahead of the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections.

The incident occurred on April 15, when the girl's body was recovered from the Ganga in a village under Karanda police station limits. Police registered a murder case on a complaint by her father and arrested a local youth, Hariom Pandey. Officials said call records indicated the two knew each other, while the postmortem report found no injury marks and ruled out sexual assault.

The Samajwadi Party rejected the findings, alleging a cover-up and insisting the case involved rape and murder. The party organised protests and questioned the investigation, escalating the matter into a wider political controversy.

Tensions rose when an SP delegation visited the village to meet the family, leading to clashes between rival groups that left several people injured, including a former minister and a police officer. Police filed cases against party leaders and supporters and made multiple arrests. Restrictions were imposed to prevent further unrest. SP chief Akhilesh Yadav has taken up the issue, announced financial assistance for the family, and planned a visit to the district, with observers linking the move to caste consolidation efforts. MPOST

UP 'Singham' row spills into Bengal polls over 'dance video'

Akhilesh described Sharma as a 'tested agent' of BJP

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: A video of Uttar Pradesh cadre IPS officer Ajay Pal Sharma warning a Trinamool Congress candidate has triggered a political storm in West Bengal ahead of the second phase of elections.

Sharma, a 2011-batch officer known for his tough policing style, is currently deployed as an election observer in South 24 Parganas. In the viral video, he is seen warning Trinamool candidate Jehangir Khan and others of strict action if any attempt is made to intimidate voters or disrupt the polling process.

The All India Trinamool Congress reacted sharply, accusing the officer of overstepping his authority. The party said it would move court and seek action if any "illegal or unconstitutional conduct" is established.

Adding to the controversy, Trinamool MP Mahua Moitra shared another video on social media purportedly showing the officer dancing with women, taking a swipe at him with the remark "Fair and lovely Babua". She questioned the propriety of such conduct by an officer posted on election duty and called for accountability.

The controversy soon took a political turn, with Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav attacking the BJP and the Uttar Pradesh administration. In a post on social media, Yadav described Sharma as a "tested agent" of the BJP and said the viral video had damaged the image of governance in Uttar Pradesh.

He also questioned the state government's claims on women's safety and respect, alleging that such incidents expose gaps in the administration's approach. Yadav said strict action should be taken against officials whose conduct raises questions about neutrality, adding that zero tolerance must apply not only to criminals but also to those in positions of authority.

The row has added to the already charged political atmosphere in West Bengal, where allegations of voter intimidation and administrative bias remain key flashpoints between rival parties.

Key Points

- Sharma, a 2011-batch officer known for his tough policing style, is currently deployed as an election observer in South 24 Parganas
- In the viral video, he is seen warning Trinamool candidate Jehangir Khan and others of strict action if any attempt is made to intimidate voters or disrupt the polling process
- Adding to the controversy, Trinamool MP Mahua Moitra shared another video on social media purportedly showing the officer dancing with women, taking a swipe at him with the remark "Fair and lovely Babua"

Extract of Audited Financial Results (Standalone & Consolidated) for the Three Months and Year ended 31-03-2026

(₹ in Crore)

Sl. No.	Particulars	Standalone					Consolidated				
		Three Months Ended			Year Ended		Three Months Ended			Year Ended	
		31-03-2026	31-12-2025	31-03-2025	31-03-2026	31-03-2025	31-03-2026	31-12-2025	31-03-2025	31-03-2026	31-03-2025
		(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1.	Total Income from Operations	14,386.01	14,944.26	15,159.44	59,139.96	55,911.12	14,563.82	15,051.08	15,333.54	59,584.16	56,366.55
2.	Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	4,397.09	5,116.40	5,384.67	20,713.19	19,859.78	4,414.54	5,154.71	5,489.89	20,784.61	20,117.47
3.	Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	4,397.09	5,116.40	5,384.67	20,713.19	19,859.78	4,414.54	5,136.43	5,489.89	20,766.33	20,117.47
4.	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	3,362.30	4,043.08	4,236.20	16,282.26	15,713.21	3,375.08	4,052.44	4,309.98	16,308.17	15,884.23
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	315.47	4,719.20	3,186.06	12,115.91	14,196.41	328.25	4,728.56	3,259.84	12,141.82	14,367.43
6.	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face Value ₹10 per share)	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22	2,633.22
7.	Other Equity	81,657.19	83,629.26	75,004.75	81,657.19	75,004.75	82,421.19	84,380.47	75,742.84	82,421.19	75,742.84
8.	Securities Premium Account	1,577.53	1,577.53	1,577.53	1,577.53	1,577.53					
9.	Net Worth	84,290.41	86,262.48	77,637.97	84,290.41	77,637.97					
10.	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	5,05,777.41	4,98,828.24	4,88,258.52	5,05,777.41	4,88,258.52					
11.	Debt Equity Ratio *	6.00	5.78	6.29	6.00	6.29					
12.	Earnings per Share (of ₹10 each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) (in ₹)										
(i)	Basic	12.64	15.35	15.96	61.71	59.55	12.69	15.39	16.24	61.81	60.20
(ii)	Diluted	12.64	15.35	15.96	61.71	59.55	12.69	15.39	16.24	61.81	60.20

** Debt/Equity Ratio = Net Debt / Net Worth (Net debt represents principal outstanding less cash and cash equivalents available.)*

Notes:

1. The above standalone financial results of the Company were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved and taken on record by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on April 28, 2026. These results have been audited by the Joint Statutory Auditors of the Company.
2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the financial results is available on the Stock Exchange websites **(www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com)** and also on the Company's website **(www.recindia.nic.in)**.
3. For other applicable disclosure as required under regulation 52(4) of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, refer detailed format of the financial results filed with the Stock Exchange **(www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com)** and can also be accessed on the Company's website **(www.recindia.nic.in)**.

FINAL DIVIDEND

The Board of Directors of the company at its meeting held on April 28, 2026, has recommended final dividend of ₹1.55/- per equity share (on face value of ₹10/- each) subject to the approval of shareholders in the ensuing Annual General Meeting of the company. The total divided per share (including proposed final dividend) for the financial year 2025-26 is ₹18.55/- per equity share.

Place: Delhi
Date: April 28, 2026

For REC Limited
(Jitendra Srivastava)
Chairman & Managing Director
DIN - 06817799

REC Limited
(A Maharatna Government of India Enterprise)
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Scan this QR code to download the Financial Results

SCO MEET IN BISHKEK

No place for any double standards in combating terrorism, says Rajnath

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Operation Sindoor demonstrated India's firm resolve that "terror epicentres" are no longer immune to "justifiable punishment", Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said on Tuesday, in remarks widely seen as a warning to Pakistan over cross-border terrorism.

In an address at a conclave of Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) in Bishkek, Singh also called on the influential grouping to not lose sight of "state-sponsored" cross-border terrorism and that there should not be any place for any "double standards" in combating the menace.

Delving into ongoing conflicts and geopolitical upheavals, Singh said that the "real test of power" is not in using it against the poor and the weak, but to use it in the interest of those who are unable to defend themselves.

There is a need to focus on global consensus where "co-existence, co-habitation and compassion take precedence over chaos, competition and conflict", he said.

The Defence minister emphasised that the SCO should not hesitate in seeking appropriate action against those who "abet, shelter and provide safe havens" to terrorists.

"We must not lose sight of state-sponsored cross-border terrorism which attacks the very sovereignty of a nation state. There is no place for any double standards and SCO should not hesitate in seeking appropriate action against those who abet, shelter and provide safe havens to terrorists," he said.

Singh strongly pitched for a unified front to tackle the "evils" of terrorism, separatism and extremism.

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh pays floral tribute at Victory Square during his visit to Bishkek to attend the SCO Defence Ministers' Meeting, in Kyrgyzstan PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- Op Sindoor demonstrated India's firm resolve that terror epicentres are no longer immune to justifiable punishment, he said
- He was addressing a conclave of Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) in Bishkek

"By tackling terrorism, separatism, and extremism without exception, we (can) transform regional security from a challenge into a cornerstone for peace and prosperity," he said in presence of defence ministers from China, Russia and other member states of the grouping.

The defence minister described terrorism as the the "most serious threat" to the emerging world order and noted that counter-terror cooperation has been a "foundational principle" of the SCO.

"On April 22, we remembered the victims of the heinous terrorist attack in Pahalgam. The carnage in Pahalgam shook the entire humanity," he said.

"During Operation Sindoor, we demonstrated our firm resolve that terrorism epicentres are no longer immune to justifiable punishment," he added.

Singh also recalled the declaration unveiled at last year's SCO summit in Chinese city of Tianjin saying it brought out firm and collective stance against terrorism.

"It was a testimony to our zero-tolerance outlook towards terrorism and its perpetrators, which was endorsed by this esteemed forum. But the real test of our collective credibility remains in consistency," he said.

"We must not forget that terrorism has no nationality and no theology. No grievance, real or supposed, can become an excuse for terrorism and humanitarian loss," he said.

The defence minister highlighted the significant role being played by the SCO's Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure and referred to the joint statement of the Heads of State on 'Countering Radicalisation leading to Terrorism, Separatism and Extremism' that was issued during India's chairmanship of the grouping.

CENTRE, STATES, UTS TO JOIN MEET

CCTVs in police stns: SC asks amicus to convene meeting on utilisation of funds

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday said that a meeting be convened on May 6 to deliberate on the aspect of utilisation of funds by the states on installation of CCTVs in police stations across the country.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta asked senior advocate Siddhartha Dave, who is assisting it as an amicus curiae in a suo motu matter concerning lack of functional CCTVs in police stations, to hold a meeting on May 6 with the Centre, all states and Union Territories.

"We are of the view that a meeting be convened by the amicus, as done earlier, in which the Home secretary of the Central government or his nominee not below the rank of joint or additional secretary and the Home secretary of states/Union Territories will participate," the bench said.

REPRESENTATIVE PIC

The issue cropped up after the amicus flagged the aspect of utilisation of funds by the states.

Dave told the bench that in UTs, the Centre gives 100 percent funds while in hilly states, the central government gives 90 percent funding.

He said in remaining states, the Centre gives 60 percent while the rest 40 percent funding is by the respective state.

"Why don't we get responses of the states only on utilisation of funds?" the bench said.

The top court suggested that the amicus can convene a meeting with the Centre, states and UTs on the issue.

> The issue cropped up after the amicus flagged the aspect of utilisation of funds by the states

It posted the matter for hearing on May 13 and said that a report be submitted before it.

On April 7, the Centre told the top court that all issues concerning installation of CCTVs in police stations would be sorted out within two weeks.

Attorney General R Venkataramani had told the bench that he was taking stock of the issue and a lot of things were happening.

On February 26, the apex court directed the Centre and others to participate in a meeting to deliberate upon the feasibility, modalities and implementation framework of the issues, including creation of a centralised dashboard and standardisation of CCTV infrastructure in police stations.

The top court had earlier directed registration of a suo motu case over the lack of functional CCTVs in police stations after taking cognisance of a media report.

The apex court had in 2018 ordered the installation of CCTV cameras across police stations to check human rights abuses.

In December 2020, the top court directed the Centre to install CCTV cameras and recording equipment at the offices of investigating agencies, including the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI), the Enforcement Directorate (ED) and the National Investigation Agency (NIA).

Chhattisgarh: Korba gets 40 MVA new power transformer

RAIPUR: The Chhattisgarh State Power Transmission Company has enhanced power infrastructure with the installation and energisation of an additional 40 MVA transformer at the 132 kV Chhurikhurd substation in Korba district. Executed at a cost of about Rs 4.31 crore, the project aims to meet rising electricity demand and improve supply reliability.

Around 50 villages in the Katghora-Pali area will benefit from the upgrade, with farmers expected to receive improved voltage for irrigation, while domestic users may see fewer fluctuations and outages.

Managing Director Rajesh Kumar Shukla inaugurated the facility and said the company is focusing on strengthening power systems in rural and remote areas. MPOST

Material stores energy, shows charge via colour

Developed by scientists at CeNS

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Scientists at the Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences (CeNS), Bengaluru, have developed a novel material that can both store energy and visually indicate its charge level through colour changes, potentially transforming electronic device design.

The breakthrough material, an oxygen-deficient bimetallic oxide made from molybdenum and tungsten, shifts from blue when fully charged to transparent when discharged. This allows users to instantly gauge battery status without relying on separate display components.

The research was led by Principal Researcher Ashutosh Kumar Singh, whose team synthesised the compound using solvothermal techniques.

The innovation leverages the material's oxygen-deficient lattice, which creates pathways for ions to move freely. As ions shift during charging and discharging, they alter the material's electronic structure, producing visible colour changes.

Tests on large-area devices (5×5 sq cm) showed strong electrochromic performance, with 43 per cent optical modulation and high coloration efficiency. As a supercapacitor electrode, the material delivered a specific capacitance of 234 farads per gramme.

'SELF-RADICALISATION' SUSPECTED

Thane security guards stabbed: Note on lone wolf attack, IS found

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: Investigators have found a note referring to 'lone wolf' attacks and the Islamic State at the house of a man arrested for allegedly attacking two security guards after asking their religion in Maharashtra's Thane district, an official said on Tuesday.

The 31-year-old accused, who had lived in the United States for several years, seemed to have undergone "self-radicalisation", Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said.

Prima facie, the incident appeared to be a 'lone wolf' attack, and accused Zaib Zubair Ansari allegedly asked the guards at an under-construction building site in Mira Road area to recite the 'Kalma' before stabbing them early on Monday, a state Anti-Terrorism Squad (ATS) official said.

Ansari (31) had returned to India from the US in 2020, the ATS official said.

One of the victims claimed that the accused asked them to recite the 'Kalma', and when they could not, he stabbed them with a knife, causing them serious injuries, as per the official.

The state government has handed over the probe into the incident to the ATS.

Ansari lived alone at the Smita Regency building in Naya Nagar, Mira Road, about 200 metres from the incident site, the official said. His wife, who is of Afghan origin, had left him and gone to the US, as per the probe.

During a search of his residence, the ATS recovered a note referring to lone wolf attacks and the Islamic State, a laptop, and three copies of the Quran, the official said.

Speaking to reporters in Solapur, Fadnavis, who also heads the Home ministry, said the accused was apparently influenced by online content and books, and acquired an extremist mindset. "With the help of agencies like the ATS and NIA, we will probe who is behind this radicalisation and whether others are involved," he added.

'South Coastal Rly Zone to go live on June 1'

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Railway minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Tuesday announced that the new South Coastal Zone will come into existence and start functioning from June 1, 2026.

Addressing a gathering after the Ground Breaking Ceremony of Google Cloud India AI Hub at Visakhapatnam, Vaishnaw said, "Gazette Notification for the creation of South Coastal Railway Zone will be issued, with June 1, 2026 being notified as the effective date."

He added that this development marks a significant step toward strengthening Railway Administration in Andhra Pradesh.

"The minister further explained that Andhra Pradesh has received a record railway budget allocation of Rs 10,134 crore, a substantial increase compared to the Rs 886 crore allocated in earlier years for the combined states of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana," a press note from the Railway Ministry said.

Vaishnaw noted that railway projects worth approximately Rs 1,06,000 crore are currently underway in Andhra Pradesh, aimed at enhancing connectivity across the state, including links to ports, tourism destinations, and major cities, it said.

At present, there are 17 railway zones in the country and the South Coastal Zone will be the 18th one.

On June 8, 2025, Prime Minister Narendra Modi virtually laid the foundation stone of this new zone announcement for which was made in February 2019.

According to the Railway Ministry, the purpose of creating SCoR is to improve operational efficiency and provide focused service to the growing passenger and freight demands in the region.

The minister announced that Andhra Pradesh has achieved 100 per cent electrification of its railway network, positioning it among the leading regions in Railway Modernization.

'Labour Day': Punjab Assembly to convene special session on May 1

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: The Punjab Cabinet, led by Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann, on Tuesday approved the convening of a special one-day session of the state Assembly on May 1 to mark Labour Day and honour the contribution of the working class.

Announcing the move on X, Mann said: "In a significant decision taken by the Punjab Cabinet, it has been decided to convene a special session of the Legislative Assembly on May 1, on the occasion of Labour Day. This one-day session will be dedicated to the hardworking labourers and artisans who make a vital contribution to the country's social and economic development."

He further wrote: "As part of this historic initiative, representatives of labour unions will be invited to the House as special guests. The session will also witness serious discussions on the impact of changes in the MGNREGA scheme on the working class, along with broader national and international challenges affecting them."

> "The session will be dedicated to the hardworking labourers and artisans..."

"In addition, during the session, other essential legislative business as determined by the Business Advisory Committee of the Assembly will be carried out in accordance with established procedures, ensuring that key decisions necessary for the state's development and the strengthening of democracy are undertaken," the post concluded.

According to the Chief Minister's Office, the session will pay tribute to the role of workers in the state's socio-economic progress. It added that labour union representatives would be invited as special guests and discussions would be held on the impact of changes in the MGNREGA scheme, including its restructuring into the G-Ram-G scheme, on labourers.

The session will also deliberate on emerging challenges facing workers amid national and global developments. Other legislative business will be finalised by the Business Advisory Committee as per established procedures.

'VISION TO ACTION' AI PLANNING TOOL LAUNCHED

Set timelines for 2030 targets: Hry CM to depts

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday said that every department in the state should prepare year-wise timelines for the targets set for 2030, according to a statement.

He said that merely setting goals is not enough; it is equally important to achieve them on time and regularly review them so that the benefits of schemes directly reach the people.

Saini was chairing a meeting related to the 'Swarna Jayanti Haryana Institute for Fiscal Management' at the Civil Secretariat. During the meeting, various departments were reviewed regarding their 5-year implementation roadmaps.

On this occasion, the chief minister also launched the "Vision to Action Artificial Intelligence" planning tool.

INSIGHT

- He said that merely setting goals is not enough; it is equally important to achieve them on time
- Saini was chairing a meeting related to the 'Swarna Jayanti Haryana Institute for Fiscal Management'

FILE PIC

Director General of Swarna Jayanti Haryana Institute for Fiscal Management, Raj Nehru, informed the chief minister that the tool has been designed keeping the action plan in mind.

Its objective is to ensure clarity in 5-year targets while generating uniform departmental reports. The tool will also help departments easily track their year-wise goals. In this way, Haryana will be able to contribute in a phased manner towards the goal of Viksit Bharat 2047, fulfilling the vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, he said.

During the meeting, officials from different departments, including the Industries and Commerce Department and the School Education Department, presented their plans and proposed works from 2026 to 2030, the statement read.

He directed all departments to work in coordination with NITI Aayog and focus on reforms to ensure effective implementation of schemes for the maximum benefit of the people.

Saini stressed the need to continuously monitor the ground-level impact of schemes within the stipulated timelines. He said that all departments should work collectively, adopt innovative approaches and prepare in advance so that the pace of the state's development can be accelerated further.

Advance action needed to protect vulnerable groups from heatwaves, NHRC tells 21 states

'Heatwaves may also lead to loss of livelihoods, increased fire accident risks'

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Pointing to the disproportionate impact of rise in heatwave frequency and intensity on the marginalised sections, the NHRC on Tuesday asked 21 states and Delhi to take advance action to protect the vulnerable population.

The elderly, children, infants and newborns are especially susceptible to the health impacts of extreme heat. Additionally, heatwaves can lead to the loss of livelihoods and an increased risk of fire accidents, the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) said in a statement.

Mercury levels have soared in various states in the country over the past few days and in Delhi, temperature readings have breached the 40 degrees Celsius mark at many places.

In this context, the NHRC asked 21 states and Delhi to take advance action and implement relief measures to protect the vulnerable population during heatwaves.

The states are Andhra Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Karnataka, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, Punjab, Rajasthan, Sikkim, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Tripura, Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal.

A police personnel drinks water to beat the heat on a hot summer day in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, on April 25 PTI

KEY POINTS

- The elderly, children, infants and newborns are especially susceptible to the health impacts of extreme heat
- Mercury levels have soared in various states in the country over the past few days and in Delhi, temperature readings have breached the 40 degrees Celsius mark at many places
- In this context, the NHRC asked 21 states and Delhi to take advance action and implement relief measures to protect the vulnerable population during heatwaves

The Commission has observed that the "rise in the frequency, duration and intensity of heatwaves, disproportionately affects the marginalised, economically weaker sections, outdoor workers and the homeless due to the lack of adequate shelter and resources".

Therefore, the NHRC, in a letter to the chief secretaries of these states and the Union Territory of Delhi, has emphasised the urgent need for integrated and inclusive measures.

The rights panel also highlighted the risks faced by economically weaker sections, outdoor workers, the elderly, children, newborns and especially the homeless due to heatwaves amid inadequate shelter and resources, the statement said.

Highlighting the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) data on the reported deaths of about 3,712 people in India due to heat or sunstroke between 2019-23, the Commission urged them to plan and facilitate seamless implementation of relief measures as per their existing standard operating procedures or guidelines issued by the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) to mitigate the impact of heatwaves and prevent casualties, it said.

The NHRC called for consolidated action taken reports from the districts at the state or UT level, the statement added.

Meanwhile, Uttar Pradesh continues to experience high temperatures, with Banda in Bundelkhand region recording the highest temperature in the state at a sweltering 45.6 degrees Celsius on Tuesday, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

Among other hot spots, Orai recorded 43.8 degrees Celsius, followed by Jhansi at 42.4 degrees Celsius, while Fatehgarh and Hamirpur both registered 42.2 degrees Celsius. Agra too witnessed extreme weather at 42.1 degrees Celsius, reflecting the widespread intensity of the heatwave across the state.

ISI-BACKED TERROR MODULE

Rly track blast bid: Patiala cops nab 4

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Police have busted an alleged Pakistan's ISI-backed pro-Khalistani terror module linked to a late-night attempt to detonate an explosive device on a railway track near Shambhu in Patiala. Four highly radicalised habitual offenders have been arrested, and a significant cache of arms and explosives recovered from their possession.

The accused have been identified as Pardeep Singh Khalsa of Mansa, Kulwinder Singh alias Bagga of Bappiana village in Mansa, Satnam Singh alias Satta of Panjwarh in Tarn Taran, and Gurpreet Singh alias Gopi of Goindwal bypass in Tarn Taran. Police said all four have prior involvement in serious criminal cases.

The recovered material includes a hand grenade, two .30 bore pistols with ammunition, sophisticated communication devices allegedly meant for coordinating future attacks, and laptops used to stay in touch with handlers.

Addressing a press conference, DIG Patiala Range Kuldeep Chahal and SSP Patiala Varun Sharma said the module was unearthed within 12 hours of the attempted railway track blast. They identified Pardeep Singh Khalsa as the kingpin, claiming he was in close contact with a Malaysia-based pro-Khalistani operative and Pakistan-based arms suppliers.

According to police, Khalsa allegedly facilitated the movement of radicalised youth to Malaysia for training and later assigned them roles in terror activities. He is also accused of forming a radical outfit named "Chalda Vaheer Chakarwarti, Attariye".

Preliminary interrogation has revealed that the accused were involved in a low-intensity IED blast on the main line near Shambhu railway station and were planning further attacks targeting public infrastructure and property.

A case has been registered at Police Station Kotwali, Patiala, under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, Explosive Substances Act, Arms Act, and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act. Investigations are ongoing.

Sh. Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister

Sh. Vishnu Deo Sai
Hon'ble CM, Chhattisgarh

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- **400+** reforms implemented, transforming the "Ease of Doing Business" into the "Speed of Doing Business"
- Continuous increase in the number of technically proficient and industry-ready skilled youth
- Bespoke Policy: Special packages for industries generating 1,000 or more jobs, including training assistance of up to ₹15,000 per employee per month

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Nava Raipur – The Industrial Hub of New India

- **₹1800 crore** for Establishment of a semiconductor unit
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Special Incentives

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Chhattisgarh progressing toward becoming India's leading power-generating state by 2030

Current capacity : 30,000 MW

Women and Youth Entrepreneurs

- **₹50 crore** Startup Fund and subsidized loans under the Udyam Kranti Yojana

Tax Benefits

- **12 years of 100%** Net SGST Refund is available under the current policy

Connectivity, Logistics and Tourism

- **₹47,447 crore** worth of railway projects operational
- National Highway development worth **21,380 crore** completed; works worth **18,000** crore in progress
- **New Logistics Policy** Development of integrated cold storage and transport infrastructure

Industry Status for Tourism

- **Homestay Policy** implemented in Chhattisgarh
- **'Destination Chhattisgarh'** promotes Tribal, Heritage and Eco-tourism

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EDITORIAL

AXIS OF NECESSITY

The optics were unmistakable. As Abbas Araghchi sat across from Vladimir Putin in St. Petersburg, the message being crafted was not merely about bilateral ties—it was about the reconfiguration of power in a region that refuses to settle into stability. In the language of diplomacy, phrases such as "strategic partnership," "solidarity," and "support for peace" often conceal as much as they reveal. What is unfolding today between Tehran and Moscow is not simply cooperation; it is a calculated alignment shaped by sanctions, conflict, and the shifting contours of global geopolitics. At one level, the expanding Iran-Russia relationship is unsurprising. Both nations have long been subject to Western sanctions, both seek to resist American influence, and both have found common cause in theatres such as Syria. But the present moment carries a different urgency. The recent conflict involving Iran, triggered by coordinated military action from the United States and Israel, has deepened Tehran's sense of strategic isolation while simultaneously reinforcing its need for dependable partners. Russia, embroiled in its own confrontation with the West, has emerged as both a political ally and a diplomatic shield. The optics of Putin praising Iran's "sovereignty" and offering mediation are less about neutrality and more about positioning Moscow as an indispensable power broker in West Asia.

For Iran, the outreach is equally pragmatic. The Islamic Republic has demonstrated resilience in the face of military pressure, but resilience alone cannot substitute for strategic depth. By strengthening ties with Russia, Tehran signals that it is not diplomatically cornered. It also seeks leverage in its fragile engagement with Washington. The stalled peace talks, the uncertainty surrounding a second round of negotiations, and the United States' fluctuating posture all contribute to a volatile diplomatic environment. In such a scenario, Russia's willingness to offer "good offices" is not just a gesture—it is a bargaining chip that Iran can deploy in its broader negotiation calculus. Yet, beneath the surface of this growing partnership lies a fundamental contradiction. Russia's ambition to act as a mediator sits uneasily with its clear alignment with Iran. Mediation, by definition, requires credibility with all parties. While Moscow may present itself as a facilitator of peace, its deepening strategic and military cooperation with Tehran raises legitimate questions about its neutrality. For Washington and its allies, Russia's involvement is unlikely to inspire confidence. Instead, it reinforces the perception of an emerging bloc that seeks to counterbalance Western influence across multiple fronts.

The United States, for its part, finds itself navigating a complex and evolving landscape. President Donald Trump's claims of strategic advantage—asserting that Washington "holds all the cards"—reflect a familiar pattern of rhetorical dominance. However, the ground reality appears far more nuanced. The extension of the ceasefire, the withdrawal of negotiators from planned engagements, and the openness to telephonic diplomacy suggest a degree of recalibration. If anything, these moves indicate that the United States recognises the limitations of coercive power in achieving decisive outcomes against a state that has demonstrated both military capability and political endurance. This is where the Iran-Russia axis acquires broader significance. It is not merely about bilateral cooperation; it is about the gradual erosion of a unipolar diplomatic order. As Iran engages with Russia, consults Pakistan, and holds discussions in Oman over critical maritime routes like the Strait of Hormuz, it is constructing a networked approach to diplomacy that reduces dependence on any single interlocutor. This multi-vector strategy allows Tehran to hedge its bets, balancing confrontation with engagement, and resistance with negotiation.

For India and other regional stakeholders, these developments carry important implications. The stability of West Asia remains crucial for energy security, trade routes, and diaspora interests. An entrenched Russia-Iran partnership could alter the dynamics of regional alliances, particularly in relation to the Gulf states and Israel. Moreover, any prolonged uncertainty in the Strait of Hormuz—through which a significant portion of global oil supply passes—has the potential to disrupt markets and exacerbate economic vulnerabilities far beyond the region. At a deeper level, the current moment underscores a recurring truth about international relations: alliances are rarely about shared values; they are about converging interests. Iran and Russia may differ in their long-term ambitions, but their immediate priorities align sufficiently to sustain cooperation. The language of solidarity, therefore, must be read as strategic convenience rather than ideological convergence. It is a partnership forged not in trust, but in necessity. The question that remains is whether this alignment can translate into durable peace. Russia's offer to mediate may create diplomatic openings, but it cannot, on its own, resolve the underlying tensions that define the Iran-US relationship. These tensions are rooted in decades of mistrust, competing regional ambitions, and fundamentally different visions of security. Any meaningful progress will require not just intermediaries, but a willingness among the principal actors to move beyond maximalist positions.

The meeting in St. Petersburg is less about the immediate prospects of peace and more about the evolving architecture of power. It signals a world where traditional hierarchies are being contested, where regional conflicts are increasingly shaped by global rivalries, and where diplomacy is as much about perception as it is about substance. For Iran, Russia offers a counterweight. For Russia, Iran offers relevance. And for the rest of the world, this partnership serves as a reminder that in times of flux, alliances harden not out of choice, but out of compulsion. Whether this compulsion leads to stability or further fragmentation will depend on how the coming months unfold. What is clear, however, is that the axis taking shape today is not a temporary arrangement. It is a reflection of a changing world—one where power is negotiated, contested, and, above all, constantly recalibrated.

ETERNAL DHARMA

Relics of Reverence

The arrival of Buddha's sacred relics in Ladakh turns a spiritual exposition into a civilisational moment of peace, memory and national recognition

GAJENDRA SINGH SHEKHAWAT

THE WRITER IS THE UNION MINISTER FOR CULTURE AND TOURISM, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

The relics arrive in Leh today, and for 15 days, they will be accessible to devotees, monks, scholars and pilgrims from across the world

There are moments in a nation's life when history does not merely repeat itself - it deepens. This Wednesday, as the sacred relics of Tathagata Buddha descend upon Ladakh for the first time in India on this scale of public veneration, I find myself reaching not for the language of officialdom, but for something far older: reverence.

For centuries, Ladakh has held the flame. Through brutal winters that freeze rivers solid, through geopolitical pressures that would test the sturdiest of souls, through the isolation of altitude and the remoteness of high passes - the people of Ladakh have kept the Dharma alive with a fidelity that humbles every institution and every government. It is entirely fitting, then, that India's first historic public exposition of the Tathagata relics does not take place in a climate-controlled museum in a metropolitan city. It takes place here, on the Roof of the World, where faith is the very architecture of daily life.

And consider where these relics come from. They originate from Piprahwa, in Uttar Pradesh — the site historically identified with ancient Kapilavastu, the very birthplace of Siddhartha Gautama. Bringing them to Ladakh is, in the most literal sense possible, a homecoming.

A First That Carries the Weight of Ages

The Sacred Exposition of the Holy Relics of the Tathagata carries an official title that is also a declaration: "Peace in Times of Conflict." In a world convulsed by war, fracture, and rising hostility, these words are a challenge to the premise that conflict is inevitable, that strength requires aggression, and that the only answer to uncertainty is force. The Buddha answered that challenge two and a half millennia ago. We bring his physical presence back to remind a watching world that the answer still holds.

The sacred relics of Gautama Buddha - preserved with the utmost sanctity - are travelling for the first time from their permanent place of keeping to be venerated on Indian soil at this scale. Under Z-category security, aboard a special aircraft, they arrive in Leh on April 29th, and for 15 days, from the 1st to the 15th of May, beginning on the auspicious occasion of the 2569th Vesak Buddha Purnima, they will be accessible to devotees, monks, scholars, and pilgrims from across the world.

At a time of global conflict, Ladakh offers the world a quieter grammar of strength — compassion, restraint and spiritual continuity

The venues themselves speak volumes. The Mahabodhi International Meditation Centre, the Dharma Centre at the historic Leh Palace, the teaching ground of Jive-Tsal - the same sacred earth where His Holiness the Dalai Lama has delivered his teachings - will host this exposition. And the relics will not remain confined to Leh alone. Between the 11th and 12th of May, they will travel to the remote *Zanskar valley,* carrying the Buddha's grace to a community whose Buddhist traditions remain as deep as the gorges of their landscape.

"This is a celebration of India's soul, her civilisation, and the enduring message she carries for a fractured world."

The Land That Never Let the Flame Go Out

To understand why Ladakh is the right home for this occasion, one must understand what Ladakh is. It is not simply a dramatic landscape of monasteries and mountains, however breathtaking that landscape may be. It is a living university of the Dharma. From the serene heights of Hemis Monastery - whose annual festival draws pilgrims from across the Himalayan world - to the ancient frescos of Alchi, painted in the 10th century and still vivid with devotional genius; from the towering Maitreya Buddha of Diskit that faces the Shyok River with a gaze of infinite compassion, to the layered wisdom of Thiksey, often compared to the great monasteries of Tibet - Ladakh has been, for over a thousand years, one of the most extraordinary repositories of Buddhist philosophy, art, manuscript tradition, and living practice on the planet.

These monasteries, the monks who inhabit them - they are the active transmitters of a tradition that has survived every geopolitical storm the Himalayan region has known. And they have done this work of preservation under conditions that would tax the imagination of most administrators: extreme cold, scarce resources, infrastructural isolation, and a geography that demands courage simply to inhabit.

It is India's formal acknowledgement of what Ladakh has always been - not a peripheral territory at the edge of the map, but a beating spiritual heart at the centre of the nation's identity.

A Vision Rooted in Civilisational Depth

Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi has consistently described Ladakh as a vibrant centre of Buddhist culture and spirituality. He has spoken often of the resilience and patriotism of the Ladakhi people - especially in difficult border conditions - linking their spiritual strength with national resolve and unity. He has made clear that development in Ladakh will go hand in hand with the preservation of its unique culture and environment.

As the Prime Minister has emphasised: Ladakh is not only a land of immense strategic importance, but also a living centre of the Buddha's teachings. The visit of the holy relics is both a spiritual blessing and a recognition of Ladakh's centuries-old role in preserving Buddhist heritage, as well as the courage and dedication of its people in serving the nation.

This vision - of a Ladakh that is simultaneously a frontier of national security and a citadel of civilisational wisdom - is the most coherent thing about the place.

What Ladakh Teaches a Fractured World

The exposition is expected to be one of the largest congregations of Buddhist communities India has ever hosted. And in a world increasingly defined by conflict, polarisation, and the politics of suspicion, that congregation carries a message that transcends faith.

The Buddha's teachings on non-violence, compassion, and inner awakening are not the property of any single community, sect, or lineage. Whether it is the Gelug, Drukpa, Kagyu, or any of the other magnificent traditions that flourish in Ladakh, the essence of the Dharma remains singular: the path of *karunā,* of *prajñā,* of harmony.

The sacred exposition, arriving just as the region welcomes spring and the snow begins to melt from the high passes, is an invitation to cross every border that divides us: of sect, of nationality, of fear.

"The relics bless the faithful. But they also remind a watching world that the quietest forms of strength have always been the most enduring."

Our Commitment to This Living Heritage

The Government of India recognises Ladakh as one of the most important living centres of Buddhist culture in the world. We remain committed - not in the language of policy documents alone, but in concrete action - to supporting the preservation of its monasteries, the promotion of Buddhist scholarship, and the safeguarding of its unique cultural traditions. A large-scale Buddhist chanting ceremony involving a significant number of monks is being planned as part of this exposition - one that organisers hope will be entered into the Guinness World Records, a fitting symbol of the scale of devotion this land commands.

The Union Government will continue to work closely with the monastic institutions and the people of Ladakh to ensure that this rich heritage flourishes and reaches the world. The recently launched digital portals for both Ladakh Tourism and the Sacred Exposition itself are steps in that direction

The Ministry of Culture, the Archaeological Survey of India, the International Buddhist Confederation, and the local organisations of Ladakh - the Gonpa Association, the Buddhist Association, the UT Administration under Lieutenant Governor Shri Vinai Kumar Saxena - have worked together with a unity that mirrors the very teachings the relics carry.

A Moment That Belongs to All of Us

As the sacred relics of Tathagata Buddha arrive in Ladakh this Wednesday, something ancient stirs. It is the recognition that some things in the life of a civilisation matter more than the political cycle of any given season. The Buddha's message of compassion is one such thing. Ladakh's fidelity to that message is another.

May the blessings of the Buddha bring peace to every home in Ladakh, harmony among all communities, and spiritual awakening to all beings. And may this sacred exposition remind each of us - regardless of faith, regardless of where we stand - that the deepest human aspiration has always been the same: to live without causing suffering, to act with wisdom, and to leave the world a little more at peace than we found it.

Buddham Sharanam Gacchami.
Dhammam Sharanam Gacchami.
Sangham Sharanam Gacchami.

Views expressed are personal

ELITE ILLUSIONS

Revolution, Until it Hurts

From Imran Khan to Arvind Kejriwal, elite-driven political movements falter when confrontation replaces comfort, exposing the fragile depth of urban dissent in South Asia

ASIF ULLAH KHAN

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When politics turns punishing, the distance between belief and endurance becomes visible—and for many, comfort quietly wins over conviction

In the leafy avenues of South Delhi and the manicured blocks of Karachi and Lahore's DHA, a particular brand of revolution was born over the last decade. It was polished, social-media savvy, and smelled of expensive cologne. It promised a "Naya Pakistan" and a corruption-free India, led by messianic outsiders like Imran Khan and Arvind Kejriwal. But as the summer heat of 2023 and 2024 gave way to the cold reality of state crackdowns, this "Burger Class" revolution hit a terminal wall: the ceiling fan—or rather, the lack of one.

The term "burger," once a light-hearted jab at the Westernised elite of Pakistan, has matured into a potent political metaphor. It describes a demographic that views politics as an intellectual project or a moral crusade, provided it can be conducted from the comfort of an air-conditioned room. To this class, Imran and Kejriwal were not just politicians; they were mirrors reflecting their own aspirations for a "clean" system.

However, politics in the subcontinent is not a debate club; it is a blood sport. It requires "street-fighting" capabilities — the ability to stare down a police baton or endure the psychological warfare of an ED raid or a midnight knock at the door by ISI.

In Pakistan, the May 9 crackdown provided a stark litmus test. We saw the spectacle of fashion designers and tech entrepreneurs — the vanguard of the PTI — walking out of jail cells only to immediately denounce their "Messiah."

Without endurance, dissent cannot survive beyond the first serious confrontation with power

The reason cited was often surprisingly mundane: the heat. The admission by one high-profile detainee that she could not continue because of the May temperatures and the absence of a ceiling fan in her cell wasn't just a personal confession; it was the epitaph of an entire movement's elite wing.

In India, the trajectory of Raghav Chadha offers a parallel study in "burger" pragmatism. Chadha — the London-educated, designer-suit-wearing face of the Aam Aadmi Party — embodied the South Delhi elite's foray into radical change. Yet, when the "hospitality" of Tihar Jail beckoned, and the "Common Man" branding turned into a legal nightmare, the calculation changed.

Chadha's recent defection to the BJP, alongside a cohort of Rajya Sabha MPs, is the ultimate "burger" exit strategy. By utilising a constitutional loophole to switch sides, he didn't just save his career; he saved his comfort. He realised that the revolution Kejriwal promised would require him to endure the same "inhospitality" his colleagues had faced in the Delhi summer. For the urban elite, a seat at the table of power — even a different table — is always preferable to a floor mat in a cell.

The lesson here is grim for grassroots movements. The "Burger Class" brings glamour, funding, and international visibility, but they rarely bring the stomach for the "cesspool" of real politics. When the state stops playing by the rules of civil discourse and starts using physical and legal intimidation, the elite don't just break — they pivot.

In Pakistan, journalists and social media users have devised a cutting term for such turncoats: they say "their software has been updated"— a reference to the state's ability to "re-program" a politician's loyalty through the rigours of jail.

The trajectory of Chadha offers a parallel study in this "burger" pragmatism. Having watched from the sidelines as colleagues like Arvind Kejriwal, Sanjay Singh and Manish Sisodia endured the grit of Tihar Jail, Chadha appears to have reached his own threshold. Despite the discharge of AAP leaders by a Delhi court in February 2026, his dramatic defection to the BJP suggests a calculated choice to avoid any future "inhospitality" of Tihar in Delhi summer.

For the urban elite, the promise of a revolution is rarely worth the sacrifice of personal comfort. Ultimately, Chadha chose a different path: instead of waiting for a "software update," he simply uninstalled the AAP app and downloaded the more secure, power-packed version offered by the BJP!

Views expressed are personal

BHARAT KI SOCH

Sudama's Quiet Greatness

In Sudama's humility, dignity, and devotion lies a timeless moral framework that challenges today's transactional world to rediscover sincerity, gratitude and authentic human relationships

ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS CHAIRPERSON BHARAT KI SOCH

"The Lord is not won by wealth or grandeur, but by the simplicity of a devoted heart."

– Bhagavata Purana
(Sudama narrative; paraphrased)

Among the many figures in India's sacred narrative tradition, Sudama remains deeply relevant because the values it embodies remain urgently necessary even today. His life is not remembered for achievements in the worldly sense. He did not build kingdoms, command armies, or seek recognition. Yet he continues to endure in the moral imagination of India because he represents a rare and disciplined richness of character. In Sudama, we encounter humility, devotion without greed, self-respect without ego, and friendship without transaction. His story invites us to reflect not on material success, but on the ethical foundations of a worthy life. It asks what truly defines a human being when comfort is absent, when circumstances are modest, and when the temptation to measure worth by possession becomes strongest.

One of the most enduring lessons from Sudama's life is that true relationships see beyond status. His bond with Krishna was not built on wealth, usefulness, or social position. It rested on affection, memory, trust, and inner recognition. Krishna did not receive Sudama according to his outward poverty, but according to the depth of the person before him. That is why the episode continues to speak so powerfully to modern life. It reminds us that true friendship is not altered by external standing, and true leadership does not become blind to human worth merely because the world has become accustomed to ranking people by influence, wealth, and visibility. A person of character must learn to see others for who they are, not merely for what they possess or what advantage they bring.

This is why the story carries such significance for leadership. Greatness is proved in the ability to recognise dignity where society sees little prestige. Krishna's enthusiastic reception of Sudama during his visit to his court reveals a profound leadership principle. The noblest authority is never diminished by humility but is, in fact, affirmed by it. Leadership that sees only status may remain efficient, but it cannot become truly great. Great leadership sees the person before the position, the relationship before the hierarchy, and the inner worth before the outward condition. This is a lesson of immense contemporary relevance in institutions, organisations, and public life, where respect is too often distributed according to leverage rather than character.

In a restless age, Sudama's quiet integrity offers a timeless standard of moral strength and human dignity

Sudama also teaches that humility is not a mark of weakness, but a form of strength. He did not complain about his deprivation, nor did he allow poverty to become the defining language of his identity. He bore hardship with dignity, simplicity, and inward composure. This is not passivity. It is discipline. There is a profound difference between being broken by adversity and being refined by it. He shows that when hardship is met with inner steadiness, humility becomes a source of nobility. In a world that frequently rewards self-promotion, noise, and performance, Sudama offers a more enduring model of respect. Quiet integrity does not always attract immediate applause, but it creates a moral stature that time does not easily erode.

Closely related to this is the lesson of self-respect. Sudama's condition was humble, yet he did not reduce friendship to a means of gain. He did not approach Krishna with expectation, nor did he treat affection as a pathway for extraction. This restraint is morally significant. It shows that dignity is not preserved only in what one refuses to endure, but also in what one refuses to exploit. He did not wish to turn companionship into a transaction. That lesson is especially important in the present age, when many relationships are judged by immediate usefulness. Sudama reminds us that some bonds must remain above calculation. To seek support when needed is not wrong, but support must be sought without surrendering dignity, and relationships must not be built or maintained solely for personal advantage.

Here, the role of Sudama's wife acquires a quiet but essential significance. She represents practical wisdom and moral responsibility. She does not undermine Sudama's dignity, but neither does she allow suffering to be disguised as virtue. Her presence in the narrative introduces an important correction to any one-sided celebration of endurance. Human life cannot be sustained by noble thought alone. Duty to family requires responsiveness, courage, and action. Through her, the story teaches that seeking support when genuinely needed is not weakness, provided self-respect remains intact. There are moments when dignity lies in silent endurance, and there are moments when dignity lies in accepting help without diminishing oneself. She reminds us that moral life is not sustained in isolation, but by wise companionship and truthful counsel.

Another profound lesson of the story lies in the humble offering of a small poha packet that Sudama carried for Krishna. While it was materially insignificant, emotionally and ethically, it was immeasurable. Its significance lay not in value, but in sincerity. Intent matters more than magnitude. Honest effort matters more than display. An offering made with affection, humility, and thoughtfulness carries a greatness that wealth can never buy. In a world increasingly enamoured by scale, Sudama reminds us that the spirit behind an act is often more important than the act's visible size. Small offerings can reveal great intentions. What is given from the heart acquires a value that cannot be matched.

This principle extends far beyond the devotional context. In work, relationships, and public life, the same truth remains valid. Sincerity often carries greater weight than spectacle. Effort offered honestly, even when modest in outward scale, creates trust and moral credibility. It asks us to judge not merely by volume, but by intention. The same principle applies to leadership and institutions. Grand declarations often impress, but it is the small and sincere act that builds loyalty, trust, and lasting respect.

Sudama's devotion also offers an equally important lesson in faith without expectation. He did not approach Krishna driven by greed. There was affection, reverence, and trust, a remembrance of their childhood companionship, but no bargaining intent. This is what gives his devotion its purity. He did not calculate devotion in terms of immediate returns. Much of modern life is driven by impatience, by the desire for instant results, visible reward, and measurable return. Sudama represents a different principle. Work with sincerity and let results follow in their own time. Let effort be guided by faithfulness, not greed and expectation. Let relationships be nourished by affection, not by constant accounting. Such a disposition creates inner freedom. It releases the mind from restlessness and allows action to emerge from conviction rather than anxiety.

Gratitude is another central value illuminated by Sudama's life. His heart was not encumbered with disappointment. Even in hardship, he remained rooted in devotion, memory, and thankfulness. Gratitude does not erase suffering, but it keeps suffering from defining the whole of one's experience. That is what gives gratitude its transformative power. It allows hardship to be endured without letting it overcome one's emotions and life. It shifts the mind from scarcity to abundance by building emotional resilience. It allows the individual to remain inwardly content even when outward conditions remain unfavourable. Sudama shows that character far outweighs circumstance. He refused to allow poverty to define him. This is one of the story's most enduring insights for contemporary life. External situations may rise or fall, but identity grounded in values remains a lasting asset. Wealth can be lost. Position can change. Recognition can fade. Character alone travels with the individual through every condition.

Ultimately, Sudama's story teaches that purity of heart, strength of values, and depth of relationships are truer measures of success than material acquisition. To be rich in character is to possess something that cannot be taken away by fortune. This is why his story continues to be meaningful across generations. It is not merely a devotional memory from a sacred past. It is a moral framework for the present. It teaches that humility is strength, that self-respect is indispensable, that sincerity matters more than scale, that gratitude transforms hardship, and that true relationships remain above transaction. It also teaches that great leadership begins in the ability to honour quiet worth without condescension and to give dignity without making another feel small.

That is Sudama's quiet greatness. He shows that a life of modest means can still possess immense moral wealth. He shows that adversity need not diminish identity, that devotion need not become transactional, and that friendship need not become utility. In him, we encounter a standard of conduct that remains deeply relevant to individuals, families, and institutions alike. In an age dominated by display, Sudama reminds us that the deepest forms of greatness often shine quietly. They endure through humility, integrity, gratitude and the unshaken dignity of a devoted heart.

Views expressed are personal

> True wealth lies not in possession, but in character, where humility, sincerity and gratitude shape a life that endures beyond circumstance

TWELFTH MAN

Swing, Skill, Survival

Nearly 10 years after his peak, Bhuvneshwar Kumar has found it again—this time with greater control, maturity and purpose, reminding T20 cricket that bowling intelligence still matters

ARIF MOHAMMAD

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Cricket, in its modern, hyper-accelerated avatar, has steadily tilted the scales in favour of the batsman. Flat pitches, shorter boundaries, heavier bats, and a format ecosystem that rewards relentless aggression have combined to make the fast bowler's craft both unforgiving and, at times, thankless. In such an environment, longevity itself becomes a statement of excellence. It is in this context that Bhuvneshwar Kumar stands apart. In a game increasingly defined by explosive batting and fleeting careers, how many fast bowlers have endured for 15 years in the IPL since their debut? The answer, remarkably, narrows down to just one.

To understand the weight of this moment, one must revisit the arc of his career. A two-time Purple Cap winner in the Indian Premier League, Bhuvneshwar once operated at the peak of his powers, shaping matches with the new ball and suffocating opposition at the death. That phase, nearly a decade ago, established him as one of the finest exponents of swing and control in white-ball cricket. But time, injuries, and the relentless churn of T20 cricket have a way of pushing even the best into the background. For many, such peaks are singular moments. For Bhuvneshwar, remarkably, they appear cyclical.

Against Delhi Capitals, what stood out was not merely the wickets he picked up, but the manner in which he dictated terms. On a surface and in a format that typically rewards aggression, he chose precision. The new ball moved just enough to keep the batters uncertain, the lengths were probing, and the variations were deployed with a clarity that comes only from experience. There was no excess, no theatrics—just a methodical dismantling of rhythm. It was a spell that slowed the game down in a format obsessed with speed.

What makes this resurgence compelling is its timing. Nearly ten years removed from his peak, Bhuvneshwar Kumar is not just surviving; he is influencing games again. In a league where careers can be fleeting and reputations quickly replaced, such a return to form speaks volumes about discipline and reinvention. He has not attempted to outpace the younger bowlers or mimic newer trends. Instead, he has leaned deeper into his strengths—seam position, swing, and control—refining them to meet the demands of a changed game.

There is also a subtle shift in how his performances are being perceived. Earlier, Bhuvneshwar was often seen as a specialist—lethal with the new ball, reliable at the death. Now, he carries the additional weight of experience, functioning almost as a stabilising force in an otherwise volatile bowling landscape. His spell against Delhi Capitals was not just about wickets; it was about restoring balance, about proving that even in a batsman-dominated format, a bowler can still script the narrative.

In many ways, this phase of his career is as significant as his initial rise. The first peak established his credentials; the second underscores his resilience. It tells a story that goes beyond statistics—a story of adaptation in an unforgiving era, of patience in a format that rewards immediacy. For young fast bowlers watching, there is a lesson here that transcends technique: longevity is not just about surviving the game's demands, but about evolving with them.

Bhuvneshwar Kumar's resurgence will inevitably invite comparisons with his past. But perhaps that is missing the point. This is not a nostalgic echo of what once was; it is a fresh assertion of what still can be. In a game increasingly tilted towards the bat, his bowling stands as a quiet but firm reminder—fast bowling, when executed with intelligence and control, remains an art capable of shaping outcomes and redefining narratives.

Views expressed are personal

> In a six-hitting era, Bhuvneshwar proves longevity and skill can still bend T20 cricket's relentless tilt toward batters

WHO SAID WHAT

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A day before Bengal votes in second and final phase, ONLY 1,468 names are believed to have been added back to the electoral roll (source: Indian Express). Total 34 lakh applications are pending before 19 tribunals. As Justice Bagchi of SC said: 'This election, we understand. More valuable right to remain on the rolls, we will examine.' Well, your Lordship, in 99% of cases NO examination done yet and election is tomorrow. Repeat: a RIGHT TO VOTE your Honour is not a post-dated cheque. I guess only when a family member is denied the right, will we all wake up!

WAR BEGAN WHEN THE US AND ISRAEL JOINTLY ATTACKED IRAN IN FEB

Preventing Iranian nuclear weapon remains core issue: Secretary Rubio

WASHINGTON: US Secretary of State Marco Rubio was asked in a Fox News interview about Iran's latest proposal, which would postpone discussions on its nuclear programme but end its chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz if the US lifts its blockade and ends the war.

"There's no doubt in my mind that at some point in the future, if this radical clerical regime remains in charge in Iran, they will decide they want a nuclear weapon," Rubio said.

"That fundamental issue still has to be confronted," he said. "That still remains the core issue here."

Asked if he thinks the Iranians are serious about a deal, Rubio said they are skilled negotiators looking to buy time.

"We can't let them get away with it," Rubio said. "We have to ensure that any deal that is made, any agreement that is made, is one that definitively prevents them from sprinting towards a nuclear weapon at any point."

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio

Meanwhile, the Trump administration seemed unlikely to accept Iran's offer to end the war and reopen the Strait of Hormuz if the US lifts its blockade on the country.

Iran's proposal also would postpone discussions on its nuclear programme, and US Secretary of State Marco Rubio appeared to rule that out.

"We have to ensure that any deal that is made, any agreement that is made, is one that definitively prevents them from sprinting towards a nuclear weapon at any point," Rubio said in a Fox News interview Monday.

The White House said Trump's national security team discussed the offer, which was delivered by Pakistan, and Trump would address it later. The offer emerged Monday as Iran Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi visited Russia, long a key backer of Tehran.

What assistance Moscow might offer now was unclear.

United Nations General Assembly President Annalena Baerbock said urgent efforts to secure a ceasefire in the Iran war are critical.

Highlights

- Rubio said they are skilled negotiators looking to buy time
- Trump administration seemed unlikely to accept Iran's offer to end the war
- The White House said Trump's national security team discussed the offer

During a visit Tuesday to New Delhi, Baerbock warned the conflict is disrupting global supplies and deepening regional crises, with attacks and blockades in the Strait of Hormuz increasing oil and fertilizer prices worldwide.

"Every effort to come to a ceasefire is highly needed," Baerbock said, adding that the escalation is diverting attention from humanitarian crises in Gaza.

"It overshadows the devastating situation for the people in Gaza. The humanitarian situation in Gaza is still heartbreaking."

The war began when the US and Israel jointly attacked Iran on February 28, killing Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei and several top commanders.

The retaliation by the Islamic Republic extended the war to the entire Gulf region. AGENCIES

King Charles III meets with Trump at White House before address to Cong

US President Donald Trump and first lady Melania Trump greet Britain's King Charles III and Queen Camilla as they arrive at White House AP/PTI

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump and King Charles III greeted each other warmly on Tuesday as the monarch began a day of diplomacy in Washington designed to emphasize a bond between the United Kingdom and the United States that is so strong it can withstand the political turmoil of the moment.

Trump welcomed Charles and Queen Camilla to the White House in a ceremony on the South Lawn. The king shook hands with members of Trump's Cabinet before joining the president for a rendition of the national anthem.

The leaders will huddle later in the Oval Office for a meeting that's closed to the public, reducing the potential for the freewheeling, sometimes controversial meetings with foreign officials that have become routine during Trump's second term.

> "CHARLES WILL LATER BECOME THE FIRST BRITISH MONARCH TO ADDRESS THE CONG SINCE HIS MOTHER IN 1991"

Charles will later become the first British monarch to address the US Congress since his mother, Queen Elizabeth II, in 1991.

Her speech highlighted the shared history of both countries and the importance of their democratic values, themes Charles will likely reinforce on Tuesday.

Such addresses are an opportunity afforded to only the most prominent world leaders, including Pope Francis, Vaclav Havel and Winston Churchill. It will likely mark the most extensive public remarks Charles will deliver during a four-day visit to the US that's intended to celebrate the country's 250th anniversary of independence from Britain.

House Speaker Mike Johnson became the first sitting leader of his chamber to address the UK Parliament earlier this year.

He attended a garden party with the king in Washington on Monday and said he told him he would be "well received" in Congress.

The visit comes at a challenging moment for US-UK relations.

Trump's up-and-down relationship with British Prime Minister Keir Starmer has taken a particularly sour turn over the past several months as the Republican president has sought to rally international support for the war in Iran. AGENCIES

'Pleased' to engage with Russian leadership: Iran foreign minister

Reports say Araghchi's meeting with Putin lasted 2 hours

MOSCOW: Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said on Tuesday that the cooperation between Russia and Iran is expanding even as the region is in major flux, as he welcomed Moscow's solidarity and support to Tehran amid uncertainty over the second round of peace talks with the US.

Araghchi, who met Russian President Vladimir Putin in St. Petersburg on Monday, said he was "pleased to engage" with Russia at the highest level as the region is in major flux.

"Recent events have evidenced the depth and strength of our strategic partnership. As our relationship continues to grow, we are grateful for solidarity and welcome Russia's support for diplomacy," he said in a post on X.

During the meeting, Putin hailed the Iranian people for fighting bravely and heroically for their sovereignty and said Moscow is ready to do its best to help bring peace to West Asia as soon as possible.

"We will do everything that meets your interests and the interests of all peoples in the region in order to ensure that this peace is achieved as quickly as possible," Putin told Araghchi, according to the Kremlin.

Regardless of everything that is happening, Iran-Russia relations will continue to grow stronger, Araghchi told Putin, according to the Kremlin.

"It has also been proven to everyone that Iran has friends and allies, such as the Russian Federation, who stand by Iran in difficult times. We are grateful to you for your firm and strong positions in support of the Islamic Republic of Iran," he said. According to Russian media, Araghchi's meeting with President Putin lasted nearly two hours.

Russian President Vladimir Putin (right) and Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi AP/PTI

Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov, who attended the meeting, described it as "constructive and practical".

The Iranian minister arrived in Russia after a whirlwind trip to Islamabad, which, according to him, was "very productive" and involved "good consultations" with Pakistan's Army Chief Field Marshal Asim Munir.

Talking to Russian media, Araghchi said that the United States failed to achieve any of its objectives in its recent war against Iran. Replying to a question about US President Donald Trump's claim of victory, Araghchi said that Iran had stood firm against one of the world's major powers, and none of Washington's stated goals was met, the official IRNA reported. AGENCIES

Pakistan Army targets Afghan Taliban posts

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan on Tuesday responded to alleged unprovoked aggression by the Afghan Taliban and attacks by the TTP along the border, according to a media report.

The reported clashes came after a pause in Operation Ghazab Lil Haq, launched by Pakistan on Feb 26 in response to attacks on border posts by the Afghan Taliban.

Citing security sources, The Express Tribune newspaper reported that Afghan Taliban and "Fitna al-Khawarij" were targeted in the retaliatory fire by the Pakistan Army.

The term "Fitna al-Khawarij" is used by the state for militants belonging to the banned Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan (TTP).

"The Pakistan Army, in the Chaman sector, effectively targeted and destroyed multiple Afghan Taliban posts," the sources said. AGENCIES

Mali's junta leader meets Russian envoy

BAMAKO: Mali's junta leader met with Russia's ambassador to Bamako on Tuesday, authorities said, his first public appearance since the West African nation saw a massive, coordinated attack by Islamic militants and separatists over the weekend. Russia, the junta's key ally, called the attack a coup attempt.

The office of the military leader Assimi Goita released photos showing him meeting a Russian delegation led by the Ambassador Igor Gromyko in what appeared to be the presidential palace in Bamako, the Malian capital.

Meanwhile, the US Embassy in Mali issued a security alert, citing "possible terrorist movements within Bamako, including reports of forced school closures". AGENCIES

ZELENSKYY WARNS OF SANCTIONS

Ukraine in diplomatic tussle with Israel over grain Kyiv says 'stolen' by Russia

KYIV: Ukraine accused Israel on Tuesday of allowing the import of grain it says Russia stole from occupied areas, prompting a sharp exchange between officials.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said a vessel carrying grain had arrived at an Israeli port and was preparing to unload, calling the trade illegal and warning of sanctions against those involved.

Israel claimed that the vessel had not entered the port and had not yet submitted its documents. The MarineTraffic.com marine tracking website showed the ship had been in Haifa for several days.

"In any normal country, purchasing stolen goods is an act that entails legal liability," Zelenskyy wrote on X, adding that Ukraine's intelligence services were preparing sanctions targeting companies and individuals profiting from the shipments. "We will also coordinate with European partners to ensure that the relevant individuals are included in European sanctions regimes," he said. Israel's Foreign Minister Gideon Saar said the country's tax authority had opened an investigation into a ship expected to dock at Haifa port.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy

Saar dismissed Zelenskyy's comments as "Twitter diplomacy", telling a press conference in Jerusalem that Ukraine had not provided sufficient information or requested legal assistance.

Heorhii Tykhyi, a spokesman for Ukraine's Foreign Ministry, said Kyiv had informed Israeli authorities about the vessels in advance. He said more than two had arrived in Israel carrying agricultural products Ukraine described as illegally taken by Russia from occupied Ukrainian land.

> 'We will also coordinate with European partners to ensure that the relevant individuals are included in European sanctions regimes'

The ministry said it had summoned Israel's ambassador, Michael Brodsky, and handed him a note of protest over what it called a continuing flow of such shipments. It added that the origin of the grain had been established and that concealment methods, including ship-to-ship transfers in the Black Sea, were well known. AGENCIES

Belarus frees journalist Andrzej Poczobut in prisoner swap

WARSAW: Prominent journalist Andrzej Poczobut has been released from jail in Belarus in a swap with Poland that also saw a total of 10 prisoners released as the authoritarian leader of Belarus seeks improved relations with the West, officials in both countries said Tuesday.

Poczobut, a correspondent for the influential Polish newspaper Gazeta Wyborcza and a leading figure among Belarus' Polish minority, was serving eight years in prison in a case condemned as politically motivated. His arrest in 2021 drew widespread criticism from Europe, and he was later awarded the European Union's most prestigious human rights award, the Sakharov Prize.

Polish Foreign Minister Radek Sikorski described Poczobut as a symbol of the fight for freedom in Belarus but also of the effectiveness of the Polish state in leaving no one behind. AGENCIES

UK police probe arson attack near Jewish Centre

LONDON: The UK's counter-terror officers are investigating a suspected arson attack at a memorial wall near a Jewish Centre in north London, the Metropolitan Police said on Tuesday.

The force said it had received reports of a fire on Monday evening and while it is not being treated as a terrorist incident, officers are "keeping an open mind" about the motive behind the attack.

The memorial wall at Limes Avenue in Golders Green, which depicts Iranians killed protesting against the country's regime, was not damaged.

"We recognise that this incident will heighten concerns in the Golders Green area, where residents have already faced a series of attacks," said Detective Chief Superintendent Luke Williams. AGENCIES

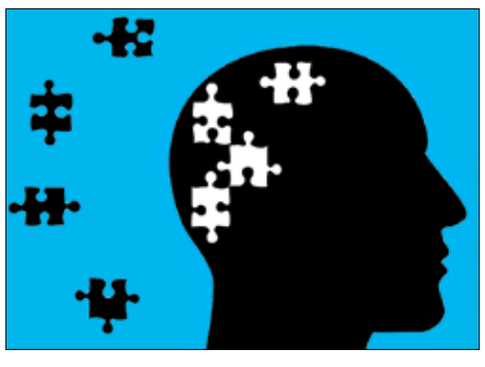
Study describes three distinct trajectories of cognitive decline in Alzheimer's disease

Alzheimer is a neurodegenerative condition in which memory & cognition steadily declines with age

NEW DELHI: A study has revealed three trajectories of cognitive decline in Alzheimer's disease -- stable or no change, slow decline, and fast decline -- based on scans of over 1,100 people in the US who had an elevated level of amyloid protein clumps in the brain, a hallmark feature of Alzheimer's disease, but were cognitively unimpaired.

Alzheimer's disease is a neurodegenerative condition in which memory and cognition (thought processes) steadily declines with age, eventually interfering with one's abilities to perform daily activities. Scans of patients commonly show agglomerates or clumps of brain proteins, such as amyloid and tau.

Researchers from the University of Southern California's school of medicine found higher levels of tau and phosphorylated tau (P-tau217, a modified form of tau) among participants who showed a gradual or a fast cognitive decline, compared to those who remained stable.



Takeaways

- Findings published in the Alzheimer's and Dementia
- They added future trials should focus less on average results and more on different patterns of decline
- Data for the analysis was taken from the Anti-Amyloid Treatment in Asymptomatic Alzheimer's Disease (A4) study

Findings published in the Alzheimer's and Dementia: The Journal of the Alzheimer's Association also showed a smaller hippocampus among the participants with cognitive decline, a brain region involved in memory formation and among the first affected due to the neurodegenerative disease.

"Most studies look at the average across participants, which can make it seem like everyone is slowly getting worse at the same rate," said author Michael Donohue, professor of neurology and associate director of biostatistics at the University of Southern California's Keck School of Medicine.

"But we found that this approach masks major differences between people, suggesting that Alzheimer's disease is more variable than often depicted," Donohue said.

The researchers said while previous studies suggest that people with the neurodegenerative condition suffer cognitive decline at differing rates, the study is among the first to tie the patterns of cognitive decline to biomarkers, including phosphorylated tau.

The team also found that using blood tests and brain scans, they could predict and classify participants into 'stable' and 'cognitive decline' groups with about 70 per cent accuracy.

The findings also point to a major challenge in Alzheimer's prevention research -- during early stages of the disease, participants may remain stable even without treatment, making it harder to detect whether a drug is working, the researchers said.

They added future trials should focus less on average results and more on different patterns of decline.

Data for the analysis was taken from the Anti-Amyloid Treatment in Asymptomatic Alzheimer's Disease (A4) study, a clinical trial of the monoclonal antibody solanezumab, and Longitudinal Evaluation of Amyloid Risk and Neurodegeneration Extension (LEARN), a companion study of people without the elevated levels of amyloid in the brain.

Scores of cognitive tests measuring memory, attention and thinking were used to assess cognitive decline among the participants. AGENCIES

World Briefs

'PAKISTAN CONDUCTS TRAINING LAUNCH OF FATEH-II MISSILE SYSTEM'

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan has successfully conducted a training launch of the indigenously developed Fateh-II missile system, the army said on Tuesday. The launch of the system equipped with advanced avionics and state-of-the-art navigational aids was carried out by the Army Rocket Force, according to a statement by the army. "The training launch was aimed at training of troops, validating various technical parameters and performance evaluation of different sub-systems incorporated for improved accuracy and enhanced survivability," it said.

CROATIA, BOSNIA SIGN PIPELINE DEAL TO REDUCE DEPENDENCY ON RUSSIA

DUBROVNIK: Croatia and Bosnia signed an agreement Tuesday to build a gas pipeline designed to reduce energy dependency on Russia in the volatile Balkans region. The Southern Interconnection pipeline will link Bosnia with Croatia's gas network and the liquefied natural gas terminal on the Adriatic Sea island of Krk. Bosnia has designated a US-based company, AAFS Infrastructure and Energy, as the project's investor and developer. Croatian Prime Minister Andrej Plenkovic and the chair of Bosnia's Council of Ministers, Borjana Kristo, signed the deal in the presence of US Secretary of Energy Chris Wright on the sidelines of a summit of the countries.

Uganda detains 231 foreigners in migration crackdown

KAMPALA: Ugandan authorities said on Tuesday that they have detained dozens of foreigners, including Indians and Pakistanis, in a crackdown on illegal migration that the internal affairs ministry suggested was linked to human traffickers and cyberscam operations.

At least 231 people have been detained since Monday in operations that targeted a group of Nigerians living in the country's north, as well as another group of foreigners living together in a closed compound in Kampala. AGENCIES

CHANGE OF NAME

I, **Manisha Puri W/o Mr. Kamal Bedi,** aged 36 years, residing at C-36, Second Floor, Tagore Garden Extension, New Delhi-110027 have changed my name from **Manisha Bedi to "MANISHA PURI "** for all future purposes. As per Affidavit sown before notary public Delhi on 24.04.2026.

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Cancellation of E-Tender

The e-Tender No.: ST-CKP-OT-26-27-07 & **ST-CKP-OT-26-27-08, Dtd: 10.04.2026** published earlier by Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer, South Eastern Railway, Chakradharpur. The above tender may be treated as **cancelled.** (PR-96C)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Satish Kumar
Addl. District and Session Judge, Charkhi Dadri
Sat Kaur
Vs.
Deepati
CNR No. HRCD01-004865-2023
Next Date:-06-05-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
Juglal S/o Bhagwan Singh :-
Ward No 10 Charkhi Dadri Dist Charkhi Dadri

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **06-05-2026** at **10:00 am.**

For details logon to **https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod = district notice & district =** Charkhi Dadri

Sd/-Sh. Satish Kumar
Addl. District and Session Judge
Dated 28.04-2026 Charkhi Dadri

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority

Main Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **http://etender.up.nic.in.** Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1. **15/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M- III/26-27,** Providing Low Height Street light pole in Dr. BR Ambedkar Park Sector-37 Noida. Cost Rs. 21.98 Lacs.
2. **19/GM(E&M)/S.M./E/M-III/26-27,** Construction of New Fountain In B block Park Sector-100, Noida. Cost Rs. 20.65 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date: 12.05.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 13.05.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B)

1. **26/GM(E/M)/Sr.M (E/M)-IV/2025-26,** AMC of DG Set Gaushala Sector-135 and Annual Electrical Maintenance of Gaushala Sector-135, Noida. Cost Rs. 17.32 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date: 05.05.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 06.05.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (E&M)
Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Babbal S/o** Sagaru **R/o** H.No. A-91, Block-A, PH-2, Ambika Enclave, Nihal Vihar, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 602/2016 U/s 498A/406/34 IPC**., has been registered at **P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Babbal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Babbal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Babbal** of **FIR No. 602/2016 U/s 498A/406/34 IPC**., registered at **P.S. Nihal Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Divyashree Raina
DP/5484/OD/2026 JMFC (West), (Mahila Court)-04
(Court Notice) Room No. 262, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **1.Vicky, S/o: Ram Kewal Gupta, R/o: G-459, Gali No. 12, Janta Enclave, Prem Nagar 3rd, Kirari, Delhi, 2.Pankaj, S/o: Akhilesh, R/o: G-378, Gali No. 10, Janta Enclave, Prem Nagar 3rd, Kirari, Delhi** have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 793/2018, 1. U/s: 323/341/34 IPC, 2. U/s: 323/341/506/34 IPC, Police Station Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it have been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **1.Vicky**, **2.Pankaj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **1.Vicky**, **2.Pankaj** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **1.Vicky**, **2.Pankaj** of **Police Station Roop Nagar, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **02.06.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Shagun
Ld. JMFC, North-West,
1st Floor, Room No. 109
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/5523/RD/2026

मध्यप्रदेश पुलिस आवास एवं अधोसंरचना विकास निगम

कार्यालय परियोजना यंत्री, भदभदा रोड संभाग क्रमांक-03
भोपाल-462003
Mobile No. 9425601545, ईमेल : mpphidcbpl3@gmail.com
क्र.-मप्रपुआअविनि/471/पयं/भोपाल-03/तशा/2026
भोपाल, दिनांक : 28.04.2026

प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

भोपाल संभाग-3 के अंतर्गत जिला भोपाल एवं सागर में ज्ञानोदय विद्यालय का मरम्मत कार्य हेतु निविदा क्रमांक-03/2026-27**(ऑनलाइन निविदा क्रमांक-503612, 503614)** आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र **दिनांक 08.05.2026 सायं 5:00 बजे तक** ऑनलाइन खरीदे एवं दस्तावेज अपलोड किये जा सकते हैं। विस्तृत निविदा सूचना एवं अन्य विवरण Portal : **https://www.mptenders.gov.in** पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

म.प्र. माध्यम/125534/2026 **परियोजना यंत्री**

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Applications are invited under scheme of 'One Station One Product' for setting up:

A. **Total Ten (10) Stall at:** Delhi, Delhi Cantt., Delhi Shahdara, Faridabad, Ghaziabad, Meerut City, Panipat, Pataudi Road, Subzi Mandi, Gurgaon Railway stations.
B. **Total fourty three (43) Trolley at:** Anand Vihar Terminal, Badli, Ballabhgarh, Baghpat Road, Baraut, Delhi Kishanganj, Delhi Sarai Rohilla, Faridabad New Town, Garhi Harsaru, Jakhal, Jind, Muzzafarnagar, Julana, Narela, Khekra, Mansa, Meerut City, Nangloi, Narwana, Noli, Okhla, Palam, Shakurbasti, Shamli, Tapri, Tohana, Tughlakabad, Vivek Vihar, Asawati, Delhi Azadpur, Delhi Safadargunj, Deoband, Khatauli, Mangolpuri, Modinagar, Meerut Cantt, Muradnagar, New Ghaziabad, Partapur, Sakoti Tanda, Sampla, Shivaji Bridge, Tilak Bridge Railway Stations.

- The period for setting up of stall/Trolley at Delhi Jn., Kurukshetra, Subzi Mandi, Palwal, Gurgaon, & Meerut Cantt, Panipat, Narela, Badli Rohtak, Julana, Sampla Railway Stations per spell will be 90 days.
- Registration fee for NSG 1, 2, 3 stations will be charged @ rate of Rs. 2000 for each spell of thirty days and for **NSG 4,5,6** (Delhi Kishanganj, Deoband, Badli, Okhla, Shamli, Tapri, Jind, Jakhal, Tohana, Mansa, Narwana, Baghpat Road, Khekra, Nangloi, Muradnagar, Khatauli, Meerut Cantt, Julana, Sampla, Shivaji Bridge, Tilak Bridge, Ganaur, Badli, Subzi Mandi, Narela, Tughlakabad, Faridabad New Town, Ballabhgarh, Palam, Delhi Safdarjung, Partapur & Sakoti Tanda Railway Station registration fee will be charged @ rate of Rs. 1000 for each spell of thirty days.
- The following are the eligibility criteria for participant viz.
  a) Holder of Artisans/Weaver ID card issued by Development Commissioner Handicraft, Development Commissioner Handloom, or by the requisite State/Central Government Authority.
  b) Individual artisans/weavers/craftsmen enrolled/registered with Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India Limited (TRIFED)/National Handloom Development Corporation (NHDC)/Khadi/ Village Industries Commission (KVIC)/ associated with Social Organizations, State Govt. bodies and associated with registered micro enterprises on the Udyam Portal of the Ministry of MSME and NGOs etc.
  c) Self Help Groups registered with PMEGP (Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme).
  d) Marginalized or weaker sections of society.
  e) No separate logo shall be allowed.
- The applicant will have to submit an undertaking to the Station Superintendent indicating that no activity would be undertaken to adversely affect the train operations, passenger safety and image of the Railways.
- Applications should be addressed and can be submitted to Station Superintendent at station by the applicant till 15:00 hrs. of 07.05.2026, which will be opened on same day.
- Station Superintendent will make priority roster of all approved participants and priority will be established through a draw of lots conducted at the station in the presence of all approved applicants by the Station Manager/Sectional CMI and nominated Finance representative.
- The One Station One Product scheme shall be governed by Railway Board's Commercial Circular No. 12 of 2022 and 09 of 2023 respectively available at website: www.indianrailways.gov.in & URL: https://indianrailways.gov.in/ railwayboard/uploads/directorate/ traffic_comm/Comm_Cir_2022/OSOP%20Policy.pdf & https://indianrailways.gov.in/railwayboard/ uploads/ directorate/traffic_comm/m_Cir_2023/CC%20%2009%20of%202023.pdf. For any queries applicant may contact Station Superintendent or CMI of the respective stations. **1418/2026**

Serving Customers With A Smile

Public Work Department
Office of the Executive Engineer Public Works (West) Division Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar
Address :- Public Works Premise, Padampura, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar 431005
E-mail address: westaurangabad.ee@mahapwd.gov.in
Telephone/Fax Number :-0240 2331288
E-Tender Notice No.(01) of 2026-27

E-Tender for the following work in **B-1** Tender Form is invited via online e- tendering system from Eligible Contractor by the Executive Engineer, Public Works (west) Division, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar on behalf of Public Works Department, Government of Maharashtra Tender Document are downloaded from government portal **https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in** Right to select or reject is reserved by Executive Engineer, Public works (west) Division, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar. Conditional Tender will be not accepted. (Number of 04 Works)

All information of **e-tender is available on following portal.**
A) **https://pwd.maharashtra.gov.in**
B) **https://mahatenders.gov.in**
If any change made in this e-tender is informed on above portal.

Sd/-Executive Engineer
Public Works (west) Division
DGIPR/2026-2027/ 471 Sambhajinagar

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rohit Khanna S/o** Ravinder Khanna, **R/o:** 1/5386, Gali No-14, Balbir Nagar, Extension, Delhi-32, **Also At: (2)** C-3-203, Bharat City, Loni, Ghaziabad (U.P.), **(3)** 676 Mahalaxmi Complex Shakti Khand-3, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad (U.P.), **(4)** Flat No 1106, Classis Resi Raj Kr, Ghaziabad (U.P.), has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg. No. 672/19, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Swaroop Nagar, Outer North Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Rohit Khanna** the said accused of **Case Reg. No. 672/19, U/S 138 NI Act, PS Swaroop Nagar, Outer North Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.07.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Jyoti Nain
DP/5515/ON/2026 Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North Distt.,
(Court Matter) Room No.-06, Rohini Courts, Delhi

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
GREATER LUDHIANA AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY

GLADA Complex, Rajguru Nagar, Ferozepur Road, Ludhiana

Tender Reference No. 657 Dated 28-04-2026

Divisional Engineer (C-II), GLADA, Ludhiana invites online bids for the following works:-

1. Repair and renovation of parking and pavement area by providing & laying bituminous macadam and open graded premix carpet and interlocking pavers in Commercial Pocket opposite Labour Colony Site in U/E, PH-1, abutting 100 feet wide Dugri-Dhandra Road, Ludhiana.
2 Hiring of Architect/ Architectural consultant for design, plannning and supervision of GLADA Guest House-Cum-Business Centre, Dugri Phase-II, Ludhiana.

Closing date & time for SR No.1 : 11-05-2026 at 01.00 PM
for SR No.2.: 14-05-2026 at 01.00 PM
Prebid Meeting date and time: For Sr No.2: 05-05-2026 at 11.00 AM

For details log on to: **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

NOTE: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.
PR-Advt. No :- :- 1323/12/2026-27/10976

CFM ASSET RECONSTRUCTION PRIVATE LIMITED

REGISTERED OFFICE: "Block no. A/1003, West Gate, Near YMCA Club, Sur No. 835/1+3, S. G. Highway, Makarba, Ahmedabad-380051 Gujarat"
CORPORATE OFFICE: 1st Floor, Wakefield House, Sprott Road, Ballard Estate, Mumbai-400038
EMAIL: info@cfmarc.in, sweta.rana@cfmarc.in, anmol.mishra@cfmarc.in Contact: 022-40055282
thoughtful regeneration
CIN: U67100GJ2015PTC083994

APPENDIX- IV-A
[See proviso to rule 8 (6)]
SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

E-auction Sale Notice for the sale of immovable assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest Enforcement Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower/(s) and Guarantor/(s) that the below described immovable property (Secured Asset) mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the **physical possession** of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of CFM Asset Reconstruction Pvt. Ltd. **(acting in its capacity as a Trustee of CFMARC Trust – 1 IHFL "The secured Creditor")** will be sold on "As is where is basis", "As is what is basis", "Whatever there is basis", and "No recourse basis" on **22.05.2026** from **05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M.** for recovery of **Rs.36,43,626/- (Rupees Thirty Six Lakh Forty Three Thousand Six Hundred Twenty Six only)** pending towards Loan Account No. **HHLDMT00289483**, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till **10.04.2026** with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w.e.f. **11.04.2026** along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from **ASHU KHAN** and **AFROZ KHAN**.

The reserve price of the properties and the earnest money deposit is given below: -

DESCRIPTION OF SECURED PROPERTY:	Residential Premises Bearing No. F.F. -02, Having Total Covered Area Measuring 600 Sq. Ft. Or 55.74 Sq. Mtr., Without Roof Rights, Mig Flat, On 1st Floor, Rear Middle Side, Constructed On Plot No.- C 1/1, In Dlf Ankur Vihar, Loni, Ghaziabad-201002, Uttar Pradesh.
SECURED DEBT:	Rs.36,43,626/- (Rupees Thirty Six Lakh Forty Three Thousand Six Hundred Twenty Six only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLDMT00289483 as on 10.04.2026 together with further interest, other costs, and expenses thereon due and payable till the final payment.
RESERVE PRICE (RP):	Rs.14,40,000/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakh Forty Thousand only)
INSPECTION	Visit on request
TIME: DATE: PLACE: For E-AUCTION	E-Auction/Bidding through website **(www.auctionfocus.in)** Date: 22.05.2026 Time: 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M
LAST DATE AND TIME FOR BID SUBMISSION:	On or before 3:00 PM on 22.05.2026
EMD:	Rs.1,44,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Forty Four Thousand only)
CONTACT:	0124-6910910, +91 7065451024

Encumbrances if any: Not known to the secured creditor

For detailed terms & conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in Secured Creditors website i.e. https://www.cfmarc.in for detailed terms & conditions of e-auction/sale of respective properties and other details before submitting their bids for taking part in the e-auction. Bidders may also visit the website to www.auctionfocus.in or contact No.: 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com.

Date: 28.04.2026 **Sd/- Authorised Officer**
Place: GHAZIABAD **CFM Asset Reconstruction Pvt. Ltd.**
Acting as trustee of CFMARC Trust – 1 IHFL

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No.: NCRPU-KRJ-CPYZ-MSDAC-T-05-2026, **Date: 23.04.2026**

E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. CSTE/ PU/ Aligarh, N. C. Railway, for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on-Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: NCRPU-KRJ-CPYZ-MSDAC-T-05-2026, Dated 23.04.2026

Description of work: Replacement of overaged AFTC with MSDAC in DN line between KRJ-CPYZ section of Prayagraj Division.

Approx Cost (Rs.): 6,77,19,396.25	**Earnest Money:** 13,54,400.00/-
Cost of Tender Form: Nil	**Validity of Tender:** 90 days

Date of closing Tender & Time: 28.05.2026, 15:00 hrs.

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 15 Month

Note- 1) The complete information along with Tender document of above E-Works Tender will be available on Website on **www.ireps.gov.in** up to **15:00 Hrs.** on the due date of Tender opening. **2)** Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tenders. For this purpose, Venders are required to get themselves registered with **IREPS** website along with Class III Digital signature certificate issued by CCA under IT Act 2000. **3)** Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form / letter head if attached by Tenderer shall be straight way ignored & shall not be considered. **4)** Documents being attached should be signed by the Tenderer on its body. **5)** For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in.** **925/26 (ADM)**

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice
Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement System)

N.I.T. No.	**03, 04, 05, 07, 09**
Name of work with its location	**03:** Balance works of Construction of station building including second entry, platform surfacing including compliance of divyang facilities, PF shelters & Misc Finishing works at SONIPAT, NARELA & GOHANA Railway Stations under the Amrit Stations Scheme. **Similar nature of work:-** Any Civil work other than track work.
	04: Balance works of Construction of station building including second entry, platform surfacing including compliance of divyang facilities, PF shelters & Misc Finishing works at SUBZI MANDI & PATAUDI ROAD Railway Stations under the Amrit Stations Scheme. **Similar nature of work:-** Any Civil work other than track work.
	05: Balance works of Construction of station building including second entry, Finishing works of FOB i/c Lift & Escalators, platform surfacing including compliance of divyang facilities, PF shelters & Misc Finishing works at Ballabhgarh (BVH), Faridabad New Town (FDN) and Palwal (PWL) Railway Stations under the Amrit Stations Scheme. **Similar nature of work:-** Any Civil work other than track work.
	07: Balance work of Platform surfacing including compliance of divyang facilities, PF shelters, Construction of Improvement of station building including second entry, Elevation, interiors & improvement of circulating area at Bahadurgarh (BGZ) & Rohtak (ROK) Railway station of Delhi Division. **Similar nature of work:-** Any Civil work other than track work.
	09: Balance work of Improvement of Platform surfacing along with compliance of divyang facilities, PF shelter, beautification of circulating area at Jind & Mansa Railway station of Delhi Division of Northern Railway. **Similar nature of work:-** Any Civil work other than track work.
Approx. Cost of work:	**03.** ₹14,24,90,838.71 **04.** ₹14,47,02,114.95 **05.** ₹14,67,69,839.65 **07.** ₹11,74,27,666.92 **09.** ₹9,61,06,010.88
Earnest Money deposited	(It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway only. **Note:** FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no. 201025//CE-I/CT/5/1 dated 31.08.2016) **03.** ₹28,49,800/- **04.** ₹28,94,100/- **05.** ₹29,35,400/- **07.** ₹23,48,600/- **09.** ₹19,22,100/-
Completion period of work	**For: 03, 04, 05 & 07 :** 09 Months **09:** 07 Months
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	**For 04, 07, 09:** Upto 15:00 hrs. on 18.05.2026 Opening of tender at 15:00 hrs. on 18.05.2026
	For 03, 05: Upto 15:00 hrs. on 19.05.2026 Opening of tender at 15:00 hrs. on 19.05.2026
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**

No.: CPM-DLI-NIT-(03, 04, 05, 07, 09)-2026-27/GSU
Dated: 27.04.2026 **1415/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

UJVN Ltd.

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.Q:- "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. ROAD,Dehradun-248006.
Phone :- 0135-2763508, 2763808 & Fax : 0135-2763507
CIN No. - U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

RO No. 356 **Date: 28.04.2026**

TENDER NOTICE

Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tender from Interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

(1) Tender No: 03/EE(Civil)/MB-II/Chinyalisaur/2026-27
(2) Tender No: 04/EE(Civil)/MB-II/Chinyalisaur / 2026-27
(1) Name of work: Development of Vehicle Parking at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Uttarkashi.
(2) Name of work: Refurbishment work on the interior of the power house Building at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, HEP, Dharasu, Uttarkashi.
1. Estimated Cost: Rs. 19,87,780.00 (excluding GST)
2. Estimated Cost: Rs. 16,44,703.00 (excluding GST)
Date of availability of bid document on website 29.04.2026 from 5:00 PM
Last date for submission of tender 23.05.2026 upto 11:00 AM
For fuller & further detail, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be download from the Nigam's website **"www.ujvnl.com"**

Executive Engineer (Civil), MB-II, Chinyalisaur

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rohit, S/o: Vijay Singh, R/o: Old Mahavir Nagar, Tilak Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 252/23, U/s: 394/411/34 IPC, Police Station Vikas Puri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rohit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rohit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rohit** of **Police Station Vikas Puri, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **10.06.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vinod Kumar
JMFC-05, South-West District, Room No. 09
DP/5571/WD/2026 Dwarka Court, New Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.: झाँसी/टी.डी./ड्रा.से./टेन्डर/नोटिस/149 **Dated:** 24.04.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Traction Distribution) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-01	
Description of Work: (1) Provision of 10KVA AT supply in connection with Interlocking of LC Gates No. 377 (BWR-NEW), 382 (MGRR-TKA) and 473 (KHU-ATE) having TVU greater than 20000 of Jhansi Division. (2) Provision of 10KVA AT supply in connection with Interlocking of LC Gates No. 394(MRPR-RORA), 406 (GTI-BTX), 409 (BTX-KLAR), 410 (BTX-KLAR) and S-46 (DPSR-HAR) having TVU greater than 10000 & < 20000 of Jhansi Division.	
Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹4761876.52	**Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹95200.00
Date of Closing Tender: 19.05.2026 15.00 pm.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months	
E-Tender No.: JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-02	
Description of Work: OHE modification work in connection with Longer loop line on 3rd line at SIKRODA KWANRI Station in Jhansi-Dhaulpur section of Jhansi division.	
Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹3237176.66	**Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹64800.00
Date of Closing Tender: 19.05.2026 15.00 pm.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months	
E-Tender No.: JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-03	
Description of Work: OHE modification work in connection with Shifting of rear end point of UP Loop line towards JHS End upto 90mtr for increasing CSR of UP loop line at Jiron Station in Jhansi- Bina section of Jhansi division.	
Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹6981140.42	**Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹139600.00
Date of Closing Tender: 19.05.2026 15.00 pm.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months	
E-Tender No.: JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-04	
Description of Work: OHE Modification in connection of Provision of longer loop line on 3rd line at KRQ Station of Jhansi division.	
Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹7826054.04	**Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹156500.00
Date of Closing Tender: 19.05.2026 15.00 pm.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months	
E-Tender No.: JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-05	
Description of Work: OHE modification work in connection with Longer loop line on 3rd line at Anantpeth Station by extending track machine siding in Jhansi- Dhaulpur section of Jhansi division.	
Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹5991869.56	**Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹119800.00
Date of Closing Tender: 19.05.2026 15.00 pm.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months	
E-Tender No.: JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-06	
Description of Work: OHE modification work in connection with Longer loop line on 3rd line at Mohasa Station (VGLJ End) in Jhansi-Bina section of Jhansi division.	
Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹11237072.08	**Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹224800.00
Date of Closing Tender: 19.05.2026 15.00 pm.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months	
E-Tender No.: JHS-TD-TENDER-2026-07	
Description of Work: OHE Modification in connection of Provision of 02 loop line in UP direction at JHS EI-1 of Jhansi division.	
Approx Cost (Rs.): ₹15419739.65	**Earnest Money/Bid Security (Rs.):** ₹308400.00
Date of Closing Tender: 19.05.2026 15.00 pm.	
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter: 09 Months	

- Tender on line can be submitted up to **15:00 hrs.** on **19.05.2026.**
- For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website **www.ireps.gov.in.** **912/26 (A)**

North central railways | @CPRONCR | www.ncr.Indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Anwar Ali, S/o.: Sabit Ali, R/o.H.No.2, Gali No.1, Saraswati Vihar, Nai Pura, Loni, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.520/2020 U/S 12/9/55 G. Act** registered at **P.S. Gokul Puri, North East District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said **Anwar Ali** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Anwar Ali** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Anwar Ali**, accused of **FIR No.520/2020 U/S 12/9/55 G. Act, P.S. Gokul Puri, North East District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.06.2026.**

By Order, Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
North East District,
DP/5529/NE/2026 Karkardooma Courts, Delhi
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Raj Kumar** S/o Budh Mandal R/o D-11/19, Shahbad Dairy, Outer North, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 16/2024 U/s 324 IPC, PS Budh Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Raj Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Raj Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Raj Kumar** in **FIR No. 16/2024 U/s 324 IPC, PS Budh Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **03.06.2026**.

By order
Shri Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Room No. 112
DP/5433/RD/2026 Rohini Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Deepak @Deepu** S/o Acchewar R/o H. No. E-7/192, Sultanpuri, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 160/2019 U/s 25/54/59 ARMS ACT, PS Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Deepak @Deepu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak @Deepu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Deepak @Deepu** in **FIR No. 160/2019 U/s 25/54/59 ARMS ACT, PS Paschim Vihar East, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.05.2026**.

By order
Ms Moksha Bains
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11
Room No. 31
DP/5306/OD/2026 Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

Mfg drags IIP growth down to 5-month low of 4.1% in March

The factory output, measured in Index of Industrial Production (IIP), expanded by 3.9 per cent in March 2025, an official statement said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India's industrial production growth decelerated to a five-month low of 4.1 per cent in March on account of subdued manufacturing growth and almost flat expansion in the power sector amid the West Asia crisis, according to official data released on Tuesday.

The factory output, measured in terms of the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), expanded by 3.9 per cent in March 2025, an official statement said. The National Statistics Office (NSO) revised the industrial production growth for February 2026 to 5.1 per cent from the provisional estimate of 5.2 per cent released last month.

The previous low of IIP growth was recorded at 0.5 per cent expansion in October 2025. The NSO data further showed that the manufacturing sector's output growth remained subdued at 4.3 per cent in March 2026 compared to 4 per cent in the year-ago month.

Mining production growth improved to 5.5 per cent from a meagre growth of 1.2 per cent recorded a year ago.

Power generation grew marginally by 0.8 per cent in March against 7.5 per cent expansion in the year-ago period.

In fiscal year 2025-26, the country's industrial production growth remained almost flat at 4.1 per cent compared to 4 per cent a year ago.

In the manufacturing sector, 14 out of 23 industry groups have recorded a positive growth in March 2026 over March 2025, it stated.

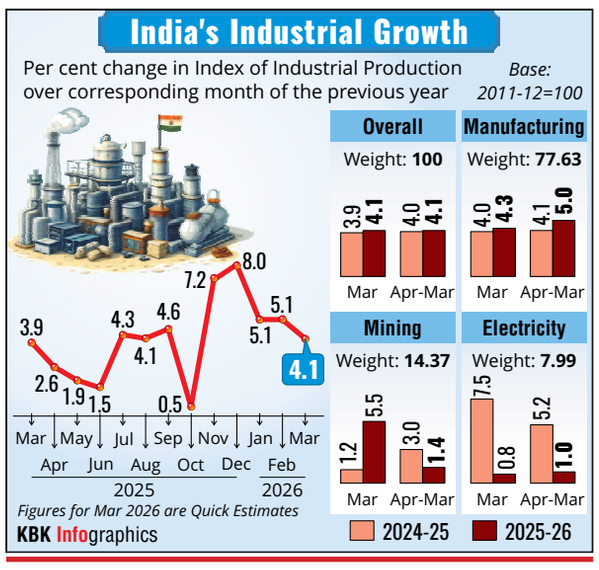
The top three positive contributors for March 2026 are 'Manufacture of basic metals' (8.6 per cent), 'Manufacture of motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers' (18.1 per cent) and 'Manufacture of machinery and equipment n.e.c.' 11.2 per cent).

In the industry group "Manufacture of basic metals", item groups "MS slabs", "Flat products of Alloy Steel" and "HR coils and sheets of mild steel" have shown significant contribution in growth.

As per the use-based classification, the indices stand at 173.3 for primary goods, 156.2 for capital goods, 181.4 for intermediate goods and 229.0 for infrastructure/ construction goods for March 2026.

Further, the indices for consumer durables and consumer non-durables stand at 146.2 and 150.6, respectively.

The corresponding growth rates of Index of Industrial Production as per Use-based classification in March 2026 over March 2025 are 2.2 per cent in primary goods, 14.6 per cent in capital goods, 3.3 per cent in intermediate goods, 6.7 per cent in infrastructure/construction goods, 5.3 per cent in consumer durables and 1.1 per cent in consumer non-durables.



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Highlights

- The previous low of IIP growth was recorded at 0.5 per cent expansion in October 2025
- In manufacturing sector, 14 out of 23 industry groups have recorded a positive growth in March 2026 over March 2025
- The top three positive contributors for March 2026 are 'Manufacture of basic metals' (8.6%), 'Manufacture of motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers' (18.1%) & 'Manufacture of machinery and equipment n.e.c.' 11.2%)
- Further, the indices for consumer durables and consumer non-durables stand at 146.2 & 150.6

Sensex, Nifty decline on surging oil prices, foreign fund outflows

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Stock market benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty buckled under selling pressure on Tuesday as a sharp rally in oil prices and foreign fund outflows amid persistent geopolitical uncertainties dented investors' sentiment.

Deep losses in banking, financial and auto stocks also dragged the equity benchmarks lower, traders said.

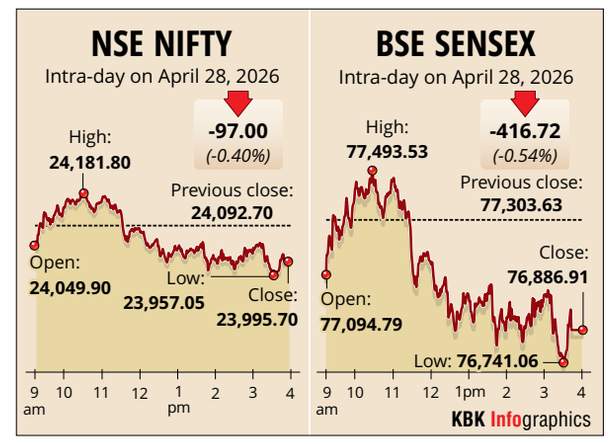
The 30-share BSE Sensex declined 416.72 points, or 0.54 per cent, to settle at 76,886.91. During the day, it lost 562.57 points, or 0.72 per cent, to 76,741.06.

A total of 2,257 stocks declined, while 1,998 advanced and 172 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The 50-share gauge NSE Nifty dropped 97 points, or 0.40 per cent, to end at 23,995.70.

"The session was largely influenced by persistent geopolitical uncertainty, particularly around US–Iran negotiations, which kept crude oil prices elevated and weighed on sentiment.

"Additionally, pressure in banking stocks following regulatory developments related to provisioning norms further capped the upside. Despite these headwinds, buying in select index heavyweights and commodity-linked stocks, along with stock-specific earnings triggers, helped cushion the downside," Ajit Mishra – SVP, Research, Religare Broking Ltd, said.



The rupee depreciated by 53 paise to close at 94.68 against the US dollar on Tuesday

From the 30-Sensex firms, Axis Bank, HCL Tech, InterGlobe Aviation, Maruti, State Bank of India and ICICI Bank were among the biggest laggards.

In contrast, Reliance Industries, Bharti Airtel, Tech Mahindra and Sun Pharma were among the gainers.

The BSE SmallCap Select index climbed 0.42 per cent, while the BSE MidCap Select index dipped 0.27 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, PSU bank dropped (2.20 per cent), bankex declined 1.61 per cent, top 10 banks (1.44 per cent), private banks (1.23 per cent), auto (0.98 per cent) and hospitals (0.95 per cent).

However, energy, commodities, industrials, telecommunication, utilities, metal and oil & gas were the gainers.

The rupee depreciated by 53 paise to close at 94.68 against the US dollar on Tuesday, as elevated crude oil prices and unabated foreign capital outflows amid rising geopolitical uncertainties dented investor sentiments.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 2.97 per cent to $111.4 per barrel.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth Rs 1,151.48 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

On Monday, the Sensex jumped 639.42 points or 0.83 per cent to settle at 77,303.63. The Nifty climbed 194.75 points or 0.81 per cent to close at 24,092.70.

RBI launches Mission SAKSHAM for UCB sector

MUMBAI: RBIGovernor Sanjay Malhotra on Tuesday launched the Mission SAKSHAM for capacity-building of the Urban Cooperative Banking (UCB) sector. The RBI has been taking various regulatory and supervisory measures to support the UCB sector, the central bank said in a release.

Under Mission SAKSHAM, a large number of training programmes would be conducted for UCBs, covering about 1.40 lakh participants, for various target groups, including board members, senior management, heads of risk, compliance and audit functions, and employees working in IT functions and other critical areas.

"The Reserve Bank shall endeavour to conduct these training programmes with content delivery in regional languages to the extent feasible," the release said. The Mission has been designed in consultation with the Umbrella Organisation of UCBs and the National/State Cooperative Federations.

RBI said the Mission is expected to enhance managerial & operational capabilities, improve the compliance culture, and strengthen institutional resilience across UCBs.

Mission SAKSHAM aims to establish a sustainable, self-reinforcing ecosystem for continuous learning, contributing significantly to systemic stability and healthy growth and development of the UCB sector. MPOST

Goyal announces waiver of IP filing fees for sports sector for three years

NEW DELHI: Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday announced a three-year waiver of application fee for intellectual property rights (IPRs), such as patents, trademarks, and designs, related to the sports sector.

A notification in this regard will be issued by the Office of the Controller General of Patents, Designs and Trade Marks (CGPDTM), he added.

"So, from today, any IP, whether it's trademark, copyright, patent, design, traditional knowledge, or a GI product, for three years, as a special drive to promote sports, the fee will be zero," he said here at World IP Day 2026 event, organised by DPIIT in association with FICCI.

The function was organised by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) and industry body Ficci.

IPR application fee at present varies by type and applicant entity - individual, startups, small firm or a big company. The government provides significant discounts for startups and individuals.

The fee ranges between Rs 500 and Rs 60,000.

The Kashmir's Willow Bat has a Geographical Indication (GI) certification.

The minister also said that the DPIIT has a scheme under which the department provides support for filling applications.

"We have a scheme by which we handhold you (applicants), provide you the support to get it registered and make your journey easier to become a part of the IP ecosystem," Goyal said.

He added that the ministry will examine the fee waiver after three years.

Further, he suggested that sports leagues register their trade marks.

"That will help them get better media rights...That will also help you franchise your products. If your core product has an IP, then you can franchise it to others and encash value for it," he said, adding that there is a need to promote the manufacturing of sports goods like hockey sticks, balls, and gym equipment in the country.

"We can also look at scaling up some of the clusters where sports goods are made," he said.

He added that the government can provide support measures for that.

"So, let's study what in India is importing and let's see how we can increase the local manufacturing," he noted. The minister also encouraged Jammu and Kashmir to look at ways to boost the manufacturing of these products. MPOST

Adani, Mittal see Vizag as emerging AI gateway

VISAKHAPATNAM: Adani Group Director Jeet Adani and Bharti Enterprises Vice Chairman Rakesh Bharti Mittal on Tuesday underscored the importance of infrastructure, energy and connectivity in building India's artificial intelligence ecosystem, saying Visakhapatnam is poised to emerge as a key digital gateway.

Adani Group Director Jeet Adani

The remarks came after the foundation-laying ceremony of a $15-billion AI data centre project led by Google near the port city. Adani said the group, along with Bharti Airtel, is playing a significant role in developing the facility, adding that the global AI race is increasingly defined by the ability to build large-scale infrastructure alongside software capabilities.

Calling the moment pivotal, Adani said the project signals Visakhapatnam's emergence as a hub for India's AI-driven future. The facility is being developed in partnership with AdaniConneX and Nxtra by Airtel, and aims to create a gigawatt-scale ecosystem aligned with the Viksit Bharat vision.

He noted that India currently has about 1.3 gigawatts (GW) of data centre capacity, with nearly 1 GW planned at a single location in Visakhapatnam, underlining the scale of the project. Energy, he said, will be central to AI growth, with the "cost of intelligence" closely tied to power costs. Affordable and reliable energy, he added, will be critical for scaling AI adoption.

Adani also highlighted the role of undersea cable infrastructure in positioning the city as a digital gateway, saying it would reduce latency and enable faster processing of AI workloads.

Mittal credited the Andhra Pradesh government, led by Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu, for its policy clarity and execution, which he said have helped attract large-scale investments. He said Visakhapatnam, historically a maritime hub, is now set to evolve into a gateway for the "intelligence age," supported by robust fibre networks and digital infrastructure.

He added that Nxtra by Airtel operates more than 120 data centres across India and said the upcoming facility will be sustainable, powered by renewable energy. Plans also include a state-of-the-art cable landing station and extensive intra-city and inter-city fibre networks to enhance resilience and capacity.

Both leaders stressed that partnerships between global technology firms and domestic infrastructure providers will be crucial for building India's AI capabilities. Lower energy costs, they noted, would reduce the cost of computing, training and deploying AI models, making the technology more accessible and scalable.

Gopal Vittal said Airtel's integrated capabilities—ranging from advanced data centres and green power to ultra-low latency fibre and next-generation cable landing infrastructure—will support large-scale AI deployment in the city. He added that the collaboration with Google and Adani will help accelerate India's digital ambitions.

Industry leaders expressed confidence that the project will spur innovation, expand access to technology and create new economic opportunities, positioning Visakhapatnam at the centre of India's AI growth story. AGENCIES

Anti-vaping group welcomes EU move flagging new nicotine devices as public health threat

NEW DELHI: Mothers Against Vaping (MAV) has welcomed the European Commission's recognition of emerging nicotine devices as a growing public health concern, warning that their increasing use among youth is driving addiction rather than helping people quit smoking.

MAV, a collective of women opposing the promotion of vapes and e-cigarettes to Indian youth, said these products—often marketed as safer alternatives—are drawing in younger users and acting as a gateway to nicotine dependence while exposing them to long-term health risks.

Citing the European Commission's evaluation of the EU tobacco control framework, the group noted that while traditional smoking has declined, new challenges have emerged due to the rapid rise of novel nicotine products, particularly among young people.

Dr Rajesh Gupta of Yashoda Medicity, Indirapuram, flagged serious risks linked to adolescent use, including impaired brain development affecting attention, memory and emotional regulation, along with increased vulnerability to anxiety and mood disorders.

He added that respiratory irritation and cardiovascular strain are also associated with these devices, which often sustain or initiate nicotine addiction.

The group highlighted that claims of e-cigarettes aiding smoking cessation remain questionable. It cited reports suggesting that e-cigarette use may triple the likelihood of initiating cigarette smoking among youth.

It also referred to the World Health Organisation's stance that such devices are not proven cessation tools, and noted that a 2023 Eurobarometer survey found most respondents do not believe they help smokers quit.

In India, MAV alleged that vested interests are promoting these products through illegal online sales, smuggling, surrogate advertising and influencer campaigns, despite an existing ban. Misleading safety claims and narratives pushing for legalisation are being used to create demand, it said.

Calling for stricter enforcement and surveillance, the group urged action to curb illegal sales. Educationist Seema Anis emphasised the need for awareness in schools and families, warning that evolving nicotine products require regular policy review to remain effective. The European Commission's findings also point to growing evidence linking e-cigarettes to cardiovascular, respiratory and potential cancer-related risks, alongside concerns over pregnancy and long-term health impacts. AGENCIES

Bandhan Bank's total business rises by 11% to over ₹3.2 lakh crore in FY26

KOLKATA: Bandhan Bank announced its results for FY26. The bank's total business grew by more than 11 per cent, to close at over Rs 3.2 lakh crore. The Bank's share of retail to total deposits now stands at nearly 74 per cent.

The business growth observed in the FY26 was driven by the Bank's expanded distribution network, improved operational efficiency, and a consistent endeavour towards excellence. Profit earned for the financial year 2025-26 stood at Rs 1,224 crore.

The Bank now serves around 3.2 crore customers through over 6,350 banking outlets across the 35 out of 36 states and UTs of India. The total number of employees working at Bandhan Bank is more than 75,000.

During FY26, the Bank registered a 10 per cent year-on-year growth in its deposit base, and the deposit book now stands at Rs 1.66 lakh crore. Total advances have reached Rs 1.54 lakh crore for the same period.

The Current Account and Savings Account (CASA) ratio stands at 29.3 per cent. The Bank's Capital Adequacy Ratio (CAR), a key indicator of financial stability, is at a robust 18 per cent well above the regulatory threshold.

Speaking on the Bank's performance, MD & CEO, Partha Pratim Sengupta said, "Bandhan Bank's FY26 performance underscores the strength of our franchise, supported by disciplined execution and diversifying business model. We will continue to pursue customer centric, digital led growth by enhancing distribution channels, expanding our product suite, and leveraging data driven insights to deliver sustainable, risk adjusted growth." MPOST

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

A well-attended Exporter–Importer Meet was successfully conducted by Canara Bank Chandigarh on April 27, 2026 at The Lalit, Chandigarh, bringing together key stakeholders from the business and trade community. The event witnessed enthusiastic participation from more than 100 customers, including exporters, importers, entrepreneurs, and business representatives from various sectors. Speaking on the occasion, Chander Singh Tomer, Circle Head, Canara Bank Chandigarh Circle Office expressed his gratitude to all attendees for their valuable presence.

Housing and Urban Development Corporation Ltd. (HUDCO) marked its 56th Foundation Day "Sankalp Diwas" on April 25, 2026. The celebration highlighted HUDCO's remarkable achievements over the past five & half decades. Manhoar Lal, Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs, Tokhan Sahu, Minister of State for Housing and Urban Affairs, Srinivas Katikithala, IAS, Secretary, MoHUA, along with senior officials of MoHUA and State Governments were present during the celebration.

Minister of State for External Affairs, Pabitra Margherita, addressing the Yuva Bharat Global Forum on India–Africa Youth Connect, organised by ChakBal Group, at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, on Tuesday. The Forum brought together distinguished ambassadors, Senior officials, representatives from think tanks and business chambers and members of the media. Margherita highlighted the deep rooted and enduring ties between India and Africa and asserted that India's engagement is guided by principles of equality, mutual respect and shared growth as embedded in the vision of Viksit Bharat @ 2047 and Africa's agenda 2063.

REC posts net profit of ₹16,282 crore in FY26

NEW DELHI: State-run REC Limited on Tuesday reported its highest-ever annual net profit of Rs 16,282 crore for FY26, driven by strong asset quality, loan growth and improved conditions in the power sector.

The company said reforms in the sector have led to a turnaround, with loss-making distribution companies posting a rare collective net profit.

REC's loan book rose by about Rs 17,000 crore to a record Rs 5.84 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026. Its renewable energy portfolio grew 30 per cent year-on-year to Rs 75,347 crore. Asset quality strengthened, with net Stage-3 NPAs at just 0.12 per cent and Stage-2 loans down 75 per cent.

Margins remained healthy, with interest spread at 2.62 per cent and net interest margin at 3.43 per cent. Earnings per share increased to Rs 61.71. The board declared a final dividend of Rs 1.55 per share, taking the FY26 total to Rs 18.55.

REC also maintained strong operational performance, securing 'Excellent' MoU ratings for three consecutive years and improving its ranking among CPSEs in the Department of Public Enterprises survey. Its Maharatna status was reaffirmed, and it topped ESG ratings by the NSE. MPOST

A Royal flush

Rajasthan's Ferreira, Dubey deal Punjab Kings first defeat

MULLANPUR: Donovan Ferreira's audacious stroke-play handed Punjab Kings the bitter pill of defeat for the first time in this edition of IPL as Rajasthan Royals cantered home by six wickets in a high-octane chase here on Tuesday.

Chasing a target of 223, Rajasthan Royals needed 71 off the last six overs when Ferreira smashed his way to an unbeaten 52 off 26 balls in company of an unheralded Shubham Dubey (31 not out off 12 balls) to clinch the victory with four balls to spare.

Ferreira was brilliant while picking his areas as PBKS troika of Arshdeep Singh (1/68 in 4 overs), Lockie Ferguson (0/57 in 4 overs) and Marco Jansen (0/41 in 3.2 overs) would like to forget this day in a hurry.

Between Ferreira and Dubey, they hit nine fours and five sixes as they undid all the good work done by Yuzvendra Chahal (3/36 in 4 overs).

The manner in which Vaibhav Sooryavanshi (43 off 16 balls) started with a deluge of sixes -- five -- including a couple of flicked maximums off Arshdeep Singh and Lockie Ferguson, it seemed RR would make a meal of the chase.

Arshdeep was lucky that Sooryavanshi missed out on a sixth six when he mistimed a full-toss only for Shreyas Iyer to grab it with ease.

However, it was the wily Chahal who brought the Royals back in the game just when Yashasvi Jaiswal (51 off 27 balls) looked like slowly taking the game away in company of Dhruv Jurel (20 off 16 balls).

However, Jurel committed a hara-kiri, offering an easy skier off a full-toss but it was the manner in which Jaiswal and skipper Riyan Parag (29 off 16 balls) were taken out deserved more than honourable mention.

For both, the pace on the ball was considerably taken off and flighted outside the off-stump line without giving enough room to chance their arms. Both were holed out at long-off. But then, Ferreira and Dubey had other ideas as Chahal's good work went down the drain.

Earlier, Stoinis muscled his way to a 20-ball half-century despite a gallant effort from young leg-spinner Yash Raj Punja as Punjab Kings posted a competitive 222 for 4 after being put into bat. While PBKs' top three -- Prabhsimran Singh (59 off 44 balls), Priyansh Arya (29 off 11 balls) and Cooper Connolly (30 off 14 balls) -- all looked dangerous, but none of them went on to play a big knock on a track that was hard and offered appreciable bounce. It was Stoinis, who bludgeoned his way to an unbeaten 22-ball 62 with a half a dozen of sixes and four boundaries as RR gave as many as 55 runs in last 3 overs. AGENCIES

Donovan Ferreira and Shubham Dubey carried the Royals over the line PTI

Suryakumar sweats it out in nets

MUMBAI: For a batter who thrived in moving away from the game for a short while to find his way back to runs, it was a contrasting sight here on Tuesday as Suryakumar Yadav sweated it out in the nets on the eve of Mumbai Indians' IPL match against Sunrisers Hyderabad here.

It was in January this year when Suryakumar banished his batting woes from 2025 with three half-centuries against New Zealand in a five-match affair right before the T20 World Cup, and helped India tide the challenge from the USA in the tournament opener with another gritty knock. On Tuesday, Suryakumar was the first to hit the nets much before MI's slated practice session from 6pm and wrapped up a one-and-a-half hour session.

Once done, Suryakumar immediately walked over to have a long chat with his Abhishek Sharma. AGENCIES

SRH TO END A 3-MATCH LOSING STREAK?

Mumbai Indians desperate for revival against in-form SRH

MUMBAI: Mumbai Indians will hope for a massive turnaround in fortunes against an in-form Sunrisers Hyderabad, with the five-time champion's campaign at stake in a crucial Indian Premier League clash here on Wednesday.

With five defeats in the first seven matches, and their most recent being their heaviest in history by margin of runs (103 vs Chennai Super Kings), Mumbai Indians (rank 9th, 4 points, NRR -0.736) have their backs firmly pressed against the wall in a season marred by no-shows from their top guns.

Comprising as many as four players from India's T20 World Cup-winning squad, MI's woes have been compounded by ordinary returns from skipper Hardik Pandya (3 wickets and 97 runs) and Suryakumar Yadav (157).

Tilak Varma's maiden IPL hundred against Gujarat Titans did help MI snap a four-match losing streak, but their massive loss to CSK once again threw their faltering campaign in a tailspin. MI also have had Jasprit Bumrah (2 wickets) languishing far behind. Usually preserved for breakthroughs in middle-overs and stifling oppositions at the death, Bumrah has uncharacteristically opened the attack for MI in the last two games since the other new-ball bowlers have failed to deliver.

Neither Trent Boult (1) nor Deepak Chahar (1) have been penetrative, and overall, MI have more often than not allowed oppositions to seize control in the powerplays with a lack of wickets and ordinary bowling.

Meanwhile, Rohit Sharma's absence created a void which Danish Malewar (2, 0) hasn't been able to fill in the last two games, and it remains to be seen if the former skipper has regained fitness after a hamstring issue.

With an injured Mitchell Santner being replaced by Keshav Maharaj, it also remains to be seen if Will Jacks finds a place in the playing XI. He had thrived in similar conditions in the T20 World Cup.

SRH, meanwhile, will feel they are primed to end a three-match losing streak against MI when they take the field in batting-friendly conditions of the Wankhede Stadium here.

Unfazed by an onslaught from the 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, SRH came out all guns blazing to record a second victory of the season over Rajasthan Royals. AGENCIES

Mumbai Indians will look to make early inroads against SRH PTI

> Mumbai Indians (rank 9th, 4 points, NRR -0.736) have their backs firmly pressed against the wall

LOST T20I SERIES 1-4

India take lessons home after S Africa drubbing

India lost by 23 runs in the fifth and final match FILE

BENONI: Head coach Amol Muzumdar struck a reflective note after India women's national cricket team slumped to a 1-4 defeat against South Africa women, saying the visitors would return richer in "learnings" despite the disappointing result.

India won the fourth game but ended the series with a 23-run defeat in the fifth and final T20 here on Monday.

"I think it's been a fantastic series, fought really well. It was competitive right from the start and it's been fantastic to come here in South Africa," Muzumdar said after the conclusion of the series.

"Obviously, the result hasn't gone our way. We've been a little disappointed with the 4-1 result, but we have got a lot of learnings out of the series."

The coach identified India's inability to strike in the powerplay and lapses in finishing with the bat as key areas of concern, though he noted visible improvement in the latter half of the rubber.

"Initially, in the powerplay we weren't able to pick up wickets, that was one concern area for us and also the finish with the bat. But we addressed those things in the last three games," he said.

> **We've been a little disappointed with the 4-1 result, but we have got a lot of learnings out of the series**
>
> — Amol Muzumdar, India coach

He lauded the opposition for coming out as strong rivals.

"Credit to South Africa, and especially to Laura Wolvaardt, the way she batted. She has batted beautifully in this series."

The opener had scores of 51, 54, 115, 18 and 92 not out in the series.

Muzumdar, however, drew positives from individual performances, highlighting skipper Harmanpreet Kaur's form and work ethic.

"To start with, Harman's form has been fantastic, she's batting well and her work ethics have been spot-on," he said.

He also praised late contributions from Richa Ghosh and a return to form for Deepti Sharma. AGENCIES

Junior lifters bag four gold

NEW DELHI: Indian lifters impressed at the ongoing Commonwealth Youth and Junior Weightlifting Championships and the corresponding Universal Cup (Senior) in Apia, Samoa, securing four gold medals on the second day of competition.

Sunil Singh lifted a total of 271kg (126kg in snatch and 145kg in clean and jerk) to clinch the gold in the 65kg men's category, while Aisangfa Gogoi won the top prize in women 58kg and Abhinob Gogoi bagged the yellow metal in men's 71kg division.

Aisangfa lifted a total of 185kg (79kg in snatch and 106kg in clean and jerk) to bag gold in the 58kg women's category, while Abhinob totalled 284kg (129kg in snatch and 155kg in clean and jerk) to secure top finish in the 71kg men's division.

In the Universal Cup, Arunachal Pradesh's Charu Pesi bagged the gold medal in the men's 65kg category with a total lift of 289kg (127kg in snatch and 162kg in clean and jerk).

Indian Weightlifting Federation (IWF) president Sahdev Yadav congratulated the athletes, coaches and support staff for their performances in the tournament. AGENCIES

Women lose 0-5 to China to end campaign in Uber Cup

HORSENS: Two-time Olympic medallist PV Sindhu squandered a strong position as India failed to capitalise on chances, going down 0-5 to China to end their campaign at the Uber Cup Finals here.

The Indian women's team had opened with a 2-3 loss to hosts Denmark before bouncing back with a 4-1 win over Ukraine.

China, the most successful team in Uber Cup history with 16 titles, was always going to be a formidable opponent, with India having lost to them three times in their last three major ties.

While Sindhu remained the leader of the group, Isharani Baruah and Devika Sihag were drafted in place of Unnati Hooda and Tanvi Sharma for the other two singles.

Sindhu raised hopes as she looked set for a statement win before letting slip an 18-12 lead in the decider to go down 16-21, 21-19, 19-21 to world No. 2 Wang Zhiyi in the opening singles, handing China a 1-0 lead in the must-win Group A tie on Monday.

It would have taken a miracle to upset the defending champions thereafter and, though the young Indian shuttlers showed fight, they lacked the finishing touch and faltered at crucial moments.

Priya Konjengbam and Shruti Mishra were no match for world No. 1 pair Liu Sheng Shu and Tan Ning, losing 11-21, 8-21 in the first doubles.

Tasked with keeping the tie alive, Isharani Baruah produced a fast-paced display to trouble Tokyo Olympic champion Chen Yufei but left too many shuttles and committed errors at the net. The world No. 38 Indian missed a sitter at 20-19 in the opening game as the world No. 4 Chinese eventually sealed a 22-20, 21-13 win in 44 minutes to give China an unassailable 3-0 lead.

The pair of Treesa Jolly and Kavipriya Selvam also had their moments before going down 10-21, 21-12, 19-21 in a 59-minute clash against Luo Xu Min and Zhang Shu Xian.

World No. 43 Devika Sihag, who had won her maiden Super 300 title in Thailand this year, too made a strong start but failed to sustain the momentum, losing 21-19, 17-21, 10-21 to world No. 97 Xu Wen Jing in the third singles. AGENCIES

PV Sindhu lost in three games to Wang Zhiyi BWF

> China, the most successful team in Uber Cup history, was always going to be formidable

No demons in pitch, just RCB's brilliance: Krunal on DC Collapse

NEW DELHI: RCB all-rounder Krunal Pandya says the dramatic Indian Premier League contest against Delhi Capitals was decided as much by skill as by staying "one step ahead" in the mental game.

Reflecting on the comprehensive nine-wicket win, which will be remembered for an incredible capitulation of Delhi, Krunal underlined that there no demons in the wicket but just that pacers Bhuvneswar Kumar and Josh Hazlewood were exceptional.

"To get six wickets in the powerplay, you have literally taken the game away from the opponent. The wicket wasn't that bad, but it was pure skill set and why they are among the best," Krunal said.

Krunal also shed light on his own evolution as a bowler, revealing that the introduction of variations like the bouncer and altered trajectory deliveries was a conscious attempt to outthink batters in a format increasingly dominated by power-hitting. "Every year the opposition prepares for you, so it becomes a mental game as well. I was thinking what I can add to be one step ahead. That's where the bouncer and change in trajectory came in," he explained.

The left-arm spinner acknowledged that executing such variations is physically demanding, particularly for a spinner. "It's not easy for a spinner to bowl a bouncer. A lot depends on fitness. But I've never been scared to try new things. I took it as a challenge."

Despite the dominant performance, Krunal struck a cautious note on RCB's campaign, insisting that the team is not looking too far ahead. AGENCIES

Asiad may be moved to pre-Oly year

NEW DELHI: The Asian Games could shift to odd-numbered years after the 2026 edition, effectively moving to the year before the Olympics to serve as a key qualifying event across more sports, according to reports.

The Executive Board meeting of the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) discussed the subject on April 21 in the Chinese city of Sanya, the venue of the ongoing Asian Beach Games.

The move is aimed at aligning the continental showpiece more closely with the Olympic cycle, given that the Olympic Games are held in even-numbered years. Currently, the Asian Games are held two years before the Olympics.

The upcoming Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, scheduled from September 19 to October 4, 2026, will go ahead as planned. Any calendar change, if approved, is likely to be implemented from the next edition, slated for Doha, Qatar in 2030, which could be shifted to 2031. Saudi Arabian capital of Riyadh is to hold the 2034 edition while India has submitted an Expression of Interest to host the 2038 edition.

"The Olympic Council of Asia addressed the possible calendar modification this week in Sanya," the report stated. AGENCIES

World Team Table Tennis C'ships: India men thrash Tunisia 3-0

LONDON: The Indian men's team made a strong start to its campaign at the World Team Table Tennis Championships with a convincing 3-0 win over Tunisia, while the women's side was awarded a walkover here on Tuesday.

Manush Shah, Manav Thakkar and Harmeet Desai registered impressive wins for India. Shah got the team off to a steady start, defeating Essid Wassim 3-1 (11-5 9-11 11-3 11-5) before Thakkar and Desai picked up identical 3-0 wins.

World No 38 Thakkar then extended the lead, overwhelming Yousef Aidli 11-3 11-3 11-3 in a one-sided contest.

Desai wrapped up the tie with a composed display, beating Aboubaker Bourass 11-5 11-4 11-8 to seal a comprehensive win for the Indian side.

Placed in Group 7 of Stage 1B, the result has propelled the Indian men's team to the top of the standings in a group that also features Slovakia and Guatemala.

Earlier in the day, the Indian women's team received a 3-0 walkover after Uganda failed to report for the tie.

Like the men, the women's side is also competing in Stage 1B of the tournament.

The top two seeded groups, featuring the top seven teams plus hosts England, start in Stage 1A, while the remaining teams play in Stage 1B.

Only group winners are guaranteed direct entry into the main draw from Stage 1B, while second-placed teams face a complicated qualification route based on match ratios.

Meanwhile, the Sports Authority of India (SAI) has extended significant support ahead of the Championships, sanctioning over Rs 90 lakh for preparations and participation.

This included a national coaching camp in Bengaluru followed by an overseas training stint in Sheffield.

SAI also released a total fund of approximately Rs 60.1 lakh to the Table Tennis Federation of India to ensure the teams' participation. AGENCIES

> Earlier in the day, the Indian women's team received a 3-0 walkover after Uganda failed to report for the tie

FIFA proposes new World Cup rule on yellow cards to avoid knockout bans

Yellow to no-go?

VANCOUVER: FIFA is preparing to tweak World Cup rules on yellow cards to ensure fewer players are suspended for key elimination games in North America.

An extra amnesty for yellow cards — wiping player disciplinary records twice during the expanded tournament — will be proposed to a meeting Tuesday of FIFA's ruling council, people familiar with the plan told The Associated Press. They spoke on condition of anonymity because the decision is not yet official.

At the World Cup, players must serve a one-game ban if they are shown a yellow card in two different games but they were canceled at previous tournaments after the quarterfinals stage. That ensured no player would miss the final through suspension just because of getting a yellow card in the semifinal.

The expanded 48-team World Cup format, with an extra round-of-32 knockout stage, led to a FIFA review aimed at helping keep players on the field.

FIFA proposes to clear the disciplinary records of players who have one yellow card after the three-game group stage so they start the knockout phase afresh. A second amnesty after the quarterfinals will apply for players who got one yellow during the three previous knockout rounds and whose teams advanced to the semifinals. AGENCIES

Lookman a doubt for Atletico against Arsenal

MADRID: Atletico Madrid could be without striker Ademola Lookman when it takes on Arsenal looking to return to the Champions League final for the first time in a decade.

Atletico and Arsenal meet on Wednesday in Madrid in the first leg of the semifinals, seeking their first Champions League title. Lookman has been key for Atletico since arriving from Atalanta this year, but he missed the last two games because of a muscle issue from the Copa del Rey final on April 19.

He practiced with the rest of the squad in the last few days and seemed ready to make his return. But Atletico coach Simeone said on Tuesday the Nigeria striker was still a doubt to start at Metropolitano Stadium. "We'll see if he recovers well tomorrow," said Simeone, who turned 56 on Tuesday.

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Sr. No.	Work Name	Cost in Cr.
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Information regarding the E-Tender notice, Tender documents and other information etc. will be available on this website - https://mahatenders.gov.in/ from date 28.04.2026

Sd/- (Sanjay kakade)
Jt. Commissioner
Dgipr/465/2026-27 **Directorate of Municipal Administration**

'I NEVER WANT TO BE NEXT SOMEONE ELSE'

Sara Arjun called Deepika Padukone and Alia Bhatt her inspiration in an old video

Sara Arjun is getting a lot of love for her performance in 'Dhurandhar' opposite Ranveer Singh. Playing the role of Yalina, she struck a strong connection with audiences, while the film has become an all-time blockbuster. Amid the buzz around her breakout performance, an old childhood video of Sara has resurfaced on the internet. Sara, who started her career as a child artist, can be seen calling Deepika Padukone and Alia Bhatt her inspiration in this old video.

In the clip, which appears to have been filmed by her mother, a young Sara is seen answering a fan's question about her role model. She said, "My role model… I love the way Alia Bhatt looks and acts and I really love Alia Bhatt and Deepika Padukone. But they are not my role models, I just love them and they are my inspiration, but I wanna be Sara Arjun. If I am honest. I never want to be next to someone else."

Her words, marked by a clear sense of individuality at such a young age, have impressed many online. Social media users have been quick to praise her confidence and self-belief. One user wrote, "The girl has a sense of individuality at such a young age. Couldn't be more impressed," while another commented, "What a sorted girl." Others described her as 'confident', 'focused' and 'incredibly talented'. AGENCIES

> Her words, marked by a clear sense of individuality at such a young age, have impressed many online

Veteran actor Bharat Kapoor dies at 80

The late actor had a cardiac arrest

15 October, 1946 - 26 April, 2026

Veteran actor Bharat Kapoor passed away in Mumbai on Monday following a cardiac arrest. He was 80. Actor Avtar Gill confirmed the news to SCREEN. Gill said, "I have just come from the cremation ground. When his son called me, he shared that Bharat had not been keeping well for the past three days. The main cause of death is cardiac arrest. He was at home only. Before that, he was in the hospital."

He added, "Very few people, including close relatives and members of our theatre group IPTA, attended the funeral. Rakesh Bedi, director Ramesh Kumar, actor Kuldeep Singh and a few other people from our theatre group paid their last respects to him. His prayer meeting is on April 30 from 5 to 7 pm at his house."

A widely recognised figure in Bollywood, Bharat Kapoor appeared in tens of films over four decades, starting in the early 1970s, during which he played a wide range of roles, unperturbed by how they would shape his image.

In the 1980s and early 1990s, he appeared in many movies, portraying noteworthy characters and leaving a lasting impact on the audience, regardless of how much screentime he received. He was mostly seen in supporting and villain roles.

> Bharat Kapoor appeared in tens of films over four decades

His notable movies include 'Noorie' (1979), 'Ram Balram' (1980), 'Love Story' (1981), 'Bazaar' (1982), 'Ghulami' (1985), 'Aakhree Raasta' (1986), 'Satyamev Jayate' (1987), 'Swarg' (1990), 'Khuda Gawah' (1992), 'Rang' (1993), 'Barsaat' (1995), 'Saajan Chale Sasural' (1996) and 'Meenaxi: A Tale of Three Cities' (2004). AGENCIES

Karl Urban talks about his series 'The Boys'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

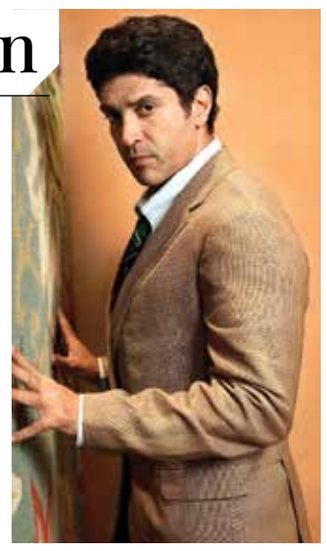
Before Prime Video's 'The Boys' blew up into the kind of series people quote, meme and obsess over, Karl Urban, who plays the now fan-favourite Billy Butcher, approached it with measured optimism. He had hope, certainly, but what unfolded over the seasons was something far bigger than a typical hit series run. As the series catapulted from a superhero drama into a full-blown pop culture force, the shift, for Karl, wasn't just visible in ratings or numbers; it played out in real time. And what followed was a steady, unmistakable rise, from growing buzz to real-world recognition and eventually, the kind of behind-the-scenes intrigue (including an on-set mole leaking script) that signalled that the series had truly entered the big leagues.

> 'It's dangerous to have expectations,' says the actor

As 'The Boys' inches closer to its much-awaited finale, Karl Urban reflected on how the series' success unfolded far beyond his expectations. He shared, "I learned a long time ago it's dangerous to have expectations. I wouldn't say I had any expectations of the show, but I certainly had hopes. We were greenlit for a second season and it slowly dawned on me that this show is a hit and not just by the ratings numbers, but in day-to-day life. The interactions with people who are coming up and saying, 'Hey, I love your show, can I have my picture with you?' It was this slow process as the show became more and more popular, directly proportional to the loss of anonymity, that I knew we had reached a totally new threshold."

I should go back to acting: Farhan

Akhtar opened up about the 'messy' 'Don 3' row with Ranveer Singh



Farhan Akhtar finally opened up on the ongoing row with Ranveer Singh over the fate of his long-awaited next directorial, 'Don 3'. The actor-filmmaker admitted the disagreement became 'messy', but having learnt from past setbacks, he chose to count his blessings instead. Farhan also opened up about his learnings from the episode.

"What I've learnt is expect the unexpected. You can't take anything for granted until it's on film," said Farhan in a chat with 'The Hollywood Reporter India'. Completing 25 years in the film industry this year, Farhan recalled how he was incredibly lucky when stars like Aamir Khan, Saif Ali Khan, Akshaye Khanna, Preity Zinta and Dimple Kapadia instantly said yes to him for his 2001 seminal debut, 'Dil Chahta Hai'.

"You realise at some point there'll be a period that would come that would be a bit challenging. You've had it good. It's okay, just take it in your stride. I inculcated a lot from the experiences of people who came before me. There will be these moments that will come along that'll be challenging creatively and existentially. You'd wonder, 'Do I have what it takes?'" Farhan said.

But he also pointed out that his most defining success in 'Dil Chahta Hai' was followed by his most crushing failure in his sophomore directorial, 'Lakshya', starring Hrithik Roshan. That box-office failure took time to heal but eventually made him stronger to tackle similar uncertainties. AGENCIES

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Antonio, ranked among the world's top 50 management thinkers is the world's leading champion of project-driven transformation at scale. A renowned author and Harvard Business Review contributor, his work including *"Powered by Projects"* has redefined how organizations deliver strategy. He has published over 20 papers in HBR. Today, he is leading the charge in integrating AI into project management, unlocking new levels of speed, intelligence, and impact. His book on Project Economy has given a new direction to the PM profession.

Ricardo Viana Vargas, Ph.D.
on 'Unlimited Opportunities in Managing Change through AI'

Ricardo, with over 25 years of experience in global operations, project management, business transformation, and crisis management has managed projects exceeding US$20 billion across industries. A bestselling author of 16 books and an internationally acclaimed keynote speaker (250+ talks in 40 countries), he is at the forefront of driving innovation in project management. His work highlights how AI can transform change management into a powerful strategic advantage.

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